**Jordan Level III**
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# EXHIBIT A

# Complaint (#Z005911-061526)

**Complaint Details**

| | |
|---|---|
| Name of Complainant: | Stephen Ray Jordan |
| Address of Complainant: | 13054 Cinderella Lane, Frisco, Texas 75035 |
| Complainant Phone Number: | 972-403-1231 |
| Complainant Email Address: | srjordan@gmail.com |
| Add Second Complainant?: | No |
| Type of Complaint: | Student/Parent Complaint |
| Student Name: | [redacted] Ray Jordan |
| Student Campus: | [redacted] MS |
| Select the Student / Parent Complaint Type: | Violation of a school law of the state \| |
| Please describe the decision or incident causing your complaint: | On June 9, 2026, Matthew Franks, Head Club Swim Coach and Assistant Natatorium Manager, issued written notice to Complainant titled "Report of Conduct at the NWAA Team Travel Meet." The notice announced that the District would conduct an investigation into Complainant's conduct as a potential violation of the Parent Code of Conduct, and designated Coach Franks himself as the investigator. The notice was copied to Melissa Howard and Daiki Sato, both of whom are named subjects of Complainant's prior protected reporting through the District's Lighthouse Services ethics channel and the District's formal grievance process. Coach Franks is himself a named subject of an active USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant on June 9, 2026. The conduct described constitutes retaliation against Complainant for protected reporting in violation of TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and Board Policy FNG(LOCAL), and the assignment of Coach Franks as investigator violates the recusal requirement of TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FNG(LOCAL) page 5. This grievance is separate and distinct from the matter currently pending before the Texas Commissioner of Education in Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District. Full grievance with statutory grounds, required recusals, and relief sought are being transmitted by email to the Office of the General Counsel and the Complaint Resolution Office under separate cover due to the 0MB attachment limit displayed by this portal. |
| Date of decision or incident: | 6/9/2026 |
| Date you became aware of decision or incident: | 6/9/2026 |
| Please explain how you have been harmed by this decision or incident: | Complainant has been harmed in the following ways: (1) Subjected to a Parent Code of Conduct investigation initiated in temporal proximity to Complainant's protected reporting through Lighthouse Services, the District's grievance process, the Texas Public Information Act, and USA Swimming Code of Conduct procedures; (2) Subjected to investigation by a District employee who is himself a named subject of an active complaint filed by Complainant in a parallel forum, in violation of recusal requirements; (3) Disclosure of the investigation against Complainant to named subjects of Complainant's prior protected reporting (Melissa Howard and Daiki Sato), who were copied on the investigation notice, constituting a breach of investigative confidentiality and indicating coordination with subjects of Complainant's prior protected reporting rather than independent investigation; (4) Ongoing chilling effect on Complainant's exercise of protected reporting rights, including the rights to file grievances under FNG(LOCAL), to request public information under the Texas Public Information Act, and to file complaints with external regulatory bodies; (5) Procedural prejudice in the form of having to expend time and resources defending against an improperly initiated and improperly assigned investigation while parallel District proceedings remain unresolved. |
| Please describe any attempts you made to resolve you complaint informally, including the names of any individuals with whom you spoke and the dates of those conversations: | On June 11, 2026, Complainant submitted a written response to Coach Franks's investigation notice that included a specific question (identified as Item 5) asking whether the office conducting the investigation was aware of Complainant's other pending matters with the District and whether any coordination had occurred between offices. On approximately June 12, 2026, Coach Franks responded to Complainant's June 11 written response but did not address Item 5. On approximately June 13, 2026, Complainant submitted a second written response to Coach Franks renewing the request for a direct written response to Item 5, requesting identification of all interviewees, disclosing for the record the pendency of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaints involving multiple Iron Horse Aquatics coaches, and protecting Complainant's minor child from being interviewed without written parental consent. As of the date of this filing, Coach Franks has not provided a direct written response to Item 5. The Parent Code of Conduct investigation continues. The District has not voluntarily reassigned the investigator nor addressed the recusal concerns informally despite the Complainant's documented good-faith attempts. |
| Please list the remedies you are seeking for this complaint: | (a) Immediate suspension of the Parent Code of Conduct investigation initiated June 9, 2026, pending recusal of Coach Franks and reassignment to a District employee who is not a subject of Complainant's pending complaints in any forum; (b) Written confirmation that no findings, statements, recordings, or other documents generated by Coach Franks in his capacity as investigator will be retained in any FISD personnel, student, or family file or shared with any other FISD office or external entity; (c) Disclosure in writing of the identity of all persons who provided the "additional information regarding your interactions with meet volunteers and officials" referenced in the June 9, 2026 investigation notice; (d) Written response to Item 5 of Complainant's June 11, 2026 response, specifically addressing whether the office conducting the investigation is aware of Complainant's other pending matters with the District and whether any coordination has occurred between offices; (e) Written assurance that no further retaliatory conduct will be taken against Complainant or Complainant's minor child by any District employee in any capacity in connection with any protected reporting by Complainant; (f) If the Parent Code of Conduct investigation is to proceed at all, written commitment that it will be reassigned to a District employee who: (i) is not a subject of any of Complainant's pending complaints; (ii) holds no governance role at North Texas Swimming or any other body where Complainant has filed a related complaint; and (iii) was not a recipient of any communication concerning Complainant's protected reporting prior to assignment; (g) Such other and further relief as the District deems appropriate under TEC Chapter 26A and FNG(LOCAL). |
| Do you wish to report additional incidents: | No |
| Will you be represented in voicing your complaint/appeal?: | No |

| | |
|---|---|
| Do you wish to Appeal this decision?: | Yes |
| Date you received the response to your complaint: | 7/20/2026 |
| Please explain specifically how you disagree with the findings: | Attached Summary |
| Please list the remedies you are seeking for this appeal: | Attached Summary |
| Will you be represented in voicing your appeal?: | No |

## Internal Information Only

| | |
|---|---|
| Policy Codes: | FNG\|FFH\| |
| Abated: | No |
| Abated Time Period: | Please enter date range such as 10/1/2020 - 11/2/2020 |
| Appeal of Prohibited Conduct Complete: | No |
| Investigator Name: | Deidra Rucker |
| Investigator Title: | Ast Athletic Director |
| Investigation Allegation Determination: | Unsubstantiated |
| Date of Findings Letter: | 7/20/2026 |
| Investigation Certified Mail Number: | |
| Name of Level I Hearing Officer: | U'i Womble |
| Title of Level I Hearing Officer: | Assistant Athletic Director |
| Date of Level I Conference: | 8/10/2026 |
| Level I Allegation Determination: | Unsubstantiated |
| Level I Remedy Acceptance: | Denied |
| Date of Level I Response: | 8/19/2026 |
| Level I Certified Mail Number: | |
| Date of First Appeal: | 7/21/2026 |
| Date Appeal Due: | 8/4/2026 |
| Name of Level II Hearing Officer: | Chris Burtch |
| Title of Level II Hearing Officer: | FISD Athletic Director |
| Level II Allegation Determination: | Unsubstantiated |
| Level II Remedy Acceptance: | Denied |
| Date of Level II Conference: | 8/26/2026 |
| Date of Level II Response: | 9/14/2026 |
| Level II Certified Mail Number: | |

## Message History

Date

On 6/15/2026 8:13:46 PM, System Generated Message:
**Subject:** Complaint :: Z005911-061526
**Body:**

FRISCO INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

Confirmation of Complaint

Complaint #Z005911-061526

This email serves as confirmation that the below referenced complaint was submitted on June 15, 2026. **PLEASE NOTE: If your complaint was submitted after 4:30pm or on a non-District business day, it will be received in our offices on the next business day.**

Upon receipt, your complaint will be processed in accordance with applicable Frisco ISD Board Policy and Complaint Procedures. The reference number for your complaint is **Z005911-061526**.

Your complaint will be assigned to a hearing officer or investigator, as appropriate, who will contact you within 10 District business days of the receipt of your complaint.

Please click the "REQUEST CENTER" button below to view and track the progress of your request. If you have any questions, you may reply directly to this email.

REQUEST CENTER

COMPLAINT DETAILS

**Complainant:** Stephen Jordan

**Complaint Submission Date:** June 15, 2026

**Type of Complaint:** Student/Parent Complaint

**Complaint Reference Number:** Z005911-061526

Powered by GovQA

On 6/15/2026 8:13:45 PM, Stephen Jordan wrote:
Request Created on Public Portal

**Request Details**

| | |
|---|---|
| Reference No: | Z005911-061526 |
| Create Date: | 6/15/2026 8:13 PM |
| Update Date: | 9/15/2026 9:41 AM |
| Completed/Closed: | No |
| Required Completion Date: | 6/15/2026 |
| Status: | Response Sent |
| Priority: | High |
| Assigned Dept: | Admin- Athletics |
| Assigned Staff: | Chris Burtch |

| | |
|---|---|
| Customer Name: | Stephen Jordan |
| Email Address: | srjordan@gmail.com |
| Phone: | 9724031231 |
| Group: | Complaints |
| Source: | Web |

**FRISCO INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT**
**LEVEL I FORMAL COMPLAINT / GRIEVANCE**
**PURSUANT TO BOARD POLICY FNG(LOCAL) AND TEC CHAPTER 26A**

Filed: June 15, 2026

Complainant: Stephen Ray Jordan

Subject: Retaliation Against Parent For Protected Reporting; Misconduct in Initiating and Conducting Parent Code of Conduct Investigation

## I. STATEMENT OF COMPLAINT

**1.** Complainant Stephen Ray Jordan files this Level I formal grievance under Frisco Independent School District Board Policy FNG(LOCAL) and Texas Education Code Chapter 26A. This grievance is separate and distinct from the existing matter currently on appeal before the Texas Commissioner of Education in Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District.

**2.** This grievance alleges that the District, through specific named employees, has engaged in conduct prohibited by Texas Education Code §26A.001(e)(1), by Board Policy FNG(LOCAL), and by §26.011(a). Specifically, this grievance alleges that the District has initiated and is conducting a Parent Code of Conduct investigation against Complainant in retaliation for Complainant's protected reporting under the District's grievance process and through other authorized reporting channels.

**3.** This grievance further alleges that the District has compounded the retaliation by assigning, as the investigator of the Parent Code of Conduct matter, a District employee who is the direct supervisor of two coaches named in Complainant's prior protected reporting, who is himself a named subject of an active USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant, and who has a documented governance conflict of interest at the regional swimming governance body where Iron Horse Aquatics is registered.

## II. PARTIES

**4.** Complainant: Stephen Ray Jordan, parent of a minor child enrolled at Frisco Independent School District and participating in the Iron Horse Aquatics competitive swim program. Address:

13054 Cinderella Lane, Frisco, Texas 75035. Email: srjordan@gmail.com. Telephone: 972.403.1231.

**5.** Respondent: Frisco Independent School District.

**6.** District employees whose conduct is the subject of this grievance and who must recuse under TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FNG(LOCAL):

(a) Matthew Franks, Head Club Swim Coach and Assistant Natatorium Manager, who issued the Parent Code of Conduct investigation notice on June 9, 2026 and designated himself as the investigator;

(b) Melissa Howard, FISD Swim and Dive Coordinator, named subject of the original Lighthouse Services ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant on June 9, 2026, and recipient of the June 9, 2026 investigation notice;

(c) Daiki Sato, Iron Horse Aquatics coach, named subject of the original Lighthouse Services ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant on June 9, 2026, and recipient of the June 9, 2026 investigation notice;

(d) Justin Bilgri, Iron Horse Aquatics head coach, named subject of the original Lighthouse Services ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant on June 9, 2026;

(e) Deidra Rucker, Associate Director of Athletics, who issued the May 18, 2026 Level II response in the original grievance;

(f) Shelley Anderson, Complaint Resolution Coordinator, who issued the May 20, 2026 letter dismissing the Level III appeal;

(g) Esther Kolni, General Counsel, who issued the May 21, 2026 email refusing Level III review through the appropriate forum.

## III. STATEMENT OF FACTS

**7.** On February 26, 2026, Complainant filed an ethics report with Frisco Independent School District through Lighthouse Services, Report Number 9022620263313, identifying conduct by

Iron Horse Aquatics coaching staff including Justin Bilgri and Daiki Sato. This report is a protected report under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and Board Policy FNG(LOCAL).

**8.** Between February 26, 2026 and May 22, 2026, Complainant pursued the District's grievance process through Levels I, II, and a Level III appeal filing through the District GovQA portal. The grievance addresses the absence of published advancement criteria within Iron Horse Aquatics and related procedural concerns.

**9.** On May 22, 2026, Complainant filed a Texas Public Information Act request, Reference Number W005772-052226, seeking District correspondence related to Complainant and the grievance proceedings. The District's cost estimate response identified 515 emails responsive to the request. Complainant accepted the cost estimate and the deposit is in transit to the District.

**10.** On Tuesday, June 9, 2026, at 4:35 PM Central Time, Matthew Franks, Head Club Swim Coach and Assistant Natatorium Manager, sent Complainant an email titled "Report of Conduct at the NWAA Team Travel Meet." The email announced that the District would conduct an investigation into Complainant's conduct as a potential violation of the Parent Code of Conduct. Coach Franks designated himself as the investigator and requested a phone conversation with Complainant.

**11.** The June 9, 2026 investigation notice from Coach Franks was sent with copies to Melissa Howard and Daiki Sato, both of whom are named subjects of the underlying Lighthouse ethics report referenced in Paragraph 7.

**12.** Approximately two hours after Coach Franks issued the investigation notice, on the same date of June 9, 2026, Complainant filed four Code of Conduct complaints with USA Swimming through the national Violation Reporting Form. The four complaints named Justin Bilgri, Daiki Sato, Melissa Howard, and Matthew Franks. The complaint against Coach Franks specifically addressed his supervisory role over Bilgri and Sato, his governance conflict of interest at the North Texas Swimming Local Swim Committee where he serves as Operational Risk Coordinator while coaching at a member club under complaint, and concerns regarding his role in the chain of communication leading to the District's adverse administrative actions against Complainant.

**13.** On June 9, 2026 at 6:32 PM, Complainant filed a Petition for Review with the Texas Education Agency Division of Hearings and Appeals in the matter of Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District. The Petition was served on the District's General Counsel by email at 6:35 PM the same day.

**14.** On June 9, 2026 at 8:08 PM, Complainant received written acknowledgment from [redacted] confirming receipt of all four USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaints, including the complaint against Coach Franks.

**15.** On June 10, 2026 at 12:46 PM and 12:48 PM, Complainant received written acknowledgment from [redacted], of the LSC notifications regarding the four USA Swimming Code of Conduct filings. Dayoub's acknowledgment specifically referenced "governance and potential conflict-of-interest considerations" and was copied to [redacted] and to the full North Texas Swimming Board of Directors, which includes Coach Franks in his role as Operational Risk Coordinator.

**16.** On June 11, 2026, Complainant submitted a written response to the conduct investigation notice that included a specific question, identified as Item 5, asking whether the office conducting the investigation was aware of Complainant's other pending matters with the District and whether any coordination had occurred between offices.

**17.** On approximately June 12, 2026, Coach Franks responded to Complainant's June 11 written response. The Franks response did not address Item 5 of Complainant's response. Coach Franks's response indicated that statements would be collected from Iron Horse staff members who attended the meet.

**18.** On approximately June 13, 2026, Complainant submitted a second written response to Coach Franks renewing the request for a direct written response to Item 5, requesting identification of all interviewees, disclosing for the record the pendency of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaints involving multiple Iron Horse Aquatics coaches, and protecting Complainant's minor child from being interviewed without written parental consent.

**19.** As of the date of this grievance, Coach Franks has not provided a direct written response to Item 5. The Parent Code of Conduct investigation, initiated and conducted by Coach Franks

while he is himself a named subject of an active USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant, continues.

## IV. STATUTORY AND POLICY GROUNDS

**20.** Texas Education Code §26A.001(e)(1). The District is statutorily required to adopt a grievance policy that prohibits retaliation against a student or parent for participating in a grievance. The conduct described in Paragraphs 7 through 19 constitutes retaliation against Complainant for protected reporting through the District's own grievance process, through Lighthouse Services, through the Texas Public Information Act, and through USA Swimming Code of Conduct procedures.

**21.** FNG(LOCAL), page 3. The District's Board-adopted grievance policy, on its face, provides that "Neither the Board nor any District employee shall unlawfully retaliate against any student or parent for bringing a concern or complaint." The conduct described above violates this provision directly.

**22.** Texas Education Code §26.011(a). The Board is required to address grievances concerning violations of board policy and provisions of Title 2 of the Texas Education Code. This grievance alleges violations of both, defeating any potential extracurricular carve-out under §26.011(b).

**23.** Texas Education Code §26A.001(e)(2). The District's grievance policy must require recusal of any person who is a subject of a complaint. Coach Franks, the named investigator of the Parent Code of Conduct matter, is himself the subject of a pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant on June 9, 2026, addressing the same chain of communication and the same supervisory relationships at issue in the Parent Code of Conduct investigation. Coach Franks's assignment as investigator violates the recusal requirement on its face.

**24.** FNG(LOCAL), page 5. The District's Board-adopted policy provides that "When a District employee is the subject of a complaint, the hearing shall be conducted by an administrator who is in a supervisory or higher organizational role. The District employee who is the subject of the complaint shall recuse themselves from reviewing the complaint at any level in the process." The District has violated this provision by assigning Coach Franks to investigate a

matter in which he is himself a subject of an active and pending complaint by Complainant in a parallel forum.

**25.** Disclosure breach. The June 9, 2026 investigation notice was copied to Melissa Howard and Daiki Sato, both named subjects of Complainant's prior protected reporting. The cc'ing of named subjects on a notice initiating an investigation against the parent who reported them is, at minimum, a breach of investigative confidentiality and an indicator that the investigation is being conducted in coordination with subjects of Complainant's prior protected reporting rather than independently.

## V. REQUIRED RECUSALS

**26.** Pursuant to TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FNG(LOCAL) page 5, the following District employees must recuse from any role in the review, hearing, or decision of this grievance:

(a) Matthew Franks. Subject of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant; named investigator of the Parent Code of Conduct matter at issue.

(b) Melissa Howard. Named subject of Complainant's original Lighthouse ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint.

(c) Daiki Sato. Named subject of Complainant's original Lighthouse ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint.

(d) Justin Bilgri. Named subject of Complainant's original Lighthouse ethics report and of pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint.

(e) Deidra Rucker. Issued the Level II response in the existing grievance now on appeal at the Texas Education Agency; the conduct described in this grievance arose during and following her involvement in the underlying matter.

(f) Shelley Anderson. Issued the May 20, 2026 letter dismissing the Level III appeal in the existing grievance now on appeal at the Texas Education Agency.

(g) Esther Kolni. Issued the May 21, 2026 email refusing Level III review in the existing grievance now on appeal at the Texas Education Agency.

**27.** The District is required under FNG(LOCAL) to assign this grievance to a hearing officer who has no involvement in the matters described above and who is in a supervisory or higher organizational role relative to the named subjects.

## VI. RELIEF SOUGHT

**28.** Complainant respectfully requests the following relief:

(a) Immediate suspension of the Parent Code of Conduct investigation initiated June 9, 2026, pending recusal of Coach Franks and reassignment to a District employee who is not a subject of Complainant's pending complaints in any forum;

(b) Written confirmation that no findings, statements, recordings, or other documents generated by Coach Franks in his capacity as investigator will be retained in any FISD personnel, student, or family file, or shared with any other FISD office or external entity;

(c) Disclosure in writing of the identity of all persons who provided the "additional information regarding your interactions with meet volunteers and officials" referenced in the June 9, 2026 investigation notice;

(d) Written response to Item 5 of Complainant's June 11, 2026 response, specifically addressing whether the office conducting the investigation is aware of Complainant's other pending matters with the District and whether any coordination has occurred between offices;

(e) Written assurance that no further retaliatory conduct will be taken against Complainant or Complainant's minor child by any District employee, in any capacity, in connection with any protected reporting by Complainant;

(f) If the Parent Code of Conduct investigation is to proceed at all, written commitment that it will be reassigned to a District employee who: (i) is not a subject of any of Complainant's pending complaints; (ii) holds no governance role at North Texas Swimming or any other body where Complainant has filed a related complaint; and (iii) was not a recipient of any communication concerning Complainant's protected reporting prior to assignment;

(g) Such other and further relief as the District deems appropriate under TEC Chapter 26A and FNG(LOCAL).

## VII. RESERVATION OF RIGHTS

**29.** This Level I grievance is filed without prejudice to and does not waive any of the following:

(a) The pending Petition for Review in Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District before the Texas Commissioner of Education;

(b) The pending Texas Public Information Act records request, Reference Number W005772-052226;

(c) The pending USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaints involving Justin Bilgri, Daiki Sato, Melissa Howard, and Matthew Franks;

(d) The pending Lighthouse Services ethics report, Report Number 9022620263313;

(e) Any future right of appeal at Level II, Level III, or to the Texas Commissioner of Education arising from this grievance;

(f) Any other legal or administrative action arising from the matters described in this grievance.

## VIII. FILING INFORMATION

**30.** This grievance is filed through the District's GovQA electronic submission portal in accordance with FNG(LOCAL) and is contemporaneously transmitted by electronic mail to the Office of the General Counsel and to the Complaint Resolution Coordinator.

**31.** Complainant requests that confirmation of receipt and the assigned reference number be provided in writing within three business days.

**32.** Complainant further requests that the District identify, in writing, the District employee assigned to serve as the Level I hearing officer for this grievance, prior to the scheduling of any hearing, so that any recusal concerns may be raised in advance.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Stephen Ray Jordan

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se Complainant

13054 Cinderella Lane

Frisco, Texas 75035

Telephone: 972.403.1231

Email: srjordan@gmail.com

Dated: June 15, 2026

**DOCUMENTS RELIED UPON**

The following documents are referenced in this grievance and are part of the record:

1. Lighthouse Services Report Number 9022620263313, filed February 26, 2026;

2. Frisco ISD Level I grievance file in the original matter, including written objection to the assignment of Coach Howard as hearing officer;

3. Frisco ISD Level II response signed by Deidra Rucker, dated May 18, 2026;

4. Letter from Shelley Anderson, Complaint Resolution Coordinator, dated May 20, 2026;

5. Email from Esther Kolni, General Counsel, dated May 21, 2026;

6. Email from Matthew Franks, dated June 9, 2026, 4:35 PM, titled "Report of Conduct at the NWAA Team Travel Meet";

7. Complainant's written response to Matthew Franks, dated June 11, 2026;

8. Matthew Franks's reply, dated approximately June 12, 2026;

9. Complainant's second written response to Matthew Franks, dated approximately June 13, 2026;

10. Petition for Review filed with the Texas Education Agency, June 9, 2026, 6:32 PM;

11. USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint submissions, June 9, 2026, with USA Swimming acknowledgment received 8:08 PM the same day;

12. North Texas Swimming notifications dated June 9 and June 10, 2026, with [redacted] acknowledgments dated June 10, 2026.

# EXHIBIT B

# Swim Team Handbook

## Table of Contents


1. Team Mission
2. Program Goals
3. Coaches
4. Program Duration
5. Training Groups
6. Fees, Payments and Withdrawals
7. Team Communication
8. Volunteer Opportunities
9. Meet Participation and Entries
10. Team Apparel
11. Coach, Athlete, Parent Code of Conduct, Grievance Process
12. Annual Photo Opt-Out
13. Social Media Expectations

## Team Mission

Iron Horse Aquatics is a USA club swimming program. Our first priority is to meet the needs of the athlete(s) by focusing on discipline, integrity and accountability. Our goal is to mold young athletes to become who they envision themselves to be.

We truly believe it takes a strong community of coaches, trainers, educators and administrators to develop great athlete(s) but more importantly extraordinary people.

## Program Goals

- Professional, high quality coaching
- Providing a safe, exciting and challenging environment where athletes of every ability can grow to their fullest potential
- Personal investment in the success & growth of every athlete as a competitor and leader
- Teaching the importance of character, goal setting & time management
- Becoming one of the premier club teams in the state of Texas and the nation.

## Coaches

Iron Horse Aquatics brings together a strong and dedicated group of swimming professionals to provide high-quality instruction in a competitive, safe and nurturing environment for our swimmers to grow and improve as athletes and individuals. Our goal each year is to be better in every aspect than we were in the previous year. We expect our team of coaches to strive for greatness.

Please respect our coaches while they are on deck with our swimmers. **Parents are not allowed on the pool deck during practices.** Our coaching staff is available via email for communication with parents. Each coach can be reached via emails (found on the meet the coaches page of our website in each coach's profile). Coaches will be expected to respond to parent communication in a timely manner.

# Program Duration

Iron Horse Aquatics offers year-round training for our competitive swimmers. There are two traditional competitive seasons in the sport of swimming, short course season (Mid-August – Mid March) and long course season (April through early August). The Natatorium will close during the school district's week of Spring Break, again in August for pool maintenance, and for several days during the Christmas break. The scheduling of these breaks is very important for our swimmers. It gives the high school kids a break following their scholastic competitive season, and gives the younger swimmers a break after summer competitions. Our swimmers will take a one week break over spring break in March, a two week break in August, and several days around Christmas day during the December Holiday break. Since tuition is based on monthly membership, rather than the number of weekly practices, tuition will not be prorated during these breaks.

# Training Groups

Iron Horse Aquatics provides a safe, positive and productive instructional environment for all ages and abilities. We believe in developing our athletes to be able to compete in every event in the spectrum and feel that training for our 12 & Under athletes should be focused on helping them excel in the 200 IM and 500 freestyle and our 13 & over athletes in the 400 IM and the 1000 freestyle. Emphasizing success in these events helps to ensure that we are maintaining focus on long-term development while allowing our athletes to be able to be competitive in every event at every distance from a young age giving them the most opportunities for success.

## **Engine** (4 workouts per week; 60 minutes)

**Practices:** 4x per week (Monday,Tuesday, Wednesday and Friday)
**Duration:** 1 hour per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $120
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 10& under

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Legal 100 freestyle, 100 backstroke, 100 breaststroke, 50 butterfly
  - Legal flip turns and finishes
  - Legal underwater breaststroke pullout
  - Legal 100 IM
  - Swim and kick continuously for 10 minutes
  - Focus on understanding how to use the pace clock during interval-based sets
  - Expected to maintain a minimum 70% practice attendance and attend at least 1 meet per month

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least one meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Long Fins (any brand please visit Xtreme Swim)
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles

## Iron (5 workouts per week; 60 minutes)

**Practices:** 5x per week (Monday, Tuesday,Wednesday, Friday and Saturday)
**Duration:** 1 hour per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $125
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 6-10

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Legal 100 freestyle, 100 backstroke, 100 breaststroke, 50 butterfly
  - Legal flip turns and finishes
  - Legal underwater breaststroke pullout
  - Legal 200 IM
  - Focus on understanding how to use the pace clock during interval-based sets.
  - Expected to maintain a minimum 70% practice attendance and attend at least 1 meet per month
  - "B" times and "BB" times

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least one meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Long Fins (any brand please visit Xtreme Swim)
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (16oz minimum)

## Bronze 1 (5 workouts per week+ drylands; 60 minutes;)

**Practices:** 5x per week (Monday-Friday)
**Duration:** 1 hour per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $140
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 9-10

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- *Will work on stroke refinement and proficiency in all 4 strokes*

- Goal is to be able to successfully complete 100 yards of at least 3 out of 4 strokes
- Swimmers will be introduced to more advanced stroke drill progressions
- Be able to consistently train on intervals and develop being self sufficient running on intervals
- Continue to develop coordination and overall physical fitness
- Train them to successfully complete IM Ready Events (100 Free, 50 Back, 50 Breast, 50 Fly, 100 IM).
- Expected to maintain a minimum 70% practice attendance and attend at least 1 meet per month.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least one meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Long Fins (any brand please visit Xtreme Swim)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (20oz minimum)

## **Bronze 2** (4 workouts per week offered; 60 minutes long)

**Practices:** 5x per week (Monday-Friday)
**Duration:** 1 hour per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $140
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 11-12

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- *Will work on stroke refinement and proficiency in all 4 strokes*
- Goal is to be able to successfully complete 100 yards of at least 3 out of 4 strokes
- Swimmers will be introduced to more advanced stroke drill progressions
- Be able to consistently train on intervals and develop being self sufficient running on intervals
- Continue to develop coordination and overall physical fitness
- Train them to successfully complete IM Ready Events (100 Free, 50 Back, 50 Breast, 50 Fly, 100 IM).
- Expected to maintain a minimum 70% practice attendance and attend at least 1 meet per month.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least one meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Long Fins (any brand please visit Xtreme Swim)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (20oz minimum)

## **Silver** (6 workouts per week offered + drylands; 75 minutes long; minimum attendance 75%)

**Practices:** 6x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 75 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $150
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 10-12

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Learning seasonal training progressions
- Increased intensity and strict interval training
- Intro to specific seasonal goal setting
- Understanding of pace + race strategy
- Distance Training & Racing prioritized
- Train to successfully complete IMX Events (200 Free, 100 Back, 100 Breast, 100 Fly, 200 IM)+ 500FR/400M FR, 400IM and others
- Expected to swim all races throughout the season and available for relays at meets
- Expected to maintain a minimum 80% practice attendance (including saturday practice) and attend all Silver group mandatory meets
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles

## **Gold** (6 workouts per week offered + drylands; 90 minutes long minimum attendance 85%)

**Practices:** 6x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 90 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $160
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range:** 11-14

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Our top Age Group training group (minimum A/BB times with goal on developing TAGS level athletes)
- Focused on developing short-term & long-term goals
- Building more advanced race strategies for sprint / mid-distance / distance races
- Emphasis on developing elite turns and underwater dolphin kicks off the blocks and throughout the race
- Priority is placed on teaching and encouraging our athletes to race events over 200 yards to better prepare them for long-term success in the sport.
- Train to successfully complete IMX Events (200 Free, 100 Back, 100 Breast, 100 Fly, 200 IM)+ 500FR/400M FR, 400IM and others
- Expected to swim all races throughout the season and available for relays at meets




- Minimum 80% Attendance required and must attend all Gold mandatory meets.
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.
- ***Invitation by Head Age Group Coach ONLY.***

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Tempo Trainer
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (24oz minimum)

## **Platinum** (6 workouts per week + drylands; 90 minutes long, minimum 85% attendance)

**Practices:** 6x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 90 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $170
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range: Minimum age 12** ***Invitation ONLY.***

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Introduction to SR training group (minimum A/BB times with goal on developing TAGS level athletes).
- Athletes with aspirations to move into SR1 and beyond.
- In depth discussions about stroke technique and catering to more personalized needs
- Athletes will be expected to race all events from 1650 and down, as well as 100s&200s of strokes, 200IM and 400IM.
- Seasonal & Event goal setting and mental preparation for racing.
- Expected to swim all races throughout the season and available for relays at meets
- Minimum 85% Attendance required and must attend all Platinum mandatory meets.
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet sessions that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Tempo Trainer
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (32oz minimum beverage with electrolytes)

## Sr Development (5 workouts per week; 80 minutes)

**Practices:** 5x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 80 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $150
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range: Minimum age 12**

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- For developmental 13&O athletes who aspire to swim in HS.
- Focused on creating goals.
- Emphasis on refining stroke technique and developing well-rounded athletes.
- Building racing strategies for traditional HS events
- Priority is placed on encouraging athletes to race the 500 freestyle and down and all strokes of 50s and 100s.
- This group allows for the swimmers who have multiple activities outside of swimming to be able to pursue both.
- Expected to maintain a minimum 75% practice attendance (including saturday practice) and attend all SR Development group mandatory meets
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least one meet session that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (32oz minimum beverage with electrolytes)

## Sr Prep (6 workouts per week + drylands; 90 minutes; minimum attendance 80%)

**Practices:** 6x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 90 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition:** $170
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range: Minimum age 15 *Invitation ONLY.***

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Introduction to SR training group (minimum A/BB times with goal on developing TAGS level athletes).
- Athletes with aspirations to move into SR1 and beyond.
- In depth discussions about stroke technique and catering to more personalized needs
- Athletes will be expected to race all events from 1650 and down, as well as 100s&200s of strokes, 200IM and 400IM.
- Seasonal & Event goal setting and mental preparation for racing.
- Expected to swim all races throughout the season and available for relays at meets
- Minimum 85% Attendance required and must attend all SRP mandatory meets.
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet sessions that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Tempo Trainer
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (32oz minimum beverage with electrolytes)

## **Sr1** (6 workouts per week + drylands; 90 to 120 minutes ; minimum attendance 85%)

**Practices:** 6x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 90-120 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition**: $180
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center
**Age Range: Minimum age 13** ***Invitation ONLY.***

**Coach:** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Designed for 13 & over athletes who have committed to the sport and want to build into TAGS, Sectional, and National level competitors
- Enhanced goal setting expectations with mental preparation to best prepare the athlete for success at high level competitions
- Breath work, race specific breathing and cycle counts
- 1 distance freestyle workout per week
- 1 mid-distance/distance IM workout per week
- 2 stroke workouts per week (1 pace based / 1 racing)
- 1 freestyle speed workouts per week
- Expected to swim all races throughout the season and available for relays at meets
- Minimum 85% Attendance required and must attend all SR1 mandatory meets.
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet sessions that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Tempo Trainer
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (32oz minimum beverage with electrolytes)

## **Sr Elite** (8 workouts per week + drylands; 90 to 120 minutes long; minimum 95% attendance)

**Practices:** 8x per week (Monday-Saturday)+ 2-3 times per week dryland
**Duration:** 90-120 minutes per practice (2026 Spring Practice Schedule)
**Monthly Tuition**: $200
**Location:** Bruce Eubanks Natatorium or FISD Swim Center

**Age Range:** ***Invitation by Head Coach ONLY.***

**Coach** [redacted]

**Group Goals & Expectations:**

- Our highest training groups these senior level swimmers are committed to developing to their fullest potential and are focused on achieving the highest level of success in both High School and Club swimming.
- Swimmers in these groups compete on a Sectional, National and International level.
- Advanced training and aggressive goal setting set the bar high and participants are expected to make all scheduled workouts. This group has a more extensive meet and travel meet schedule.
- Minimum 90% Attendance required and must attend all SR Elite mandatory meets.
- Dryland attendance will also be counted towards overall attendance requirements.

**Parent Expectations:**

- Parents will be expected to volunteer at least two meet sessions that their athlete(s) are participating in (if applicable)

**Required Equipment:**

- Arena Kickboard
- Arena Buoy
- Arena Powerfin Pro
- Arena paddles (one size bigger than their hands)
- Arena Snorkel
- Arena Mesh bag
- Tempo Trainer
- Swim Cap and Goggles
- Water (32oz minimum beverage with electrolytes)

## Fees, Payments and Withdrawals

The registration fee for new athletes in the competitive programs is **$250**. This fee includes: Three Iron Horse Aquatics t-shirts, One silicone Iron Horse Aquatics team cap, and 1st months dues. All returning members will have be billed a returning member registration fee to cover administrative costs and the cost of new team t-shirts each August.

The registration fee will be collected at the time of registration. The monthly training fees will be charged in twelve (12) installments to your credit card or bank draft monthly beginning in August. Bills for each account are posted on the 15th of each month and updated throughout the month with meet fees, etc. Withdrawals will be made on or about the 1st of each month.

## FISD Employee / Multi-Swimmer Discount

Athletes whose parent(s) are full-time employees of Frisco ISD will receive the month of August off of monthly dues. Families with 3 or more swimmers will receive 10% off their total monthly dues.

## Payment Options

Families have the option to pay their fees to Iron Horse Aquatics with a credit card. If payment is declined or there are insufficient funds to complete payment there will be a $25 service fee charged to the account balance.

## Withdrawals

If a swimmer needs to withdraw for any reason, the parent or guardian must provide written notification 30 days prior to the next billing cycle (1st of the month). If written notification of intent to withdraw is not provided, the family remains responsible for tuition and fees. Iron Horse Aquatic Club Members who withdraw and request reinstatement within a 12 month period will incur a $100.00 reinstatement fee per child.

## Penalties

## PRACTICE COACH WAITING FEE

If a member of the coaching staff waits for more than 20 minutes past the end of practice for a parent or guardian to pick up their child after a team practice, the family will be assessed a $75 waiting fee. This charge will be placed on their Team Unify account.

## UNAUTHORIZED MEET PARTICIPATION PENALTY

Iron Horse Aquatics is a **TEAM**. We provide a robust meet schedule to allow for ample competition opportunities. There will be a $100.00 penalty fee assessed to each swimmer entering a meet(s) not listed on the Iron Horse Aquatics Schedule posted online without prior approval of the Head Coach. A $200.00 penalty fee will be assessed to each swimmer entering as an unattached swimmer into meet(s) not listed on the Iron Horse Aquatics Schedule posted online. High School swimmers are not restricted in their participation in meets with their High School programs.

## MAKE UP POLICY

Iron Horse Aquatics is not able to offer "make up workouts" for workouts missed due to schedule conflicts or illness. Our program has a limited number of spaces. Each swimmer

reserves their space in the group. Swimmers may request a make up workout from their coach, but are not permitted to attend an unscheduled workout without permission. If space is available, coaches may use their discretion to allow a swimmer to attend an alternative workout. Please note that we will not allow makeup practice in any workout where additional swimmers will compromise the integrity of the workout in place.

## PRACTICE CANCELLATION DUE TO WEATHER

If the facility of your child's practice group is open and it is not a scheduled Iron Horse Aquatics holiday, practice will be conducted. At times, due to extreme weather, Iron Horse Aquatics will cancel practice in alignment with FISD weather closures as dictated by the Athletic Department. We will communicate any cancellations via the Team SportsYou page and social media accounts. As a school district run program

## TEAM COMMUNICATIONS

All registered swimming families should provide at least one email address to Iron Horse Aquatics. Important team communications will come via email as well as via SportsYou post. Coaches will send out regular group updates to their groups specific SportsYou group page. This will include information about upcoming meets and events, practice changes and cancellations, and team news.

Iron Horse Aquatics will also responsibly use social media as a means of disseminating information and celebrating our athlete's achievements. The team has an official Instagram account **@IronHorseAquatics,** a Facebook group Page (search Iron Horse Aquatics) and a SportsYou page **Iron Horse Aquatics**. This is a great way to celebrate our team, amazing athletes and incredible coaches, while growing our presence in the community, as well as showing our athletes how to responsibly use social media.

The most important link in the swimmer, coach, and parent triangle is the parent-coach communication line. Iron Horse Aquatics uses a wide variety of tools to communicate with our families. However, if any questions or problem should arise, the lines of communication between the coaches and parents are always open. Feel free to email your coach or our staff about problems or suggestions concerning your swimmer. It is very important that you let us know if there is anything we can do to aid your swimmer. The more insight coaches have regarding their athletes, the more effectively they will be able to influence and assist in their enjoyment of the

sport. This will help the athlete realize greater levels of success. It is best to communicate with the coach most directly involved with your athlete's training.

## Iron Horse Aquatics Website and Team Unify

ironhorseaquatics.net is the address of our team website. It contains recent team news and is often updated weekly during the season. The site has upcoming meet information, as well as information on each of our pools including staff and practice schedule, team records, various time standards and a lot more. Be sure to add it to your bookmarks! Our TEAM UNIFY website is used for MEMBER ONLY information, including billing, meet sign-up, and much more. Please take the time to become familiar with what the website can do for you and ask your coach if you are having difficulty finding information.

## Volunteer Opportunities

Volunteers can be a great asset to any organization and can help enrich all aspects of our program. Family participation is necessary to ensure the continued success of the team. Throughout a family's association with Iron Horse Aquatics, we would appreciate your support of the team through volunteer activities.

**Officiating**: Iron Horse Aquatics and North Texas Swimming sponsor periodic clinics to certify officials in the U.S.A.S. program, and we encourage our parents to attend these clinics. Levels of certification include stroke and turn judge, starter, and referee. With the number of meets each year and the quality of competition at these meets, it is essential to have a large contingent of qualified officials. Officials who work Iron Horse Aquatics meets (in the entirety) which are held at the FISD Natatorium will receive a bill credit for every session worked, commensurate with the job they fulfilled.

### *Parent Volunteering Responsibility*

When Iron Horse Aquatics hosts swim meets at FISD Natatorium we make every effort to ensure that all meets are well-staffed, run on schedule, and that our visitors enjoy themselves. The Head Coach and Director of Competitive Swimming will delegate responsibility to a Meet Director for each meet, which in turn depends on the help of many volunteers. The system is designed to ensure that every member of the team contributes. This assures that Iron Horse Aquatics can host

the very best meets at our facility. Swimmers who compete at an Iron Horse Aquatics meet hosted at the FISD Natatorium are required to have someone volunteer in some capacity for at least one session during the meet. Swimmers who commit to attend meets hosted by Iron Horse Aquatics but do not have a family volunteer to assist at the meet may be removed from Iron Horse Aquatics hosted swim meets. For a description of volunteer roles at a swim meet please click here

## Meet Participation / Entries

All competitive swimmers with Iron Horse Aquatics are encouraged to participate in meets each month. We offer approximately one meet per month for our team. This is an opportunity for swimmers to see the benefits of their training, experience the full competitive experience of their sport and connect with their teammates from our site.

Meet announcements are posted on the Iron Horse Aquatics website under the upcoming events on the main page. Prior to confirming participation, please read the information under the notes and read the entire meet announcement first. The meet announcement will include information about the date, location, events, entry limits, and possible timeline for the meet. Each meet is different, so please read each announcement carefully. Families will have the opportunity to commit to attending or decline participation in a meet.

All registrations for meets are done using the TEAM UNIFY system. This is the same account that you used to register for the team. Once you have logged into the system, you will need to declare you are participating in the meet. Once you declare for the meet, the meet events for which your swimmer is qualified will automatically pop up. Click on the events you would like to swim. Remember to hit save or your entry will not be saved in the system.

**If your swimmer is not qualified for a meet, you do not need to indicate they are not attending**.

Once your entries are in the system the coaches will review them. They will either approve or reject them. If a swimmer's events are "rejected" the coach will select another event for the swimmer. The day after the entry deadline an Entry Report will be posted in the "Meets" page on TEAMUNIFY. Once entries are submitted to the host team NO changes or additions can be made. Check the Entry Report as soon as it's available to make sure that your swimmer is in the correct events.

If an athlete has not declined participation by the close of the team registration date the coach WILL enter the athlete in the meet.

## Iron Horse Aquatics Team Apparel

### TEAM SUIT

To build a complete Iron Horse Aquatics culture, we require swimmers to wear a team suit when attending all competitive meets that are not considered "tech suit" meets by the Iron Horse Aquatics coaching staff. Tech suits may only be worn at championship meets.

### TEAM T-SHIRTS

All team members will receive three (3) team shirts as a part of their annual team registration fees. These are the shirts that will be worn to all meets and team activities. To ensure the team has a uniform look at all meets, the shirts will be worn in the following order… Gray on the first day of the meet, Royal Blue on the second day of the meet, Black on the third day of the meet.

### IRON HORSE AQUATICS APPAREL VENDOR

Iron Horse Aquatics is an Arena sponsored team. All Iron Horse Aquatics apparel will be available exclusively through Xtreme Swim. Each Iron Horse swimmer will receive a team cap with their registration. These caps are required to be worn at all competitions. All Iron Horse Aquatics Swimmers are required to have an Iron Horse Team Suit with the Iron Horse Logo. - NO EXCEPTIONS.

*Championship suits* (Powerskin, Evo, Carbon, Carbon Glide, Carbon Air etc.) will be permitted to be worn at CHAMPIONSHIP meets ONLY- NO EXCEPTIONS.

***Championship meet suits do not have to have the Iron Horse logo.***

## Coach Code of Conduct

The purpose of this code of conduct for coaches is to establish common expectations for all members of the coaching staff of the club. It is to be used as a guide to promote a positive team environment and good sportsmanship.

❏ At all times, adhere to USA Swimming's rules and code of conduct.
❏ Set a good example of respect and sportsmanship for participants and fans to follow.
❏ Act and dress with professionalism and dignity in a manner suitable to his/her profession.
❏ Respect officials and their judgment and abide by the rules of the event.
❏ Treat opposing coaches, participants, and spectators with respect.
❏ Instruct participants in sportsmanship and demand that they display good sportsmanship.
❏ Coach in a positive manner and do not use derogatory comments or abusive language.
❏ Win with humility and lose with dignity.
❏ Treat every athlete fairly, justly, impartially, intelligently, and with sensitivity.
❏ Always place the well-being, health, and safety of swimmers above all other considerations, including developing performance.
❏ Continue to seek and maintain their own professional development in all areas in relation to coaching and teaching children.
❏ Always maintain a professional separation between coach and athlete. Any complaints of a coach violating this code of conduct will be brought to the attention of his/her supervisor and/or the director of Competitive Swimming for Frisco ISD.

Coach's Name (Print): _____
Coach's Signature (Sign): _____ Date: _____
Witness (Sign): _____ Date: _____

# Athlete Code of Conduct

I, the undersigned athlete, participating in training and competition with Iron Horse Aquatics, understand and agree to comply with the below-listed guidelines as set forth by Iron Horse Aquatics and Frisco Independent School District. Any additional guidelines may be established in writing by the Head Coach.

**General Behavior**

1. Iron Horse swimmers will display proper respect and sportsmanship towards coaches, officials, administrators, competitors, teammates and the public to include both their person and their property.
    a. I will arrive on time to all practices and meets.
    b. I will ensure that I am mentally prepared to train and compete.
    c. I will be supportive and encouraging to my teammates at all times.
    d. I will set a good example of behavior and work ethic for younger teammates.
2. The transportation, possession or use of alcohol, tobacco products, or illegal drugs by any Iron Horse team member is prohibited.
3. Illegal and inappropriate behavior that will reflect negatively on Iron Horse Aquatics and/or Frisco ISD, or be detrimental to performance objectives will not be tolerated.
4. The use of audio or visual recording, including but not limited to a cell phone camera, is not allowed in changing areas, restrooms or locker rooms at any time.
5. All team members are expected to adhere to policies and procedures in the Frisco ISD athletic handbook.

**Travel Behavior**

1. No athlete will travel when any illness is evident to the parents or coaching staff.
2. Curfews established by the staff will be adhered to each day.
3. Unless otherwise excused or instructed by the coach, participants in a team trip will attend all team functions (on time), to include meetings, practices and any other team sanctioned event.
4. There will be no male athletes in female athletes' rooms and no female athletes in male athletes' rooms.
5. Any additional guidelines will come from the staff as needed.

Violations of the Athlete Code of Conduct will be handled as follows:

1. Gathering Information: The appropriate individuals will contact the person who filed the grievance, and the person against whom the grievance is being filed, to ask questions about what happened. In addition, other witnesses may be contacted for more information. All information will be documented as part of the incident investigation. While the incident(s) is being investigated all involved parties may be suspended from team activities until resolution of the matter.
2. Assessing Behavior: The behavior of the person(s) against which the grievance was brought, will be assessed using club policies and facility rules, USA Swimming Code of Conduct, USA Swimming Safe Sport policies, as well as applicable local and state laws.
3. Consequences will be given and disciplinary action will be taken, if appropriate. These consequences and disciplinary actions will be decided using the following general guidelines:
    1. Nature of the misconduct
    2. Severity of the misconduct
    3. Prior disciplinary actions
    4. Adverse effect of the misconduct
    5. Application of the Code of Conduct

***The Head Coach has the authority to impose penalties for any behavior(s) they deem not conducive to the best interests of the Club or other swimmers. Consequences are at the sole discretion of the coaching staff and may include, but aren't limited to, verbal warnings, dismissal from practice, contacting parents, temporary suspension from club activities and expulsion. Involved parties will be informed of the processes and range of potential consequences.***

# Parent Code of Conduct

The Iron Horse Aquatics Parent Code of Conduct ensures that we create a supportive environment for our swimmers and coaches so every athlete can achieve their full potential. Two of the best ways you can enhance your athlete's experience is to show them unconditional love and support and secondly to get involved by volunteering at meets and club activities or by becoming an official.

1. Iron Horse parents, through their actions and conduct, will exhibit good sportsmanship and encourage their children to do the same at all times. Parents will serve as positive role models for their children and teammates.
    a. Gossiping or spreading any kind of negative information about the program, coaches or other athletes is unacceptable behavior. If you come to find information that you feel needs to be addressed please bring it to the attention of the Head Age Group Coach or Head Coach who will be able to assist you.
2. Iron Horse parents will respect and cooperate with coaches, team members, opponents, spectators and officials at all times.
3. Iron Horse parents will respect the integrity of swim officials by assuming decisions are based on honest, objective evaluation of performance. Only coaches may approach officials and/or meet administrators with concerns.
4. Iron Horse parents recognize that our coaches are professionals and allow them to coach without interference. Iron Horse parents will leave coaching to the coaches and respect all coaching decisions such as practice group assignments, meet entries, training focus, etc.
    a. Parents should not interrupt or confront any member of the coaching staff during practice or meets.
    b. Only coaches and athletes are allowed on deck during practices.
    c. Only Athletes, coaches, and approved volunteers are allowed on deck during competitions.
5. Iron Horse parents with a concern related to any coach or official with Iron Horse Aquatics, should discuss the concerns with the athlete's coach privately and in a professional manner.
    a. If the matter is not resolved, the issue should be brought to the attention of the Head Age Group Coach or the Head Coach. If their response is unsatisfactory, an

Iron Horse parent may then request a meeting with the Director of Competitive Swimming for Frisco ISD for further discussion.

6. Iron Horse parents will not access locker rooms in use by athletes. In addition, the use of audio or visual recording, including a cell phone camera, is not allowed in changing areas, restrooms or locker rooms at any time.
7. Iron Horse parents will not consume alcohol, tobacco products or illegal drugs and will comply with all facility guidelines at events Iron Horse Aquatics attends.

Parents who fail to adhere to the standards as stated above will be subject to the following:

1. Information Gathering: The appropriate individuals will contact the person who filed the grievance, and the person against whom the grievance is being filed, to ask questions about what happened. In addition, other witnesses may be contacted for more information. All information will be documented as part of the incident investigation. While the incident(s) is being investigated all involved parties may be suspended from team activities until resolution of the matter.
2. Assessing Behavior: The behavior of the person(s) against which the grievance was brought, will be assessed using club policies and facility rules, USA Swimming Code of Conduct, USA Swimming Safe Sport policies, as well as applicable local and state laws.
3. Consequences will be given and disciplinary action will be taken, if appropriate. These consequences and disciplinary actions will be decided using the following general guidelines:
    1. Nature of the misconduct
    2. Severity of the misconduct
    3. Prior disciplinary actions
    4. Adverse effect of the misconduct
    5. Application of the Code of Conduct

***The Head Coach has the authority to impose penalties for any behavior(s) they deem not conducive to the best interests of the Club or other swimmers. Consequences are at the sole discretion of the coaching staff and may include, but aren't limited to, verbal warnings, dismissal from practice, contacting parents, temporary suspension from club activities and expulsion. Involved parties will be informed of the processes and range of potential consequences.***

# Grievance Process

WHOM TO NOTIFY OF A GRIEVANCE

*Regarding the Conduct of a Swimmer* - Contact the swimmer's coach.

1. Should a parent or swimmer feel another swimmer's conduct is inappropriate or violates the **Iron Horse Aquatics** Code of Conduct, the parent/swimmer should discuss these concerns with the coach of the swimmer responsible for the violation (Responsible Coach). This complaint should be made in person or in writing. Coaches will ensure the **Iron Horse Aquatics** head coach is notified of the complaint and will participate in assessing behavior.

*Regarding the Conduct of an Assistant or Age Group Coach* - Contact the Head Coach

1. Should a parent or swimmer feel an Assistant or Age Group Coach's conduct is inappropriate or in violation of any Club policies or procedures, the parent/swimmer should notify the Head Coach of this violation. This complaint should be made in person or in writing. The Head Coach will ensure that the **Frisco ISD Director of Competitive Swimming & Diving** is notified of the complaint and will participate in assessing behavior.

*Regarding Conduct of Head Coach* – Notify the **Frisco ISD Director of Competitive Swimming & Diving.**

1. Should a parent or swimmer feel the Head Coach's conduct is inappropriate or violates any Club policies or procedures, the parent/swimmer should notify the Director of this violation. This complaint should be made in person or in writing.

*Regarding Parent or Official Conduct* - Notify the Head Coach

1. Should a parent or swimmer feel another **Iron Horse Aquatics** parent's or an official's conduct is inappropriate or violates any Club policies or procedures, the parent/swimmer should notify the Head Coach of this violation in person or in writing.

**Note:** With the exception of issues which immediately affect the health and safety of swimmers, all matters should be discussed before or after a coaching session, as coaches should not be expected to deal with issues during water time.

## HOW GRIEVANCES WILL BE HANDLED

*The Head Coach has the authority to impose penalties for infractions of the* ***Iron Horse Aquatics*** *Athlete, Parent and Coach Codes of Conduct or any behavior(s) they deem not conducive to the best interests of the Club or other swimmers. Consequences are at the sole discretion of the coaching staff and may include, but aren't limited to, verbal warnings, dismissal from practice, contacting parents, temporary suspension from club activities and expulsion. Involved parties will be informed of the processes and range of potential consequences. The U.S. Center for SafeSport, USA Swimming and local law enforcement (if applicable) will be contacted within 24 hours if a coach, parent, or swimmer violates the SafeSport Code for the U.S. Olympic and Paralympic Movements, the USA Swimming Code of Conduct, Athlete Protection Policy, or local laws.*

1. Gathering Information: The appropriate individuals will contact the person who filed the grievance, and the person against whom the grievance is being filed, to ask questions about what happened. In addition, other witnesses may be contacted for more information. All information will be documented as part of the incident investigation. While the incident(s) is being investigated all involved parties may be suspended from team activities until resolution of the matter.
2. Assessing Behavior: The behavior of the person(s) against which the grievance was brought, will be assessed using club policies and facility rules, USA Swimming Code of Conduct, USA Swimming Safe Sport policies, as well as applicable local and state laws.
3. Consequences will be given and disciplinary action will be taken, if appropriate. These consequences and disciplinary actions will be decided using the following general guidelines:
    1. Nature of the misconduct
    2. Severity of the misconduct
    3. Prior disciplinary actions
    4. Adverse effect of the misconduct
    5. Application of the Code of Conduct

# Annual Photo Opt-Out

The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), a federal law, requires that school districts and their programs, with certain exceptions, obtain a parent's written consent prior to disclosure of any personal student information.

With parent permission, Iron Horse Aquatics & Frisco ISD utilizes some student information to communicate and celebrate program and athlete accomplishments, as well as raise awareness about District programs and opportunities for students.

Based on your choice below, the following student information may be shared for recognition and publicity purposes:

Name
Photo/Image
Participation in Iron Horse Aquatics and/or other district activities
Honors and Awards received
Necessary data of student athletes (events, best times, graduation year)

If you wish to NOT have your athlete(s) photographed, posted on FISD or Iron Horse social media platforms, sportsYou, etc. Please sign and return below:

Athlete name:

Parent Signature:

Date:

# Social Media and Electronic Communication Policy

As representatives of Iron Horse Aquatics you have the responsibility to portray yourself and your team in a positive manner. If you participate in electronic communications (e.g. texting), interact on social media site(s) (e.g. Snapchat, Instagram) you are expected to avoid inappropriate and offensive behaviors. If a club representative's social media profile and it's contents or other electronic communications are found to be inappropriate in accordance with the behaviors listed below, he/she will be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with the club's disciplinary procedures (swimmers) or the Parent Code of Conduct.

Examples of inappropriate content and offensive behavior may include, but are not limited to, depictions or presentations of the following:

- Photos, videos, and comments that are of a sexual nature. This includes links to websites of a pornographic nature and other inappropriate material.
- Photos, videos, or comments or posts showing the personal use of alcohol, drugs and tobacco.
- Content online that is unsportsmanlike, derogatory, demeaning, defamatory, or threatening toward any other individual or entity (e.g. derogatory comments regarding another, swimmer, member of staff of our club or another club)
- Any communications including posts depicting or encouraging unacceptable behaviors such as violent or illegal activities (e.g. sexual harassment, vandalism, underage drinking, or illegal drug use)

REMEMBER:

- Always present yourself in the most positive image possible. Don't do anything to embarrass yourself, your team, your family or the Club.
- The Internet is permanent. Anything posted online is available to anyone in the world. Any content you post is completely out of your control the moment it is published online, even if you limit access to your page.
- Don't post anything you wouldn't want your coaches or parents/guardians to see.

- Your social media content can and will be reviewed by both potential colleges and future employers.

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<EmailHeader.png>

# New Incident Report

This is an automated message from Mitratech Syntrio Case Management System (CMS).
We received this report via email today, 02/26/2026, for Frisco Independent School District.
Report #9022620263313
Subject Line: Ethics Violation / Conflict of Interest Coach Justin Bilgri, Coach Daiki Sato
To whom it may concern:

Section 1: Detailed Description of Incident
I am filing a formal report regarding a coordinated misrepresentation of district policy and a prohibited financial conflict of interest within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.

Part 1: Deceptive Communication (Violation of Standard 1.1) On February 2, 2026, I received written confirmation from Coach Justin Bilgri and Coach Daiki Sato explicitly stating that "nobody has moved up" and that promotions were on hold until March. This was a factual misrepresentation of program operations, as a promotion was granted to another student during this exact period. This dishonest communication violates the professional standards required of Frisco ISD employees.

Part 2: Prohibited Financial Gain (Violation of Standard 1.4 & 1.5) I have received information that Coach Justin Bilgri is accepting private cash payments from the family of the promoted student for "weekend lessons." Because Coach Bilgri serves as the primary

evaluator for student placement in this district-owned program, accepting private fees from a student he supervises is a direct violation of FISD Conflict of Interest policies. This "pay-to-play" arrangement has compromised the integrity of the promotion process and created an unfair advantage for a specific family.

Part 3: Undue Influence & Nepotism The student receiving this preferential treatment is the child of a Frisco ISD Assistant Principal. This creates a severe appearance of nepotism and a conflict of interest, where a district administrator’s child is promoted under a "secret" time line while other parents are intentionally misled by staff.

Section 2: Evidence to Support Complaint
Email Records: I have retained emails dated February 2, 2026, from both Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato denying that any move-ups had occurred.

Time line Discrepancy: I can provide the general dates the promoted student began participating in the advanced group, which directly contradicts the written denials provided by the coaching staff.

Witnesses/Locations: Information regarding the location and timing of the private "weekend lessons" can be provided to the Internal Audit department upon request to assist in the investigation of the financial conflict of interest.

Section 3: Requested Action
I am requesting that the FISD Internal Audit Department conduct a full investigation into the financial relationship between Coach Bilgri and the family of the promoted student. Furthermore, I request a review of the deceptive communication practices used by the coaching staff to ensure that all district families are treated with the

equity and transparency required by Texas law and Frisco ISD Board Policy.

**NOTICE:**

1. Valuable best-practice resources - videos and documents - are available in the Syntrio Engage employee experience platform. Contact Customer Success for your user account.
2. This report has been uploaded to the Case Management System (CMS), where you can document your investigative activities and outcomes.
3. YOU ARE ENCOURAGED NOT TO RESPOND TO THIS EMAIL. Communication with a reporter or Company should be input in the CMS using the dialog feature.
4. Providing proactive and timely feedback to reporters who respond YES to "Provided PIN (Dialog enabled in CMS)" is important.
5. If you do not have access to the CMS, contact your hotline program administrator.

<EmailFooter.png>

The information contained in this communication is confidential and is intended only for the use of the addressee. It is the property of Mitratech Holdings, Inc. Any unauthorized use, disclosure, or copying of this communication or any part thereof is strictly prohibited and may be unlawful. If you have received this communication in error, please notify us immediately and destroy this communication and all copies thereof, including all

attachments.

# Complaint (#Z005436-022626)

## Complaint Details

| | |
|---|---|
| Name of Complainant: | Stephen Ray Jordan |
| Address of Complainant: | 13054 Cinderella Ln, Frisco, TX, USA |
| Complainant Phone Number: | 9724031231 |
| Complainant Email Address: | srjordan@gmail.com |
| Add Second Complainant?: | No |
| Type of Complaint: | Student/Parent Complaint |
| Student Name: | [redacted] Jordan |
| Student Campus: | [redacted] MS |
| Select the Student / Parent Complaint Type: | All other complaints\| |
| Please describe the decision or incident causing your complaint: | The Incident: The core of this complaint involves a coordinated misrepresentation of athlete promotion status and potential preferential treatment within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.<br><br>On February 2, 2026, I sought clarification regarding athlete promotions into the Gold group. I received the following written responses from the coaching staff:<br><br>Coach Justin Bilgri: Stated explicitly that "There have been no move-ups at this time" and that move-ups would not occur until March.<br><br>Coach Daiki Sato: Reinforced this by stating, "To be clear nobody has moved up."<br><br>The Decision causing the complaint:<br>Despite these formal assurances from the coaching staff, a promotion (specifically of the athlete[redacted] was indeed made. This indicates that the information provided to me was factually inaccurate. Furthermore, the athlete in question is the child of a Frisco ISD Assistant Principal, which creates a strong appearance of preferential treatment and a conflict of interest. By providing me with false information while granting a promotion to the child of a district administrator, the program leadership has violated the principles of transparency and equity. This breach of trust and the resulting disparity in placement for my son, [redacted] is the basis of this grievance. |
| Date of decision or incident: | 2/24/2026 |
| Date you became aware of decision or incident: | 2/24/2026 |
| Please explain how you have been harmed by this decision or incident: | Gemini said<br>When answering the "Harm" section of a formal grievance, the goal is to shift from "disappointed parent" to "documented athlete advocate." You want to demonstrate that this isn't just a minor inconvenience, but a decision that causes quantifiable athletic, developmental, and professional harm to [redacted] progress.<br><br>Here is how you should frame that answer:<br><br>Explanation of Harm<br>1. Stagnation of Athletic Development (Technical Harm)<br>By being denied entry into the Gold group, [redacted] is being deprived of the aerobic volume and specialized training intensity required to maintain his elite performance in his primary strokes (100 Breaststroke and 100 Butterfly). The coaching staff has confirmed that 80% of practices emphasize freestyle; however, the lower-tier group does not provide the yardage or interval density necessary for an "A" or "AA" level swimmer to continue dropping time. Remaining in a lower group will lead to a plateau in his physiological development, effectively "capping" his potential during a critical growth window in age-group swimming.<br><br>2. Competitive Disadvantage (Rankings Harm)<br>Swimming is a sport governed by official time standards and rankings. By training in a group that does not align with his fastest strokes, [redacted] is at a disadvantage compared to peers across the region who are training in groups matched to their highest-performing events. This decision negatively impacts his ability to qualify for high-level meets (such as TAGS or Sectionals), as he is not receiving the level of coaching feedback and lane-leader pacing required to achieve those national-tier time standards.<br><br>3. Psychological and Motivational Impact (Student Well-being)<br>There is a documented psychological harm in "Performance-Cap Situations." When a student-athlete consistently outperforms their peer group (as [redacted] does in the 100 BR and 100 FL) but is denied promotion based on arbitrary or non-specialized benchmarks, it leads to a decrease in engagement and athletic self-efficacy. Being forced to repeat training cycles that he has already mastered—while seeing peers with slower specialty times promoted—undermines the "meritocracy" that Frisco ISD athletics claims to uphold.<br><br>4. Future Collegiate/Scholarship Implications (Long-Term Harm)<br>In competitive swimming, recruiting and scholarship opportunities are often stroke-specific. By de-emphasizing [redacted] elite-level Breaststroke and Butterfly in favor of general freestyle conditioning, the district is actively hindering his ability to build a competitive Recruitment Profile. The loss of a single season of high-level training can have a cascading effect on an athlete's multi-year trajectory. |

| | |
|---|---|
| Please describe any attempts you made to resolve you complaint informally, including the names of any individuals with whom you spoke and the dates of those conversations: | Attempts to Resolve Complaint Informally<br><br>I have made multiple documented attempts to resolve this matter through the informal channels outlined in District policy:<br><br>Initial Outreach (Coaching Staff): I initially contacted Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato via email on [Insert Date of your first email to them] to discuss the technical data regarding [redacted] performance in the 100 BR and 100 FL relative to the Gold group benchmarks.<br><br>Administrative Intervention: Following the coaches' refusal to adjust the placement, I corresponded with Melissa Howard (Campus/District Administration).<br><br>Specific Correspondence (February 2026):<br><br>February 26, 2026: I sent an email to Ms. Howard requesting confirmation that the proposed meeting on March 3, 2026, would be a meaningful negotiation based on [redacted] merit and technical performance data. I explicitly stated that if the decision was already final, I would prefer to move to the formal process to respect all parties' time.<br><br>February 26, 2026 (Response Received): Ms. Howard responded but failed to confirm whether the district was open to reconsidering the placement. Her response stated, "If this is not sufficient, you are welcome to continue the complaint process."<br><br>Involved Individuals:<br><br>Coach Bilgri (Involved Coach)<br><br>Coach Sato (Involved Coach)<br><br>Coach Franks (Requested for technical input)<br><br>Melissa Howard (Administrator)<br><br>Conclusion of Informal Attempts:<br>Because the administration refused to state that the meeting would be a good-faith reconsideration of the performance facts, and instead invited me to "continue the complaint process," I have determined that the informal steps have been exhausted. The district appears unwilling to move from a fixed position regardless of the objective swimming data provided. |
| Please list the remedies you are seeking for this complaint: | Remedies Sought<br>1. Immediate Promotion to the Gold Practice Group<br>Based on the objective data showing [redacted] Ray Jordan is "clearly ahead" in the 100 Breaststroke and 100 Butterfly, I am seeking his immediate placement in the Gold group. His current performance metrics in these specialty strokes already align with or exceed the competitive standards of that group.<br><br>2. Implementation of a Weighted Placement Metric<br>I am seeking a formal revision to how practice group placements are determined. Currently, the "80% Freestyle" focus creates an arbitrary barrier for "Stroke Specialists." I request that placement criteria be adjusted to include a weighted average of all four competitive strokes, ensuring that swimmers who excel at a Gold level in Breaststroke, Butterfly, or Backstroke are not unfairly held back by marginal differences in Freestyle sprints.<br><br>3. Alignment with USA Swimming Motivational Standards<br>I request that the district officially recognize and utilize USA Swimming 2024–2028 Motivational Time Standards (A, AA, AAA) as the primary benchmark for group advancement. This ensures that placements are based on nationally recognized developmental tiers rather than subjective campus-level "foundation" metrics.<br><br>4. Documentation of Technical "Gates"<br>Should the district continue to deny placement, I seek a formal, written "Technical Deficiency Report" from the coaching staff (Coach Bilgri, Sato, and Franks) outlining the exact mechanical or physiological markers [redacted] is missing. This must go beyond "general freestyle averages" and address why his superior stroke times do not qualify as "Gold level" performance.<br><br>5. Non-Retaliation Assurance<br>I seek a formal assurance that [redacted] will not face any reduction in lane time, relay opportunities, or coaching feedback as a result of this grievance process. |
| Do you wish to report additional incidents: | No |
| Will you be represented in voicing your complaint/appeal?: | No |
| Do you wish to Appeal this decision?: | Yes |
| Date you received the response to your complaint: | 4/27/2026 |

| | |
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| Please explain specifically how you disagree with the findings: | I disagree with the findings because the Level I response does not address the core issue raised in my complaint, which is whether advancement criteria are clearly defined, measurable, and consistently applied.<br><br>The response concludes that my allegation of inconsistency is unsubstantiated, but it does not establish what the actual advancement standards are, how they are measured, or how they are applied uniformly across all swimmers.<br><br>Instead, the response relies on general statements regarding coaching experience, variability in standards, and athlete development. These statements do not address whether there are defined, objective criteria that govern advancement decisions once measurable performance data exists.<br><br>Additionally, the response states that varying standards are normal practice. While athlete development may vary, the criteria used to evaluate advancement should still be clearly defined and consistently applied. The response does not demonstrate that such standards exist.<br><br>The denial of my requested remedy is also based on feasibility and capacity considerations. However, those considerations do not address whether the current advancement criteria meet the standard of being clear, measurable, and consistently applied. Operational constraints are separate from whether the criteria themselves are defined and applied uniformly.<br><br>At the Level I conference, I clarified that once swimmers have measurable competition times, those times provide an objective basis for evaluating performance. The response does not address whether measurable performance standards are used as a consistent baseline for advancement decisions.<br><br>As a result, the findings do not resolve the issue of whether advancement criteria are clearly defined, measurable, and consistently applied across all swimmers.<br><br>As a public school program supported by taxpayer resources, it is especially important that advancement criteria are applied fairly, transparently, and consistently across all students. |
| Please list the remedies you are seeking for this appeal: | The remedies I am seeking are limited to clarifying and establishing advancement criteria that are clearly defined, measurable, and consistently applied across all swimmers.<br><br>Specifically, I request the following:<br><br>1. That advancement criteria be formally defined using objective, measurable performance standards once swimmers have measurable competition times.<br><br>2. That these standards include a consistent performance baseline, such as:<br>• Achievement of at least three qualifying time standards<br>• Demonstration of BB-level performance or higher<br><br>3. That age may be considered as a supporting factor, but that performance remains the primary basis for advancement.<br><br>4. That advancement occurs when defined performance standards are met, particularly in cases where discretionary advancement is permitted at any time.<br><br>5. That advancement criteria be applied consistently across all swimmers and all groups within the program.<br><br>6. That factors such as attendance, event participation, parent volunteer participation, or invitation-only discretion not be used as mandatory conditions for advancement, but may remain as developmental guidance.<br><br>7. That once swimmers have measurable competition times, those measurable times serve as the primary and objective basis for advancement decisions.<br><br>These remedies are intended to ensure that advancement criteria are clear, measurable, and consistently applied in a fair and transparent manner.<br><br>As this is a public school program supported by taxpayer resources, it is important that advancement criteria are applied fairly, consistently, and transparently across all students. |
| Will you be represented in voicing your appeal?: | No |

## Internal Information Only

| | |
|---|---|
| Policy Codes: | Administrative Complaint Process\| |
| Abated: | No |
| Abated Time Period: | Please enter date range such as 10/1/2020 - 11/2/2020 |
| Appeal of Prohibited Conduct Complete: | No |
| Investigator Name: | |
| Investigator Title: | |
| Investigation Allegation Determination: | |
| Date of Findings Letter: | |

| | |
|---|---|
| Investigation Certified Mail Number: | |
| Name of Level I Hearing Officer: | Melissa Howard |
| Title of Level I Hearing Officer: | FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator |
| Date of Level I Conference: | 4/7/2026 |
| Level I Allegation Determination: | Unsubstantiated |
| Level I Remedy Acceptance: | Granted |
| Date of Level I Response: | 3/24/2026 |
| Level I Certified Mail Number: | |
| Date of First Appeal: | 4/28/2026 |
| Date Appeal Due: | 4/8/2026 |
| Name of Level II Hearing Officer: | Deidra Rucker |
| Title of Level II Hearing Officer: | FISD Ast Athletic Director |
| Level II Allegation Determination: | Unsubstantiated |
| Level II Remedy Acceptance: | Denied |
| Date of Level II Conference: | 5/5/2026 |
| Date of Level II Response: | 5/18/2026 |
| Level II Certified Mail Number: | |

**Message History**

Date

On 4/29/2026 1:36:23 PM, Stephen Jordan wrote:
I entered data for the level II appeal but I am not certain that I entered it correctly. Would you please confirm that I followed the correct procedure?

Date

On 2/26/2026 8:08:42 PM, System Generated Message:
**Subject:** Complaint :: Z005436-022626
**Body:**

FRISCO INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

Confirmation of Complaint

Complaint #Z005436-022626

This email serves as confirmation that the below referenced complaint was submitted on February 26, 2026. **PLEASE NOTE: If your complaint was submitted after 4:30pm or on a non-District business day, it will be received in our offices on the next business day.**

Upon receipt, your complaint will be processed in accordance with applicable Frisco ISD Board Policy and Complaint Procedures. The reference number for your complaint is **Z005436-022626**.

Your complaint will be assigned to a hearing officer or investigator, as appropriate, who will contact you within 10 District business days of the receipt of your complaint.

Please click the "REQUEST CENTER" button below to view and track the progress of your request. If you have any questions, you may reply directly to this email.

REQUEST CENTER

COMPLAINT DETAILS

**Complainant:** Stephen Jordan

**Complaint Submission Date:** February 26, 2026

**Type of Complaint:** Student/Parent Complaint

**Complaint Reference Number:** Z005436-022626

Powered by GovQA

On 2/26/2026 8:07:58 PM, Stephen Jordan wrote:
Request Created on Public Portal

**Request Details**

| | |
|---|---|
| Reference No: | Z005436-022626 |
| Create Date: | 2/26/2026 8:08 PM |
| Update Date: | 7/14/2026 2:59 PM |
| Completed/Closed: | Yes |
| Close Date: | 5/20/2026 3:34 PM |
| Status: | Closed |
| Priority: | High |
| Assigned Dept: | Admin- Athletics |
| Assigned Staff: | Deidra Rucker |

| | |
|---|---|
| Customer Name: | Stephen Jordan |
| Email Address: | srjordan@gmail.com |
| Phone: | 9724031231 |
| Group: | Complaints |
| Source: | Web |

Outlook

## RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

**From** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Date** Thu 2/26/2026 8:14 PM
**To** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Cc** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Howard,
Thank you for your response. Given your background as a swim coach and the formal legal tone of your recent correspondence, it is clear that our perspectives on [redacted] placement and the application of performance benchmarks remain at an impasse.
Rather than proceeding with an informal meeting that appears unlikely to result in a good-faith negotiation, I have decided it is best to move directly to the formal process. I am filing a Level 1 complaint today to ensure this matter is reviewed through the objective standards outlined in Board Policy FNG(Local).
I look forward to resolving this through the official district channels.
Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 4:37 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Hello Mr. Jordan,

As per my previous email, we are still open to meeting with you and will schedule that meeting for Tuesday, March 3rd at 1:30pm. If this is not sufficient, you are welcome to continue the complaint process. Our goal is to support your son and his success both in and out of the pool. We hope to discuss this with you on Tuesday.

Thank you,

Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 4:04 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

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Dear Ms. Howard,
Following up on my previous message, I am available for the meeting on either Tuesday (3/3) or Wednesday (3/4) at 1:30 PM. As I requested, I would like Coach Franks to be present in addition to Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato to ensure all involved individuals are represented.
Before we meet, I would like to clarify where we are in the Frisco ISD process. Based on your correspondence, it appears we are currently at **Step 1 (Contact involved individual)** moving into **Step 2 (Contact campus administrator)**.
I want to be clear that my goal for this meeting is a good-faith negotiation regarding [redacted] placement based on his performance in the 50 BR, 100 BR, 50 FL and 100 FL, which meet the competitive standards for the Gold group. If the district's position is that the current placement is final and non-negotiable regardless of the technical data provided, please let me know.
If your minds are already made up and the meeting is simply to restate a fixed decision, I would prefer to forgo the informal meeting and proceed directly to a **Level 1 Formal Complaint** as outlined in Board Policy FNG(Local).
Please confirm if the district is open to a reconsideration of [redacted] placement during this meeting, or if the current decision is considered final.
Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 3:13 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Either day is fine with me. I also want Coach Franks at this meeting.

Get Outlook for Android

---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 3:00:35 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

Based on our initial review of facts following receipt of your email, it is clear you have a misunderstanding of what has occurred. However, we are prohibited by law from providing you with information regarding another student. Please note that practice group decisions are based on a variety of factors, including the rationale provided to you at this point. There is no evidence that practice group decisions were based on any other factor.

We are happy to discuss this matter with you further but please know that we will continue to be limited by student privacy laws. If you wish to meet to discuss your concerns, I, Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato will be available at 1:30pm either Tuesday (3/3/26) or Wednesday (3/4/26) next week. If you wish to file a formal complaint with Frisco ISD, you may file a Level 1 complaint through the District's grievance process as outlined on our website. You have 30 days from receipt of this correspondence, which includes both a detailed description of the Frisco ISD decision as well as instructions for how to file a complaint. All timelines as outlined in Board Policy FNG(Local) will be strictly enforced.

Please let us know how you would like to proceed.
Thank you.

Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:17 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am following up on my previous email as I have yet to receive a response. Please be advised that I am committed to seeing this matter through to a resolution that ensures transparency and equity for all swimmers in the program.
My concerns regarding the **misrepresentation of program status** are based on the following written communications I received on February 2, 2026:

- **From Justin Bilgri:** *"Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March."*
- **From Daiki Sato:** *"To be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin.".*

**I am requesting the following actions be taken by the FISD Athletic Department:**

1. **Administrative Review:** I request that [redacted] **Janak**, as the direct supervisor, provide a written explanation for why parents were provided with inaccurate information regarding athlete promotions.
2. **Accountability:** I am asking for a formal review of the conduct of Coaches Sato and Bilgri regarding their communication standards with parents.
3. **Leadership Oversight:** I request that the district evaluate the management practices under the current Head Coach to ensure an environment of honesty and equity.
4. **Placement Resolution:** To rectify the current disparity, I request that [redacted] be placed in the **Gold group**, or that the status of other athletes be returned to **Silver** to align with the timeline previously communicated to me.

I look forward to a prompt response from the management team regarding the steps being taken to address these discrepancies.
Sincerely,
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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---

**From:** Stephen Jordan
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:24 PM
**To:** 'BILGRI, JUSTIN' <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; ',[redacted]Janak' <janakj@friscoisd.org>; 'Melissa Howard' <howardme@friscoisd.org>; 'Chris Burtch' <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; 'Deidra Rucker' <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; ',' <leaders@friscoisd.org>; 'davisdy@friscoisd.org' <davisdy@friscoisd.org>; 'elads@friscoisd.org' <elads@friscoisd.org>; 'hillmark@friscoisd.org' <hillmark@friscoisd.org>; 'ddoxk@friscoisd.org' <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; 'manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Grievance Regarding Iron Horse Aquatics Placement – Stephen Jordan

**Dear Coach Franks, FISD Board of Directors, and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am writing to file a formal complaint regarding the recent placement and promotion decisions within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.
Both you and Coach Daiki explicitly informed me that [redacted] was not being promoted. I have since discovered this was untrue. This lack of transparency is unacceptable, but more concerning is the apparent **conflict of interest** regarding this decision.
Because DR. [redacted] mother is an Assistant Principal within Frisco ISD, it appears that she is receiving **preferential treatment** for her child that is not being afforded to other

families. Using a district position to influence athletic promotions undermines the "power of one" and the equity Frisco ISD claims to uphold.
Due to this ethical concern and the misinformation provided to me, I am requesting the following immediate action:

1. **Placement Equity:** Promote [redacted] into the **Gold group** immediately, OR
2. **Reversion:** Move [redacted] back into the **Silver group** to reflect the standards previously communicated to me.

I am copying the Frisco ISD Athletic Department leadership to ensure this matter, and the potential misuse of district influence—is properly documented. I expect a formal response addressing these inconsistencies and a resolution to the placement issue.
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

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**From:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

To provide additional context, the current group averages for the boys in Gold are:

- 50 Free: 24–28 seconds
- 100 Free: 53–1:04
- 200 Free: 2:00–2:15

At this time, [redacted] is below these benchmark ranges in his freestyle events. His breaststroke is stronger and aligns more closely with the rest of the group. However, breaststroke is not the primary focus of daily training in Gold. Approximately 80% of weekly practices emphasize freestyle, as it forms the foundation of conditioning and overall development. Due to the physical strain that breaststroke and butterfly place on the body, training cannot be centered exclusively on those strokes.

For [redacted] to align more closely with the group standard and continue progressing long term, improving his freestyle will be key. I'm confident that with consistent focus and effort, he will continue to make strong gains across all events.

If you would like anymore clarification. We can schedule a meeting with Coach Daiki and I next week.

Best regards,
Justin Bilgri

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, February 24, 2026 9:43 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Coach Bilgri,

I hope you are doing well. I wanted to reach out regarding [redacted] current placement in the Silver group.

[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.

I am concerned about the consistency of this arrangement. If swimmers of similar competitive level are being treated differently, it can feel inequitable to the athletes who are putting in the same effort.

With that in mind, I would respectfully request one of the following:

- If [redacted] is going to continue practicing with Gold, I would ask that [redacted] be given the same opportunity.
- Alternatively, if group placement standards require swimmers to remain in their designated practice group, then those standards should apply consistently.
- Ideally, I would appreciate a formal evaluation of [redacted] for promotion to the Gold group if he meets the criteria.

Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?

Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

Outlook

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**Fw: FISD Formal Grievance**

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**From** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>

**Date** Mon 3/2/2026 4:30 PM

**To** BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; WORTH, JENNIFER <worthj@friscoisd.org>; Anderson, Shelley <andersonsh@friscoisd.org>

Good afternoon,

Please see the correspondence below as an attempt to set up a meeting for the level 1 grievance. He sent his latest email after my email below.

Please advise.
Thank you all!


Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics


---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:11 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Formal Grievance

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

The first step in the formal complaint process is for the department to hear and respond to your concerns. If you disagree with the response, you can then appeal that decision.

Thank you,


Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics


---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 3:21 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Formal Grievance

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Ms. Howard my grievance includes you. How can you be impartial? I want a representative from FISD that does not represent the swimming or athletic departments.

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---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 1:55:03 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Subject:** FISD Formal Grievance

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

I have been assigned as the Level 1 hearing officer for the grievance filed on February 26, 2026. We will meet at the FISD Administrative Building (5515 Ohio Dr.) in the conference room on the 4th floor. Please let me know which of the following dates and times work for you.

- Tuesday, March 3rd at 1:30
- Thursday, March 5th at 12:30
- Friday, March 6th at 11:30

Thank you,

Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

Outlook

## OBJECTION TO ASSIGNMENT OF HEARING OFFICER – Level 1 Grievance

**From** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>

**Date** Mon 3/2/2026 4:33 PM

**To** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Howard,
I am writing to formally object to your assignment as the Level 1 Hearing Officer for this grievance.
As noted in my previous correspondence, my complaint specifically names you and members of the swimming department regarding the inconsistent application of athletic benchmarks and potential conflicts of interest. Under the principles of **Administrative Due Process** and **Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG(LOCAL)**, a hearing officer must be an impartial party who is not a subject of the underlying grievance.
Having the individual named in the complaint serve as the "judge" of the complaint is a fundamental conflict of interest that renders the Level 1 process a mere formality rather than a good-faith attempt at resolution.
I am requesting that Frisco ISD assign an **independent Hearing Officer from the School Leadership Department or General Administration** who has no reporting relationship with the FISD Natatorium, Iron Horse Aquatics, or the Athletic Department.
If the District insists on proceeding with you as the hearing officer despite this clear conflict, please provide the specific Board Policy or Texas Education Code provision that allows a named respondent to adjudicate their own grievance.
Until an impartial officer is assigned, I am not comfortable proceeding with a meeting that lacks the procedural integrity required for a fair hearing. I will, however, make myself available on **Thursday, March 5th at 12:30 PM** or **Friday, March 6th at 11:30 PM**, provided an independent administrator is assigned to preside.
I look forward to a prompt response from the School Leadership Department.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:12 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Formal Grievance

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

The first step in the formal complaint process is for the department to hear and respond to your concerns. If you disagree with the response, you can then appeal that decision.

Thank you,


Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics


---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 3:21 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Formal Grievance


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Ms. Howard my grievance includes you. How can you be impartial? I want a representative from FISD that does not represent the swimming or athletic departments.

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---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 1:55:03 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Subject:** FISD Formal Grievance

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

I have been assigned as the Level 1 hearing officer for the grievance filed on February 26, 2026. We will meet at the FISD Administrative Building (5515 Ohio Dr.) in the conference room on the 4th floor. Please let me know which of the following dates and times work for you.

- Tuesday, March 3rd at 1:30
- Thursday, March 5th at 12:30
- Friday, March 6th at 11:30

Thank you,


Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium

Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

Outlook

---

**Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance**

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**From** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Date** Thu 3/5/2026 4:34 PM
**To** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>

The address is 5515 Ohio Dr., Frisco 75035


Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics


---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, March 5, 2026 3:28 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance


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I forgot what is the address of the administration building.

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---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 12:18:03 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Friday will be fine.

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---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 11:23:43 AM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan,

Which of the proposed meeting dates and times would be your preference?

Thank you,

Natatorium

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 10:15 AM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** RE: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

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Dear Ms. Kolni and Ms. Howard,
I am in receipt of the General Counsel's correspondence. While I will comply with the District's "stepped process" to ensure I do not forfeit my right to appeal, let the record reflect that I am participating in this Level 1 hearing with Ms. Howard **strictly under protest.**
The District's assertion that a "fresh set of eyes" must be preserved for later levels does not negate the fundamental requirement for an impartial hearing officer at Level 1. Ms. Howard is a direct subject of my grievance; her prior communications have been contemptuous in tone and have actively invited the escalation of this conflict rather than seeking a technical resolution based on swimming merit.
To have the individual whose judgment and conduct are being questioned serve as the adjudicator of that very conduct is a procedural absurdity. It creates an environment where the Level 1 hearing is not a meaningful attempt at resolution, but a bureaucratic hurdle and a significant waste of time for all parties involved.
Furthermore, I remain deeply concerned regarding the conflict of interest involving a District Vice President whose child is a direct peer of my son. The District's refusal to provide an independent officer at this stage only reinforces my belief that this process lacks the transparency and objectivity required by **Board Policy FNG(LOCAL).**
**I will attend the meeting on [Select Date: Thursday, March 5th at 12:30 PM OR Friday, March 6th at 11:30 AM] at the FISD Administrative Building.** I will be bringing the supplemental performance data and evidence previously mentioned. I expect a formal, written response to each point of my grievance following the meeting, as I fully anticipate the need to escalate this matter to Level 2 to find the "impartiality" the District claims to value.
Sincerely,
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**From:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 8:47 AM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>

**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan - Please provide all supplemental information related to your grievance directly to the assigned hearing officer only. If you would like to include a second recipient, you may copy our complaints resolution email address at ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org. The Formal Grievance process is a stepped process that begins at Level I with your assigned hearing officer, Ms. Howard. If you appeal her findings, the District will need to assign your complaint to a person who can look at the issues with fresh eyes, without having previously been exposed to your concerns. I've asked those not directly involved at this level not to read of respond to your grievance material to maintain the efficacy of the grievance process.

Best,

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
FRISCO ISD
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:26 PM
**To:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

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Dear All,
This correspondence serves as a formal evidentiary supplement to the Level 1 Grievance concerning the practice group placement of [redacted] Ray Jordan.
This submission contains:

1. Objective performance data from the February 27 to March 1, 2026 COR Swim Meet
2. A technical analysis of the current placement methodology
3. A comparative review of North Texas competitive swimming standards
4. Notice of intent regarding further action should corrective measures not be taken

---

## I. Objective Performance Data

### Junior and Senior COR Swim Meet – Garland, Texas

[redacted] demonstrated measurable and significant improvement across multiple events and achieved USA Swimming A Motivational Standards in three events.

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 200 Yard IM | 2:37.61 | 2:33.81 | 3.80 | 2.41 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Fly | 1:12.02 | 1:09.39 | 2.63 | 1.67 percent | — |

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 50 Yard Breast | 36.16 | 35.04 | 1.12 | 0.71 percent | A Time |
| 200 Yard Breast | 2:51.55 | 2:45.63 | 5.92 | 3.76 percent | A Time |
| 50 Yard Fly | 31.66 | 31.56 | 0.10 | 0.06 percent | — |
| 100 Yard IM | 1:12.53 | 1:12.20 | 0.33 | 0.21 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Breast | 1:19.20 | 1:17.11 | 2.09 | 1.33 percent | A Time |

These results are objective, verifiable, and attached as an official meet record.

## II. Training Volume Disparity

Silver Group weekly training volume: 7 hours 45 minutes
Gold Group weekly training volume: 9 hours 15 minutes
This represents a 22.8 percent increase in structured training exposure.
For an athlete performing at A standard in multiple events, denial of appropriate training volume constitutes a material developmental restriction. Continued placement below performance level directly impacts competitive progression and future opportunity.

## III. Technical Deficiency in Placement Criteria

The continued reliance on freestyle benchmarks as the primary gatekeeping metric is inconsistent with broader competitive swimming standards.

- USA Swimming Motivational Standards recognize performance across all strokes.
- ASCA development principles require stroke specific neuromuscular reinforcement for specialists.
- Long Term Athlete Development modeling identifies early non freestyle stroke proficiency as a leading indicator of long-term competitive viability.
- Regional North Texas programs promote based on verified meet data and tier standards rather than isolated stroke bias.

[redacted] currently meets or exceeds A tier standards in breaststroke events. Placement decisions that disregard these standards lack objective consistency.

## IV. Notice of Intent

If this matter is not resolved at Level 1 through immediate promotion to the Gold practice group, I will proceed through all formal grievance levels available under Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG Local.
Further, I am prepared to pursue external legal review regarding:

- Inconsistent application of advancement standards
- Arbitrary and capricious placement methodology
- Developmental harm resulting from denial of appropriate training volume
- Potential exposure arising from unequal application of published or customary criteria

This letter should be understood as formal notice that I am prepared to protect my child's athletic development through all available administrative and legal channels.

## Requested Resolution

Immediate promotion of [redacted] Ray Jordan to the Gold practice group and implementation of the 9 hour 15 minute weekly training schedule without further delay.
This request is supported by objective data, industry standards, and developmental best practice.
I expect written confirmation of corrective action.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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---

**From:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:36 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good Afternoon Mr. Jordan,

I just wanted to let you know that your email has been received, and I will touch base with athletics and someone will be in contact with you to discuss your concerns.

Sincerely,

FRISCO ISD

**Cory McClendon**
*Chief Leadership/Student Services Officer*
469.633.6021
mcclendc@friscoisd.org

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:18 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

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**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am following up on my previous email as I have yet to receive a response. Please be advised that I am committed to seeing this matter through to a resolution that ensures transparency and equity for all swimmers in the program.
My concerns regarding the **misrepresentation of program status** are based on the following written communications I received on February 2, 2026:

- **From Justin Bilgri:** *"Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do*

*our moveups in March."*

- **From Daiki Sato:** *"To be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin.".*

**I am requesting the following actions be taken by the FISD Athletic Department:**

1. **Administrative Review:** I request that [redacted] **Janak**, as the direct supervisor, provide a written explanation for why parents were provided with inaccurate information regarding athlete promotions.
2. **Accountability:** I am asking for a formal review of the conduct of Coaches Sato and Bilgri regarding their communication standards with parents.
3. **Leadership Oversight:** I request that the district evaluate the management practices under the current Head Coach to ensure an environment of honesty and equity.
4. **Placement Resolution:** To rectify the current disparity, I request that [redacted] be placed in the **Gold group**, or that the status of other athletes be returned to **Silver** to align with the timeline previously communicated to me.

I look forward to a prompt response from the management team regarding the steps being taken to address these discrepancies.
Sincerely,
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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---

**From:** Stephen Jordan
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:24 PM
**To:** 'BILGRI, JUSTIN' <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; ',[redacted]Janak' <janakj@friscoisd.org>; 'Melissa Howard' <howardme@friscoisd.org>; 'Chris Burtch' <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; 'Deidra Rucker' <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; ',' <leaders@friscoisd.org>; 'davisdy@friscoisd.org' <davisdy@friscoisd.org>; 'elads@friscoisd.org' <elads@friscoisd.org>; 'hillmark@friscoisd.org' <hillmark@friscoisd.org>; 'ddoxk@friscoisd.org' <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; 'manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Grievance Regarding Iron Horse Aquatics Placement – Stephen Jordan

**Dear Coach Franks, FISD Board of Directors, and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am writing to file a formal complaint regarding the recent placement and promotion decisions within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.
Both you and Coach Daiki explicitly informed me that [redacted] was not being promoted. I have since discovered this was untrue. This lack of transparency is unacceptable, but more concerning is the apparent **conflict of interest** regarding this decision.
Because DR. [redacted] mother is an Assistant Principal within Frisco ISD, it appears that she is receiving **preferential treatment** for her child that is not being afforded to other families. Using a district position to influence athletic promotions undermines the "power of one" and the equity Frisco ISD claims to uphold.
Due to this ethical concern and the misinformation provided to me, I am requesting the following immediate action:

1. **Placement Equity:** Promote [redacted] into the **Gold group** immediately, OR
2. **Reversion:** Move [redacted] back into the **Silver group** to reflect the standards previously communicated to me.

I am copying the Frisco ISD Athletic Department leadership to ensure this matter, and the potential misuse of district influence—is properly documented. I expect a formal response

addressing these inconsistencies and a resolution to the placement issue.
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

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**From:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

To provide additional context, the current group averages for the boys in Gold are:

- 50 Free: 24–28 seconds
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At this time, [redacted] is below these benchmark ranges in his freestyle events. His breaststroke is stronger and aligns more closely with the rest of the group. However, breaststroke is not the primary focus of daily training in Gold. Approximately 80% of weekly practices emphasize freestyle, as it forms the foundation of conditioning and overall development. Due to the physical strain that breaststroke and butterfly place on the body, training cannot be centered exclusively on those strokes.

For [redacted] to align more closely with the group standard and continue progressing long term, improving his freestyle will be key. I'm confident that with consistent focus and effort, he will continue to make strong gains across all events.

If you would like anymore clarification. We can schedule a meeting with Coach Daiki and I next week.

Best regards,
Justin Bilgri

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, February 24, 2026 9:43 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

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Dear Coach Bilgri,

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[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.

I am concerned about the consistency of this arrangement. If swimmers of similar competitive level are being treated differently, it can feel inequitable to the athletes who are putting in the same effort.

With that in mind, I would respectfully request one of the following:

- If [redacted] is going to continue practicing with Gold, I would ask that [redacted] be given the same opportunity.
- Alternatively, if group placement standards require swimmers to remain in their designated practice group, then those standards should apply consistently.
- Ideally, I would appreciate a formal evaluation of [redacted] for promotion to the Gold group if he meets the criteria.

Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?

Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan
**From:** "BILGRI, JUSTIN" <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** 2/25/2026 12:04:51 PM
**To:** "Stephen Jordan" <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**CC:** "FRANKS, MATTHEW" <franksma@friscoisd.org>; "SATO, DAIKI" <satod@friscoisd.org>

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

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Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.
Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

---

**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan
**From:** "Stephen Jordan" <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** 2/24/2026 9:43:18 PM
**To:** "Justin Bilgri" <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**CC:** "FRANKS, MATTHEW" <franksma@friscoisd.org>

Dear Coach Bilgri,

I hope you are doing well. I wanted to reach out regarding [redacted] current placement in the Silver group.

[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.

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Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?

Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

**From:** Kolni, Esther
**Sent:** Tue, 3 Mar 2026 14:58:45 +0000
**To:** Anderson, Shelley
**Subject:** Fw: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Shelley,

I responded to Mr. Jordan that he should be directing all grievance material to his hearing officer only but if he wanted to CC someone - he should CC the Complaints Resolution email.

I also emailed everyone else he'd included to NOT RESPOND. Can you print this email chain to PDF and add it as an Attachment in GovQA for the record?

Thanks so much!

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

**From:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 8:49 AM
**To:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Please do not read or respond to Mr. Jordan's email. He is now in the Formal Grievance process and it is important that those who may be involved at higher levels of the grievance process remain uninvolved at this lower level for the efficacy of the process.

Thank you all in advance.

Best,

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057

kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:26 PM
**To:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

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Dear All,
This correspondence serves as a formal evidentiary supplement to the Level 1 Grievance concerning the practice group placement of [redacted] Ray Jordan.
This submission contains:

1. Objective performance data from the February 27 to March 1, 2026 COR Swim Meet
2. A technical analysis of the current placement methodology
3. A comparative review of North Texas competitive swimming standards
4. Notice of intent regarding further action should corrective measures not be taken

---

## I. Objective Performance Data

### Junior and Senior COR Swim Meet – Garland, Texas

[redacted] demonstrated measurable and significant improvement across multiple events and achieved USA Swimming A Motivational Standards in three events.

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 200 Yard IM | 2:37.61 | 2:33.81 | 3.80 | 2.41 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Fly | 1:12.02 | 1:09.39 | 2.63 | 1.67 percent | — |
| 50 Yard Breast | 36.16 | 35.04 | 1.12 | 0.71 percent | A Time |
| 200 Yard Breast | 2:51.55 | 2:45.63 | 5.92 | 3.76 percent | A Time |
| 50 Yard Fly | 31.66 | 31.56 | 0.10 | 0.06 percent | — |
| 100 Yard IM | 1:12.53 | 1:12.20 | 0.33 | 0.21 percent | — |

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 100 Yard Breast | 1:19.20 | 1:17.11 | 2.09 | 1.33 percent | A Time |

These results are objective, verifiable, and attached as an official meet record.

## II. Training Volume Disparity

Silver Group weekly training volume: 7 hours 45 minutes
Gold Group weekly training volume: 9 hours 15 minutes
This represents a 22.8 percent increase in structured training exposure.
For an athlete performing at A standard in multiple events, denial of appropriate training volume constitutes a material developmental restriction. Continued placement below performance level directly impacts competitive progression and future opportunity.

## III. Technical Deficiency in Placement Criteria

The continued reliance on freestyle benchmarks as the primary gatekeeping metric is inconsistent with broader competitive swimming standards.
• USA Swimming Motivational Standards recognize performance across all strokes.
• ASCA development principles require stroke specific neuromuscular reinforcement for specialists.
• Long Term Athlete Development modeling identifies early non freestyle stroke proficiency as a leading indicator of long-term competitive viability.
• Regional North Texas programs promote based on verified meet data and tier standards rather than isolated stroke bias.
[redacted] currently meets or exceeds A tier standards in breaststroke events. Placement decisions that disregard these standards lack objective consistency.

## IV. Notice of Intent

If this matter is not resolved at Level 1 through immediate promotion to the Gold practice group, I will proceed through all formal grievance levels available under Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG Local.
Further, I am prepared to pursue external legal review regarding:
• Inconsistent application of advancement standards
• Arbitrary and capricious placement methodology
• Developmental harm resulting from denial of appropriate training volume
• Potential exposure arising from unequal application of published or customary criteria
This letter should be understood as formal notice that I am prepared to protect my child’s athletic development through all available administrative and legal channels.

## Requested Resolution

Immediate promotion of [redacted] Ray Jordan to the Gold practice group and implementation of the 9 hour 15 minute weekly training schedule without further delay.
This request is supported by objective data, industry standards, and developmental best practice.
I expect written confirmation of corrective action.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:36 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
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**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good Afternoon Mr. Jordan,

I just wanted to let you know that your email has been received, and I will touch base with athletics and someone will be in contact with you to discuss your concerns.

Sincerely,

FRISCO ISD

**Cory McClendon**
*Chief Leadership/Student Services Officer*
469.633.6021
mcclendc@friscoisd.org

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:18 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

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**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
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<ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; 'manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
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**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

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[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

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Best regards,
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**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

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Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,

Stephen Jordan

**From:** Kolni, Esther
**Sent:** Tue, 3 Mar 2026 14:47:10 +0000
**To:** Stephen Jordan
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA; Complaint Resolution
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan - Please provide all supplemental information related to your grievance directly to the assigned hearing officer only. If you would like to include a second recipient, you may copy our complaints resolution email address at ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org. The Formal Grievance process is a stepped process that begins at Level I with your assigned hearing officer, Ms. Howard. If you appeal her findings, the District will need to assign your complaint to a person who can look at the issues with fresh eyes, without having previously been exposed to your concerns. I've asked those not directly involved at this level not to read of respond to your grievance material to maintain the efficacy of the grievance process.

Best,

FRISCO ISD

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:26 PM
**To:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear All,
This correspondence serves as a formal evidentiary supplement to the Level 1 Grievance concerning the practice group placement of [redacted] Ray Jordan.
This submission contains:

1. Objective performance data from the February 27 to March 1, 2026 COR Swim Meet
2. A technical analysis of the current placement methodology

3. A comparative review of North Texas competitive swimming standards
4. Notice of intent regarding further action should corrective measures not be taken

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## I. Objective Performance Data

**Junior and Senior COR Swim Meet – Garland, Texas**

[redacted] demonstrated measurable and significant improvement across multiple events and achieved USA Swimming A Motivational Standards in three events.

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 200 Yard IM | 2:37.61 | 2:33.81 | 3.80 | 2.41 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Fly | 1:12.02 | 1:09.39 | 2.63 | 1.67 percent | — |
| 50 Yard Breast | 36.16 | 35.04 | 1.12 | 0.71 percent | A Time |
| 200 Yard Breast | 2:51.55 | 2:45.63 | 5.92 | 3.76 percent | A Time |
| 50 Yard Fly | 31.66 | 31.56 | 0.10 | 0.06 percent | — |
| 100 Yard IM | 1:12.53 | 1:12.20 | 0.33 | 0.21 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Breast | 1:19.20 | 1:17.11 | 2.09 | 1.33 percent | A Time |

These results are objective, verifiable, and attached as an official meet record.

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## II. Training Volume Disparity

Silver Group weekly training volume: 7 hours 45 minutes
Gold Group weekly training volume: 9 hours 15 minutes
This represents a 22.8 percent increase in structured training exposure.
For an athlete performing at A standard in multiple events, denial of appropriate training volume constitutes a material developmental restriction. Continued placement below performance level directly impacts competitive progression and future opportunity.

---

## III. Technical Deficiency in Placement Criteria

The continued reliance on freestyle benchmarks as the primary gatekeeping metric is inconsistent with broader competitive swimming standards.
• USA Swimming Motivational Standards recognize performance across all strokes.
• ASCA development principles require stroke specific neuromuscular reinforcement for specialists.
• Long Term Athlete Development modeling identifies early non freestyle stroke proficiency as a leading indicator of long-term competitive viability.
• Regional North Texas programs promote based on verified meet data and tier standards rather than isolated stroke bias.
[redacted] currently meets or exceeds A tier standards in breaststroke events. Placement decisions that disregard these standards lack objective consistency.

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## IV. Notice of Intent

If this matter is not resolved at Level 1 through immediate promotion to the Gold practice group, I will proceed through all formal grievance levels available under Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG Local.

Further, I am prepared to pursue external legal review regarding:

• Inconsistent application of advancement standards
• Arbitrary and capricious placement methodology
• Developmental harm resulting from denial of appropriate training volume
• Potential exposure arising from unequal application of published or customary criteria

This letter should be understood as formal notice that I am prepared to protect my child's athletic development through all available administrative and legal channels.

---

## Requested Resolution

Immediate promotion of [redacted] Ray Jordan to the Gold practice group and implementation of the 9 hour 15 minute weekly training schedule without further delay. This request is supported by objective data, industry standards, and developmental best practice.

I expect written confirmation of corrective action.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:36 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good Afternoon Mr. Jordan,

I just wanted to let you know that your email has been received, and I will touch base with athletics and someone will be in contact with you to discuss your concerns.

Sincerely,

**Cory McClendon**
*Chief Leadership/Student Services Officer*
469.633.6021
mcclendc@friscoisd.org

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:18 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

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**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am following up on my previous email as I have yet to receive a response. Please be advised that I am committed to seeing this matter through to a resolution that ensures transparency and equity for all swimmers in the program.
My concerns regarding the **misrepresentation of program status** are based on the following written communications I received on February 2, 2026:

- **From Justin Bilgri:** *"Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March."*
- **From Daiki Sato:** *"To be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin."*.

**I am requesting the following actions be taken by the FISD Athletic Department:**

1. **Administrative Review:** I request that [redacted] **Janak**, as the direct supervisor, provide a written explanation for why parents were provided with inaccurate information regarding athlete promotions.
2. **Accountability:** I am asking for a formal review of the conduct of Coaches Sato and Bilgri regarding their communication standards with parents.
3. **Leadership Oversight:** I request that the district evaluate the management practices under the current Head Coach to ensure an environment of honesty and equity.
4. **Placement Resolution:** To rectify the current disparity, I request that [redacted] be placed in the **Gold group**, or that the status of other athletes be returned to **Silver** to align with the timeline previously communicated to me.

I look forward to a prompt response from the management team regarding the steps being taken to address these discrepancies.
Sincerely,
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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---

**From:** Stephen Jordan
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:24 PM
**To:** 'BILGRI, JUSTIN' <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; ', [redacted] Janak' <janakj@friscoisd.org>; 'Melissa Howard' <howardme@friscoisd.org>; 'Chris Burtch' <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; 'Deidra Rucker' <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; ',' <leaders@friscoisd.org>; 'davisdy@friscoisd.org' <davisdy@friscoisd.org>; 'elads@friscoisd.org' <elads@friscoisd.org>; 'hillmark@friscoisd.org' <hillmark@friscoisd.org>; 'ddoxk@friscoisd.org' <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; 'manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Grievance Regarding Iron Horse Aquatics Placement – Stephen Jordan

**Dear Coach Franks, FISD Board of Directors, and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am writing to file a formal complaint regarding the recent placement and promotion decisions within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.
Both you and Coach Daiki explicitly informed me that [redacted] was not being promoted. I have since discovered this was untrue. This lack of transparency is unacceptable, but more concerning is the apparent **conflict of interest** regarding this decision.
Because DR. [redacted] mother is an Assistant Principal within Frisco ISD, it appears that she is receiving **preferential treatment** for her child that is not being afforded to other families. Using a district position to influence athletic promotions undermines the "power of one" and the equity Frisco ISD claims to uphold.
Due to this ethical concern and the misinformation provided to me, I am requesting the following immediate action:

1. **Placement Equity:** Promote [redacted] into the **Gold group** immediately, OR
2. **Reversion:** Move [redacted] back into the **Silver group** to reflect the standards previously communicated to me.

I am copying the Frisco ISD Athletic Department leadership to ensure this matter, and the potential misuse of district influence—is properly documented. I expect a formal response addressing these inconsistencies and a resolution to the placement issue.
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

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**From:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

To provide additional context, the current group averages for the boys in Gold are:

- 50 Free: 24–28 seconds
- 100 Free: 53–1:04
- 200 Free: 2:00–2:15

At this time, [redacted] is below these benchmark ranges in his freestyle events. His breaststroke is stronger and aligns more closely with the rest of the group. However, breaststroke is not the primary focus of daily training in Gold. Approximately 80% of weekly practices emphasize freestyle, as it forms the foundation of conditioning and overall development. Due to the physical strain that breaststroke and butterfly place on the body, training cannot be centered exclusively on those strokes.

For [redacted] to align more closely with the group standard and continue progressing long term, improving his freestyle will be key. I'm confident that with consistent focus and effort, he will continue to make strong gains across all events.

If you would like anymore clarification. We can schedule a meeting with Coach Daiki and I next week.

Best regards,
Justin Bilgri

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, February 24, 2026 9:43 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Coach Bilgri,
I hope you are doing well. I wanted to reach out regarding [redacted] current placement in the Silver group.
[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.
I am concerned about the consistency of this arrangement. If swimmers of similar competitive level are being treated differently, it can feel inequitable to the athletes who are putting in the same effort.
With that in mind, I would respectfully request one of the following:
• If [redacted] is going to continue practicing with Gold, I would ask that [redacted] be given the same opportunity.
• Alternatively, if group placement standards require swimmers to remain in their designated practice group, then those standards should apply consistently.
• Ideally, I would appreciate a formal evaluation of [redacted] for promotion to the Gold group if he meets the criteria.
Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?
Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.
Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

## Stephen Jordan

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 4:37 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan; McClendon, Cory
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW; SATO, DAIKI; BILGRI, JUSTIN; RUCKER, DEIDRA; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Hello Mr. Jordan,

As per my previous email, we are still open to meeting with you and will schedule that meeting for Tuesday, March 3rd at 1:30pm. If this is not sufficient, you are welcome to continue the complaint process. Our goal is to support your son and his success both in and out of the pool. We hope to discuss this with you on Tuesday.

Thank you,

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 4:04 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Howard,
Following up on my previous message, I am available for the meeting on either Tuesday (3/3) or Wednesday (3/4) at 1:30 PM. As I requested, I would like Coach Franks to be present in addition to Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato to ensure all involved individuals are represented.
Before we meet, I would like to clarify where we are in the Frisco ISD process. Based on your correspondence, it appears we are currently at **Step 1 (Contact involved individual)** moving into **Step 2 (Contact campus administrator)**.
I want to be clear that my goal for this meeting is a good-faith negotiation regarding [redacted] placement based on his performance in the 50 BR, 100 BR, 50 FL and 100 FL, which meet the competitive standards for the Gold group. If the district's position is that the current placement is final and non-negotiable regardless of the technical data provided, please let me know.

If your minds are already made up and the meeting is simply to restate a fixed decision, I would prefer to forgo the informal meeting and proceed directly to a **Level 1 Formal Complaint** as outlined in Board Policy FNG(Local).
Please confirm if the district is open to a reconsideration of [redacted] placement during this meeting, or if the current decision is considered final.
Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 3:13 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Either day is fine with me. I also want Coach Franks at this meeting.

Get Outlook for Android

---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 3:00:35 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

Based on our initial review of facts following receipt of your email, it is clear you have a misunderstanding of what has occurred. However, we are prohibited by law from providing you with information regarding another student. Please note that practice group decisions are based on a variety of factors, including the rationale provided to you at this point. There is no evidence that practice group decisions were based on any other factor.

We are happy to discuss this matter with you further but please know that we will continue to be limited by student privacy laws. If you wish to meet to discuss your concerns, I, Coach Bilgri and Coach Sato will be available at 1:30pm either Tuesday (3/3/26) or Wednesday (3/4/26) next week. If you wish to file a formal complaint with Frisco ISD, you may file a Level 1 complaint through the District's grievance process as outlined on our website. You have 30 days from receipt of this correspondence, which includes both a detailed description of the Frisco ISD decision as well as instructions for how to file a complaint. All timelines as outlined in Board Policy FNG(Local) will be strictly enforced.

Please let us know how you would like to proceed.
Thank you.



**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:17 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

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**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
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My concerns regarding the **misrepresentation of program status** are based on the following written communications I received on February 2, 2026:

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- **From Daiki Sato:** *"To be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin."*.

**I am requesting the following actions be taken by the FISD Athletic Department:**

1. **Administrative Review:** I request that [redacted] **Janak**, as the direct supervisor, provide a written explanation for why parents were provided with inaccurate information regarding athlete promotions.
2. **Accountability:** I am asking for a formal review of the conduct of Coaches Sato and Bilgri regarding their communication standards with parents.
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4. **Placement Resolution:** To rectify the current disparity, I request that [redacted] be placed in the **Gold group**, or that the status of other athletes be returned to **Silver** to align with the timeline previously communicated to me.

I look forward to a prompt response from the management team regarding the steps being taken to address these discrepancies.
Sincerely,
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** Stephen Jordan
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:24 PM
**To:** 'BILGRI, JUSTIN' <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; ', [redacted] Janak' <janakj@friscoisd.org>; 'Melissa Howard' <howardme@friscoisd.org>; 'Chris Burtch' <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; 'Deidra Rucker' <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; ',' <leaders@friscoisd.org>; 'davisdy@friscoisd.org' <davisdy@friscoisd.org>; 'elads@friscoisd.org' <elads@friscoisd.org>; 'hillmark@friscoisd.org' <hillmark@friscoisd.org>; 'ddoxk@friscoisd.org' <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; 'manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Grievance Regarding Iron Horse Aquatics Placement – Stephen Jordan

**Dear Coach Franks, FISD Board of Directors, and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am writing to file a formal complaint regarding the recent placement and promotion decisions within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.
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Because DR. [redacted] mother is an Assistant Principal within Frisco ISD, it appears that she is receiving **preferential treatment** for her child that is not being afforded to other families. Using a district position to influence athletic promotions undermines the "power of one" and the equity Frisco ISD claims to uphold.
Due to this ethical concern and the misinformation provided to me, I am requesting the following immediate action:

1. **Placement Equity:** Promote [redacted] into the **Gold group** immediately, OR
2. **Reversion:** Move [redacted] back into the **Silver group** to reflect the standards previously communicated to me.

I am copying the Frisco ISD Athletic Department leadership to ensure this matter, and the potential misuse of district influence—is properly documented. I expect a formal response addressing these inconsistencies and a resolution to the placement issue.
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

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---

**From:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

To provide additional context, the current group averages for the boys in Gold are:

- 50 Free: 24–28 seconds
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At this time, [redacted] is below these benchmark ranges in his freestyle events. His breaststroke is stronger and aligns more closely with the rest of the group. However, breaststroke is not the primary focus of daily training in Gold. Approximately 80% of weekly practices emphasize freestyle, as it forms the foundation of conditioning and overall development. Due to the physical strain that breaststroke and butterfly place on the body, training cannot be centered exclusively on those strokes.

For [redacted] to align more closely with the group standard and continue progressing long term, improving his freestyle will be key. I'm confident that with consistent focus and effort, he will continue to make strong gains across all events.

If you would like anymore clarification. We can schedule a meeting with Coach Daiki and I next week.

Best regards,
Justin Bilgri

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, February 24, 2026 9:43 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

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Dear Coach Bilgri,
I hope you are doing well. I wanted to reach out regarding [redacted] current placement in the Silver group.

[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.

I am concerned about the consistency of this arrangement. If swimmers of similar competitive level are being treated differently, it can feel inequitable to the athletes who are putting in the same effort.

With that in mind, I would respectfully request one of the following:

• If [redacted] is going to continue practicing with Gold, I would ask that [redacted] be given the same opportunity.

• Alternatively, if group placement standards require swimmers to remain in their designated practice group, then those standards should apply consistently.

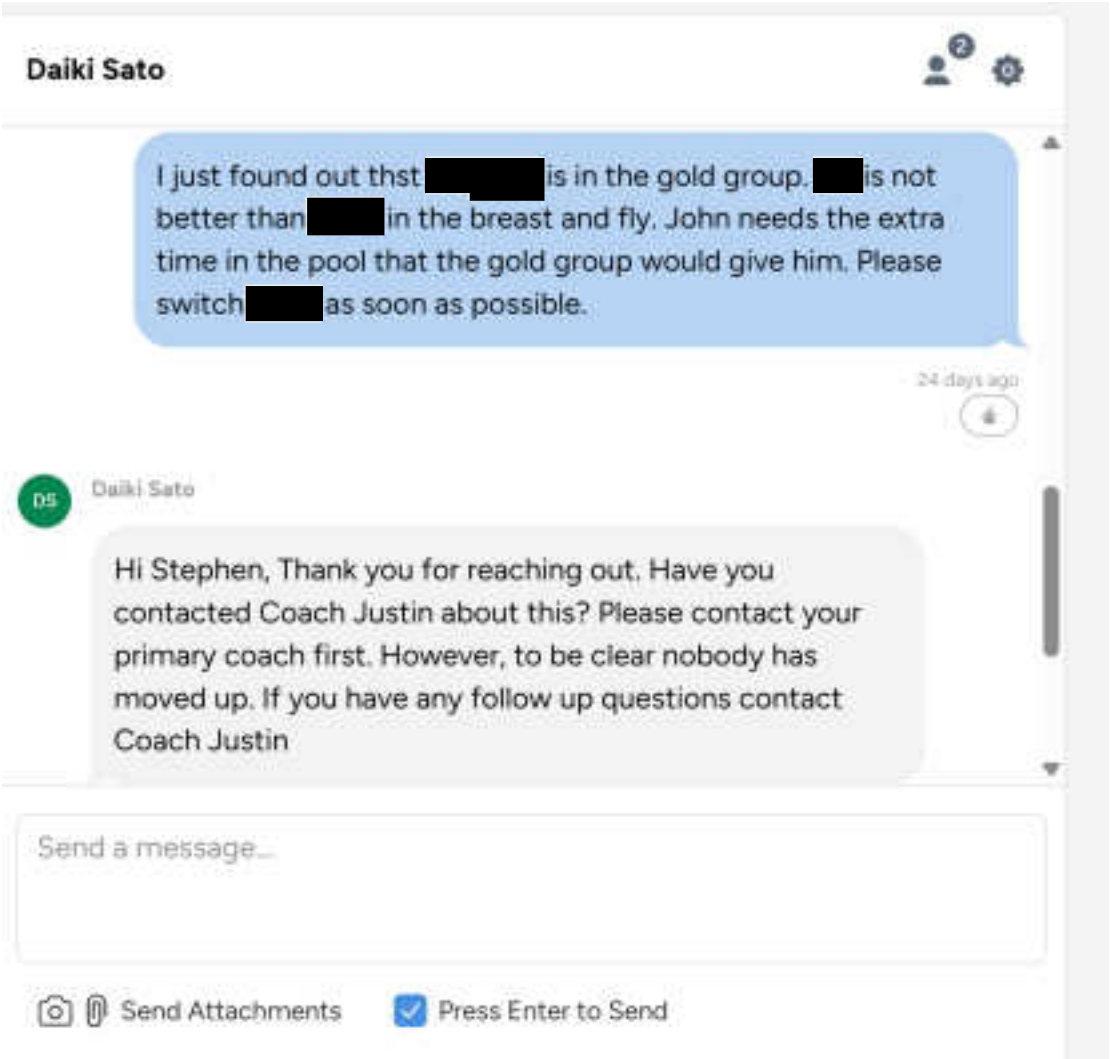
• Ideally, I would appreciate a formal evaluation of [redacted] for promotion to the Gold group if he meets the criteria.

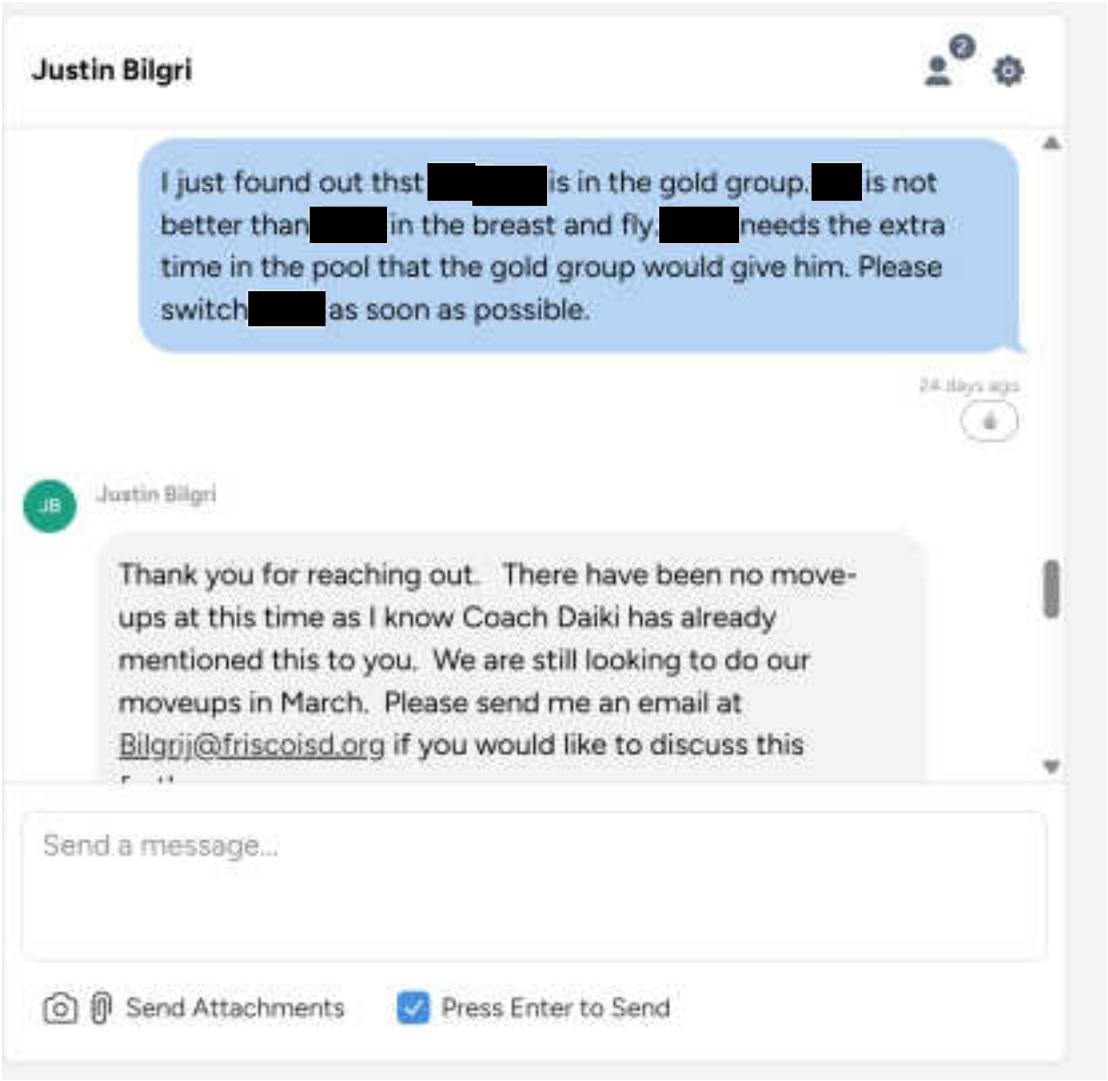
Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?

Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,

Stephen Jordan


Daiki Sato
I just found out thst [redacted] is in the gold group. [redacted] is not better than [redacted] in the breast and fly. John needs the extra time in the pool that the gold group would give him. Please switch [redacted] as soon as possible.
24 days ago
DS
Daiki Sato
Hi Stephen, Thank you for reaching out. Have you contacted Coach Justin about this? Please contact your primary coach first. However, to be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin
Send a message...
Send Attachments
Press Enter to Send


Justin Bilgri
I just found out thst [redacted] is in the gold group, [redacted] is not better than [redacted] in the breast and fly. [redacted] needs the extra time in the pool that the gold group would give him. Please switch [redacted] as soon as possible.
24 days ago
JB
Justin Bilgri
Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March. Please send me an email at Bilgrij@friscoisd.org if you would like to discuss this
Send a message...
Send Attachments
Press Enter to Send

5515 Ohio Drive
Frisco, Texas 75035
469.633.6000
469.633.6050 (fax)
www.friscoisd.org

May 18, 2026

Stephen Jordan
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

RE: Level II Grievance Response

Dear Mr. Jordan,

This letter is written in response to your Level II complaint appeal filed on April 28, 2026, pursuant to the Frisco Independent School District ("Frisco ISD" or "the District") Administrative Complaint Process. The Level II complaint conference occurred on May 5, 2026, at the Frisco ISD Athletic Offices. During the conference, you were provided the opportunity to present your concerns and all evidence you believed relevant to your complaint. This response is timely provided in accordance with the Frisco ISD Administrative Complaint Process.

The Level II complaint, requesting that advancement criteria within the Iron Horse program be clearly defined, measurable, and consistently applied across all swimmers, has been reviewed.

Specifically, the complaint requested that the program provide you with:

- Specific performance thresholds required for advancement;
- The number of qualifying standards necessary for advancement; and
- Timelines for advancement once standards are achieved.

Following the Level II conference, I conducted a thorough review and investigation, including, but not limited to:

- Reviewing all documentation you provided.
- Reviewing current group advancement procedures.
- Reviewing Frisco ISD District Academic Guides.
- Reviewing advancement criteria utilized within the program; and
- Reviewing USA Swimming recommendations and best practices regarding group placement.

Based upon my review of the evidence, my findings regarding your Level II Complaint are as follows:

- Your allegation that Iron Horse group advancement procedures are inconsistently applied across all swimmers is **unsubstantiated**.

If Frisco ISD offers a course for credit purposes, the District must provide parents of enrolled students with access to either an instructional plan or course syllabus outlining what is taught within the course and the requirements for successful course completion. This requirement is established under Senate Bill 12 through Texas Education Code Sec. 26.0062. However, the law does not require districts to publish an instructional plan or course syllabus for extra-curricular activities. Additionally, even for athletic activities or programs that provide some course credit opportunities, school districts are not required to establish or publish advancement criteria between internal training groups, levels, or practice squads such as “Gold,” Plantium,” or other performance-based groupings.

Additionally, participation in Off Campus Physical Education (OCPE), including swimming programs, is governed by Frisco ISD’s established OCPE and Middle School Physical Education guidelines. These guidelines outline eligibility requirements, participation expectations, attendance requirements, grading expectations, and course credit requirements for students participating in approved off-campus programs.

Frisco ISD has met its requirements for the Iron Horse program. We encourage you to review the Frisco ISD Middle School PE and Off Campus PE guidelines for additional information regarding program expectations and requirements.

- Frisco ISD Middle School Academic Guide
- Frisco ISD Off Campus Physical Education Guidelines

After consideration of the Level I record and the information provided to me at the Level II Grievance Hearing, you have not demonstrated that Iron Horse or Frisco ISD has acted arbitrarily or capriciously, in bad faith, or in violation of district policy, state law, or federal law. Accordingly, I am upholding the Level I decision and denying your appeal.

If you have questions regarding the timeline applicable to an appeal, please contact the Office of the Deputy Superintendent of Schools at complaintresolution@friscoisd.org.

Sincerely,

Deidra Rucker

Associate Director of Athletics

3/6/26

Mr. Steven Jordan - Level 1 Hearing

- SportsYou screenshots
- extra lessons/training being provided
- A times as 11 yr old
- achieved times Feb 28 - Mar 1
- why the push to deviate strokes when he excels at breaststroke?
- Group standards are not clearly listed
- Iron Horse / FISO -> transparency important
- ChatGPT / Gemini
- Tech v Phys
  - John promotion
  - Transparency

# Audio file

Level 1 Hearing S. Jordan.m4a

# Transcript

00:00:04 Speaker 1

Today is Friday, March 6th, 2026, and the time is 1122.

00:00:10 Speaker 1

My name is Melissa Howard.

00:00:11 Speaker 1

I'm the Frisco ISD swim and dive coordinator, and I'm the administrator designated to serve as the hearing officer for this matter.

00:00:18 Speaker 1

We are meeting to consider a level 1 complaint at the request of Mr.

00:00:21 Speaker 1

Stephen Jordan.

00:00:22 Speaker 1

This meeting is taking place at the FISD Administration Building.

00:00:26 Speaker 1

located at 5515 Ohio Drive, Frisco, Texas, 75035, and is being held in accordance with the Frisco ISD administrative complaint process.

00:00:37 Speaker 1

At this time, will you please state your name and your role or relationship to the individual who has requested the conference?

00:00:43 Speaker 2

My name is Stephen Ray Jordan, and I'm the father of [redacted] Ray Jordan, who is a student for the Frisco Independent School District.

00:00:53 Speaker 2

level 6, and he attends [redacted] Middle School.

00:00:57 Speaker 1

Okay, thank you.

00:00:59 Speaker 1

The purpose of this conference is for the complainant to present information and evidence relevant to the complaint.

00:01:05 Speaker 1

Following this conference, I will complete a thorough investigation, including a review of the information presented in this conference, and render a decision regarding the complaint and the requested remedies.

00:01:16 Speaker 1

All participants should refrain from talking when another person is speaking,

00:01:20 Speaker 1

so that the recording will accurately reflect the proceedings.

00:01:24 Speaker 1

Further, please make statements as clear and complete as possible.

00:01:28 Speaker 1

Remember that the recording will not reflect the gestures or any other form of nonverbal communications.

00:01:34 Speaker 1

In order to ensure the recording accurately reflects who is speaking, please state your name prior to making statements.

00:01:40 Speaker 1

A Level 1 complaint conference is not like a trial, but instead is an administrative proceeding.

00:01:46 Speaker 1

As such, neither the complainant nor myself will call witnesses or cross-examine any participant.

00:01:52 Speaker 1

This is simply an opportunity for the complainant to present information and evidence relevant to the complaint.

00:01:58 Speaker 1

As a reminder, this is your opportunity to provide all relevant information related to your Level 1 complaint.

00:02:04 Speaker 1

Therefore, I urge you to present the issues, describe the specific allegations of your complaint, and state the specific remedies you are requesting.

00:02:12 Speaker 1

I've allotted 30 minutes for your presentation.

00:02:15 Speaker 1

You may also, excuse me, I'm here to listen, not to answer questions, offer opinions, give advice, or render any decisions during this conference.

00:02:25 Speaker 1

However, I may ask clarifying questions during or after your presentation.

00:02:30 Speaker 1

Your presentation should include all information relevant to your complaint.

00:02:34 Speaker 1

At this time, you may present the information and evidence relevant to your complaint.

00:02:39 Speaker 1

If you have any documents you would like me to consider, you may present them as well.

00:02:46 Speaker 2

Okay, ready to get started?

00:02:47 Speaker 1

Yes, sir.

00:02:48 Speaker 2

First of all, I don't know if you're aware of this yet.

00:02:52 Speaker 2

I've filed an ethics violation against both coaches.

00:02:57 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:02:57 Speaker 2

So I don't know if you've been apprised of that yet or not.

00:03:01 Speaker 2

But your coaches clearly stated to me that they were not promoting one of the individuals that we've

00:03:13 Speaker 2

question about in our communication.

00:03:17 Speaker 2

And I have written proof here that they clearly misled me into believing that there was no promotion occurring at that point.

00:03:27 Speaker 2

Let me show you.

00:03:31 Speaker 2

This comes from Sports U, which is our communication channel for Iron Horse Aquatics.

00:03:39 Speaker 2

And this is how we communicate with the coaches.

00:03:45 Speaker 2

Let's see here.

00:03:53 Speaker 2

Let me find this real quick.

00:04:00 Speaker 2

So clearly here, this is from Coach.

00:04:10 Speaker 2

I can't pronounce his name correctly.

00:04:13 Speaker 2

apologize, Daki Sato.

00:04:15 Speaker 1

Yes, sir.

00:04:16 Speaker 2

And here he talks about that nobody has been moved up or promoted.

00:04:21 Speaker 2

So this is, that's a direct screenshot from the chat that we use to communicate.

00:04:30 Speaker 2

And then Coach Bill Green, here he says that nobody has been moved up.

00:04:40 Speaker 2

So completely misleading a misstatement of the facts because I found out a few days ago that the individual that's named has been practicing with the gold group.

00:04:59 Speaker 2

Even though they haven't officially promoted him, they've gone and been, I'm sorry, in my opinion,

00:05:09 Speaker 2

They have been going around me by saying that he is not promoted, but yet he is practicing and getting all the benefits of the Gold Group.

00:05:20 Speaker 1

And this is not your son that you're referring to.

00:05:23 Speaker 2

That's correct.

00:05:24 Speaker 2

Okay.

00:05:25 Speaker 2

So they have made promotions without clearly stating it.

00:05:33 Speaker 2

So that I can't agree with.

00:05:37 Speaker 1

And just to clarify, you did state that you understand it was not an official move up.

00:05:45 Speaker 2

It's not an official move up, but he's getting the benefit of the gold group.

00:05:50 Speaker 2

He's getting the extra time in the pool, and he's getting the training of the gold group.

00:05:56 Speaker 2

And I believe that he's benefiting from that.

00:06:02 Speaker 2

And if that's the case, then I believe my son could be promoted without being promoted and still get the extra time in the swim pool, too, without being promoted to gold.

00:06:13 Speaker 2

That would be an acceptable situation for me.

00:06:18 Speaker 2

Now, the other thing is, the coaches receive extra funds every weekend.

00:06:27 Speaker 2

They train

00:06:28 Speaker 2

individuals in the groups that are willing for people that pay extra, they get extra training.

00:06:39 Speaker 2

If you want to pay extra, they get extra training.

00:06:41 Speaker 2

And I know this for a fact.

00:06:43 Speaker 1

So through the clinics.

00:06:44 Speaker 2

Well, it's not the clinics, individual training.

00:06:48 Speaker 2

And if those coaches receive money, and then at the same time, they are determining their move-ups,

00:06:56 Speaker 2

that's clearly in conflict with the ethics of this school district.

00:07:02 Speaker 2

So I know that the individual that it's being named, I'm doing my best to leave him out of this, but I have no choice that he is gaining from this.

00:07:18 Speaker 2

My son is not.

00:07:19 Speaker 2

My wife has put pressure on me to put him with the coach.

00:07:23 Speaker 2

And I just believe that he should be getting all the training and attention he needs in his individual practices every day without paying extra for it.

00:07:39 Speaker 2

So that will be a separate administrative process with the Frisco Independent School District.

00:07:52 Speaker 2

Okay.

00:07:53 Speaker 2

So now I'd like to present why [redacted] should just be in the goal group regardless of the behavior of the coaches.

00:08:03 Speaker 2

Last year, [redacted] was 10 years old and had some very good times.

00:08:13 Speaker 2

He is both AA and AAA in the breaststroke.

00:08:18 Speaker 2

He is.

00:08:20 Speaker 1

Is that as a 10 year old or as an 11?

00:08:22 Speaker 2

Year old?

00:08:22 Speaker 2

10 year old and as an 11 year old now.

00:08:24 Speaker 2

He is now in a times now as an 11 year old.

00:08:31 Speaker 2

So very good.

00:08:34 Speaker 2

His last swim meet in all strokes, he improved his times and I was very, very proud of him.

00:08:42 Speaker 1

Now was this last meet, when did this take place?

00:08:45 Speaker 2

Just about a week ago, last week in fact.

00:08:48 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:08:49 Speaker 1

So that was just March 6th.

00:08:52 Speaker 1

So that was the.

00:08:53 Speaker 2

27th through the March 1st.

00:08:55 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:09:01 Speaker 2

And in fact, the person that I refused to name, he beat him in both breaststrokes.

00:09:08 Speaker 2

And he also came within less than,

00:09:13 Speaker 2

half a second of beating him in the 200 IM, which is the closest he's ever come to that particular individual.

00:09:20 Speaker 2

So his times now are just great.

00:09:23 Speaker 2

He's improving in the fly.

00:09:25 Speaker 2

He's improving in the individual medley.

00:09:28 Speaker 2

He is doing extremely well.

00:09:30 Speaker 2

He's the top-rated 11-year-old in the breaststroke in Iron Horse.

00:09:34 Speaker 2

Nobody can come close to him.

00:09:36 Speaker 2

Within a few months, he'll be beating all the 12-year-olds.

00:09:42 Speaker 2

[redacted] has, for some reason, since he was a little boy, has excelled.

00:09:47 Speaker 2

at the brushstroke.

00:09:48 Speaker 2

Why?

00:09:49 Speaker 2

I don't know.

00:09:52 Speaker 2

But he does real well in the brushstroke and it tends to spill over into the fly stroke.

00:09:59 Speaker 2

Not quite as much, but it does.

00:10:02 Speaker 2

And there seems to be pushing by coaches to keep him into the, I guess you call that the American Crawl.

00:10:13 Speaker 2

I don't know what you call that.

00:10:14 Speaker 2

Freestyle.

00:10:14 Speaker 2

Freestyle.

00:10:15 Speaker 2

I'm sorry, freestyle.

00:10:17 Speaker 2

And he keeps improving his times.

00:10:21 Speaker 2

He's even swam the 500 meter in freestyle, but his breaststroke just keeps excelling.

00:10:32 Speaker 2

And I'm wondering why they keep forcing him in one area when he shows complete mastery of one particular stroke.

00:10:46 Speaker 2

Now, I have looked up-- I've got all this documented, by the way.

00:10:57 Speaker 2

I'll give you all of this documentation.

00:11:02 Speaker 2

But anyway, I've looked up his strokes, and he's doing real well in the 100 meter breast.

00:11:12 Speaker 2

I looked at USA Swimming and he was rated, I don't know, number 215 out of how many, I don't know, USA swimming tracks.

00:11:22 Speaker 2

So he's climbing very quickly.

00:11:24 Speaker 2

He's only been 11 years old since last August, so I think his times will improve dramatically.

00:11:31 Speaker 2

He's given that opportunity.

00:11:35 Speaker 2

Now,

00:11:37 Speaker 2

One thing I've looked at, and I disagreed with the Iron Horse, is they won't publicly announce what times they need for move-ups.

00:11:56 Speaker 2

And I've looked at clubs across the United States, but primarily I've focused on Texas, and I've got documentation here

00:12:07 Speaker 2

that the movement in Texas is toward transparency and that they're trying to advertise more and more what the times are.

00:12:17 Speaker 2

Coaches seem in the private clubs to be reluctant to give up that ownership of stating when one student is promoted and when another one is not promoted, but I believe that will change in time.

00:12:32 Speaker 2

But Ion Horse is part of a public

00:12:36 Speaker 2

organization and transparency is very, very important.

00:12:41 Speaker 2

And I believe that they need to document the move-ups and the times and exactly what's required.

00:12:48 Speaker 2

And I've got what different groups require.

00:12:56 Speaker 2

Also, I wanted to talk about one other thing, the myth of the freestyle gatekeeper.

00:13:05 Speaker 2

So clearly, I want to read this into the record.

00:13:09 Speaker 2

The aerobic engine principle.

00:13:11 Speaker 2

A swimmer's heart and lungs do not distinguish between strokes.

00:13:15 Speaker 2

An athlete who can swim a 2.45.63, 200 brass possesses an aerobic capacity that far exceeds the development goals of the silver group.

00:13:26 Speaker 2

To deny him gold yardage because of a freestyle checkbox is to start his aerobic engine of the volume it requires to grow.

00:13:37 Speaker 1

And what is your source on that topic?

00:13:39 Speaker 2

This is from this is from ChatGPT and from Gemini Pro.

00:13:56 Speaker 2

Also, technical versus

00:14:04 Speaker 2

Physiological growth, stroke work, freestyle can be corrected in a gold environment.

00:14:09 Speaker 2

However, physiological growth, endurance cannot be achieved in a silver environment that lacks the necessary yardage and intensity.

00:14:20 Speaker 2

All right, so those are my main points.

00:14:23 Speaker 2

One is transparency, clubs.

00:14:26 Speaker 2

Oh, I'm sorry, I should have covered this.

00:14:40 Speaker 2

I'd go into more details in all of these areas and also outline what the Iron Horse states it requires for move up on their website.

00:14:51 Speaker 2

But I've outlined Texas Ford Aquatics, Lakeside Athletics, LAC, whatever it stands for, NTN, Waterloo Swimming, Madison Aquatic Center, Kingfish Swimming, and Lakeside Aquatic Club North Texas.

00:15:08 Speaker 2

All of them are moving toward transparency and specific metrics for promotion.

00:15:15 Speaker 2

One in particular here, Waterloo, defines readiness using a multiple three cuts and two strokes or full program, five cuts and three strokes system.

00:15:26 Speaker 2

So,

00:15:27 Speaker 2

[redacted] just based on him attaining A in both the 50/100 and the 200 breaststroke, would qualify him for promotion in any one of those groups.

00:15:39 Speaker 2

And him being an AA and AAA as a 10-year-old would have already have moved him up into the gold group coming right out of the 10-year-old into the 11-year-old.

00:15:51 Speaker 2

So I believe that transparency

00:15:57 Speaker 2

comparison to other swim clubs and markets.

00:16:00 Speaker 2

By the way, these are private clubs.

00:16:03 Speaker 2

There's not many clubs owned by school districts, so the comparisons are a little more difficult, but I believe in time I could do my market research and find those comparisons.

00:16:15 Speaker 2

So it is my hope that Iron Horse will publicly state what it takes to get moved up in the future

00:16:26 Speaker 2

and make that available to all the swimmers.

00:16:33 Speaker 2

So basically, I believe that [redacted] can XLS in the breast.

00:16:40 Speaker 2

He will continue to do well in other strokes.

00:16:45 Speaker 2

I'm committed next year.

00:16:46 Speaker 2

This year, I put him in.

00:16:50 Speaker 2

I did not have him go through PE in school.

00:16:54 Speaker 2

I had him do the off-campus PE because I believed he was getting enough and I didn't want to burn him out.

00:17:00 Speaker 2

But next year I'm going to commit him to doing strength and conditioning in the 7th grade to help improve his score.

00:17:11 Speaker 2

But I would like to see extra time in the pool for [redacted] so that he can attain whatever times that he's hoping to attain with the swim group.

00:17:25 Speaker 2

Okay, and so those are my main presentations, but I've got it all here and I'm going to give this to you.

00:17:32 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:17:35 Speaker 1

All right, and you are done with your presentation of your information.

00:17:39 Speaker 2

Yes, ma'am.

00:17:41 Speaker 1

Okay, so based on the information you presented, it is my understanding that the allegations raised in your complaints are basically two things.

00:17:50 Speaker 1

You are wanting [redacted] to be promoted to a

00:17:53 Speaker 1

the gold group based on his abilities.

00:17:56 Speaker 2

Or get more time in the pool.

00:17:59 Speaker 1

And you would like to see more transparency on group promotion?

00:18:03 Speaker 2

Yes, ma'am.

00:18:04 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:18:04 Speaker 1

Is there anything else that I missed in there?

00:18:06 Speaker 2

No, ma'am.

00:18:20 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:18:20 Speaker 1

And as I understand it, you are requesting the following remedies that [redacted] be moved up to the gold group and that then there is more clarification on group

00:18:31 Speaker 1

designations from the Iron Horse Aquatics.

00:18:34 Speaker 2

And I'm willing to work with the group if they feel that he can get more time in the pool without promoting to gold.

00:18:40 Speaker 2

I'm willing to accept that.

00:18:42 Speaker 2

But he's got to get more time in the group without being forced to be paid, me paying some coach to get that extra time.

00:18:49 Speaker 1

Okay.

00:18:49 Speaker 1

All right.

00:18:52 Speaker 1

Is there anything else?

00:18:53 Speaker 2

No, ma'am.

00:18:54 Speaker 2

That's it.

00:18:54 Speaker 1

All right.

00:18:55 Speaker 1

Pursuant to the Frisco ISD administrative complaint process,

00:18:59 Speaker 1

I will provide you with a written response within 20 calendar days of the date of this conference, absent any extenuating circumstances.

00:19:07 Speaker 1

In reaching a decision, I will complete a thorough investigation of the allegations in your complaint, including a review of all the information and evidence you presented today, and any other information I believe will help resolve the complaint.

00:19:20 Speaker 1

You have received a fair opportunity to present your complaint today.

00:19:23 Speaker 1

Thank you for your time.

00:19:25 Speaker 1

This Level 1 conference is concluded.

00:19:27 Speaker 1

The time is 1141 and I will stop recording.

00:19:31 Speaker 2

Okay, thank you.

FRISCO
INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT

5515 Ohio Drive
Frisco, Texas 75035
469.633.6000
469.633.6050 (fax)
www.friscoisd.org

March 24, 2026

Steven Jordan
*Email:* srjordan@gmail.com

Dear Mr. Jordan,

This letter is written in response to your Level I complaint filed on February 26, 2026 pursuant to Frisco Independent School District ("Frisco ISD" or "the District") Administrative Complaint Process. The Level I complaint conference occurred on March 6, 2026. At the conference, you had the opportunity to present your complaints and all the evidence you believe was relevant to your complaints. This response is timely provided in accordance with the Frisco ISD Administrative Complaint Process.

In your complaint and during the Level I conference, you alleged the following with regard to your complaint:

- Your son is not being given adequate training time.
- There is a lack of transparency in communication from the Iron Horse coaches regarding group assignments.

Additionally, you requested the following remedies with regard to your complaint:

- You would like your son to be moved to a higher training group (Gold Group) and/or be given more training time in his current group.
- You would like there to be more transparent communication regarding the standards required for each level of training with Iron Horse Aquatics.

Following the Level I conference, I conducted a thorough investigation, including, but not limited to, a review of all the relevant documentation you provided, reviewing team handbook and procedures, and interviewing involved coaches.

Based upon my review of the evidence, my findings with regard to your complaint are as follows:

- Your allegation that your son is not being given adequate training time is **unsubstantiated**.
    - Evidence supports that your son was offered the same opportunities as other athletes with his similar ability level.
    - Evidence further supports that athletes' parents receive invitations from the coaches to participate in events and have the opportunity to accept or decline those events. A review of the invitations shows that you declined four out of nine events from September 1, 2025 - March 1, 2026 for your son.
    - The amount of training time you son has received is consistent with our team expectations, coaching evaluations and swim meet performance.
- Your allegation that there is a lack of transparency in communication from the Iron Horse coaches regarding group assignments is **unsubstantiated**.
    - A review of evidence supports that the coaches host a parent meeting two times per year to review program information, specifically group expectations and advancement opportunities.
    - Email communication supports that the coaches offered you a time to meet on February 25, 2026, to discuss your concerns and answer any questions you had; however, you declined this invitation.

With regard to the remedies that you requested, the remedies have been **granted** as follows:

- Your request that your son be given additional training time or be moved to a higher group is **granted**.
    - Your son achieved the needed standards at the season culminating meet and was moved to the Gold Group based on his own merit, not due to the grievance that was filed.
- Your request that there be more transparent communication regarding the standards required for each level of training with Iron Horse Aquatics is **granted.**
    - Any questions you have regarding the training groups and/or your son's progress can and will be discussed at meetings and one-on-one with your son's assigned coach.
    - The standards for each group are posted on the website under the tab for the "Iron Horse Swim Team" dropdown box titled "Group Requirements/Info" linked HERE. However, in an effort to increase transparency and accessibility for parents, the Iron Horse Team Handbook

has been updated to include the same information in the presentation titled “IH Group Information slideshow for website”.

If you wish to appeal, you must do so within 20 calendar days, in accordance with applicable Frisco ISD Board Policies which are posted online at http://pol.tasb.org/Home/Index/309. Frisco ISD complaint procedures may be found on the Frisco ISD website. Please be advised that all timelines are strictly enforced.

It is my hope that this response resolves your complaints. If you have questions regarding the timeline applicable to an appeal, please contact the Office of the Deputy Superintendent of Schools at complaintresolution@friscoisd.org.

Sincerely,

Melissa Howard
FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator

**From:** Complaint Resolution
**Sent:** Mon, 30 Mar 2026 15:12:38 +0000
**To:** Stephen Jordan; Complaint Resolution
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA
**Subject:** RE: Level II Appeal – Formal Grievance Regarding Advancement Criteria (Iron Horse Aquatics)

Mr. Jordan,
The addition of remedies regarding your original complaint do not constitute an appeal under FNG; however, it does require remanding back to Level 1 to address the newly requested remedies. Ms. Howard will be in contact soon.
Regards,



*Complaint Resolution*

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Friday, March 27, 2026 8:06 PM
**To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Level II Appeal – Formal Grievance Regarding Advancement Criteria (Iron Horse Aquatics)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Frisco ISD Administration,

Pursuant to Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG(Local), I am formally submitting this Level II appeal following the Level I response dated March 24, 2026 and subsequent communications regarding the Iron Horse Aquatics program.

I am also including this appeal in light of the most recent response directing me to either work exclusively through the coach or seek placement with another club, which does not address the substantive concerns raised.

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## 1. BASIS FOR APPEAL

This appeal is not related to my son's current placement, which has been resolved.

This appeal addresses a broader and unresolved issue:

**The absence of clearly defined, objective, and consistently applied advancement criteria within the program.**

Specifically:

• Advancement language such as “invitation only” remains undefined
• No measurable performance benchmarks are published for progression
• Requests for clarification have not been answered with specific criteria
• Responses have redirected away from the question rather than addressing it

---

## 2. CONCERN REGARDING RESPONSE

The recent guidance to “contact the coach” or consider other clubs does not resolve the issue presented.

The concern is not about individual coaching communication, but about:

• program structure
• transparency of standards
• consistency of advancement criteria

These are administrative matters, not individual coaching preferences.

---

## 3. PERFORMANCE CONTEXT

As previously documented:

• [redacted] has achieved **A standards in breaststroke events**
• He is within **3–4 seconds of TAGS qualification** in 100 and 200 breaststroke
• He demonstrates **BB-level performance in multiple additional events**
• His development trajectory indicates near-term progression to championship-level performance

This establishes that he meets recognized competitive benchmarks in primary events.

---

## 4. STRUCTURAL ISSUE

The current framework lacks:

• Defined advancement thresholds
• Measurable criteria tied to performance standards
• Clear weighting of stroke performance
• Verifiable consistency across athletes

Without these elements, advancement decisions cannot be objectively understood or evaluated.

---

## 5. DISTRICT STANDARD COMPARISON

Frisco ISD applies a standards-based model in academics, including:

• Defined benchmarks
• Measurable criteria
• Transparent evaluation

In contrast, the current athletic advancement model relies on:

• Undefined discretionary language
• Lack of measurable benchmarks
• Limited transparency

This inconsistency raises concerns regarding alignment with district principles of clarity and fairness.

---

## 6. REQUEST FOR RESOLUTION

To address these concerns, I respectfully request:

• Definition or removal of “invitation only” language
• Establishment of objective advancement benchmarks (A, BB, TAGS proximity)
• Clarification of how performance across strokes is evaluated
• Written confirmation that criteria are applied consistently across all athletes

---

## 7. PURPOSE

This appeal is not intended to challenge coaching discretion, but to ensure that such discretion operates within a **clear, measurable, and consistently applied framework**.

Establishing objective criteria supports transparency, reduces ambiguity, and ensures equitable evaluation for all student-athletes.

---

Please confirm receipt of this Level II appeal and advise on the next steps in the review process.

Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

------ Original Message ------
From "HOWARD, MELISSA" <howardme@friscoisd.org>
To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
Cc "Complaint Resolution" <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
Date 3/27/2026 7:06:00 PM
Subject Re: Re[2]: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan,

Please reach out to your son's coach moving forward. If you continue to be dissatisfied, we can provide you with contact information for other clubs in the area that may be better suited to your needs.

Thank you.

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Friday, March 27, 2026 11:52 AM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re[2]: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Howard,
Thank you for your recent response and for confirming [redacted] placement in the Gold group.
While I appreciate the outcome, I would like to address an outstanding concern regarding the advancement structure within the Iron Horse Aquatics program, specifically as it relates to transparency and consistency.
The current use of "invitation only" language for advancement to higher groups, including Platinum, introduces a level of subjectivity that makes it difficult for families to clearly understand what is required for progression. Without defined, measurable criteria, advancement decisions can appear inconsistent and are not easily aligned with recognized competitive swimming standards.
Additionally, I want to express a concern regarding how stroke specialization is evaluated within the advancement process. [redacted] has demonstrated strong performance in breaststroke and continues to improve in other areas. My concern is that athletes who excel in a specific stroke may be disadvantaged if advancement decisions place disproportionate weight on freestyle performance without clearly defined criteria.
To ensure clarity and consistency going forward, I am requesting written clarification on the following:
• Whether advancement to Platinum can be tied to objective benchmarks such as USA Swimming Motivational Time Standards, including A and BB times
• Whether event-specific performance thresholds are used to evaluate readiness for promotion
• What role attendance, training consistency, and meet participation play in advancement decisions
• How different strokes are evaluated within advancement decisions, including how freestyle performance is weighted relative to other strokes
• How these criteria are applied consistently across all athletes within the program
My goal is to ensure that [redacted] development, and that of all athletes in the program, is supported by a transparent and objective framework that allows families to clearly understand expectations and progression pathways.
Establishing clearly defined criteria will benefit both athletes and coaches by reducing ambiguity and ensuring that advancement decisions are aligned with measurable performance and development standards.
I appreciate your time and consideration and look forward to your response.
Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

------ Original Message ------
From "HOWARD, MELISSA" <howardme@friscoisd.org>
To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
Cc "Stephen Jordan" <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; "Complaint Resolution" <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
Date 3/27/2026 10:53:03 AM
Subject Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Good morning, Mr. Jordan,

Thank you for your response.

Regarding your final questions, much of the relevant information is outlined in the letter sent with your son's move-up notification from the coaches, as well as in the link included in my previous response. I encourage you to review those materials for further clarification. This information is also available on our website and in the team handbook.

You are always welcome to contact your son's coach directly with any specific questions related to his training and development.

In addition, his coach will be sending regular newsletters that include details about required meet schedules and practice requirements. Please be sure to review those communications carefully.

As you know, swimming is an individual sport, and each athlete develops at their own pace. We make every effort to consider each swimmer's unique needs and growth, and to support them as consistently as possible across the team.

Lastly, please note that all out-of-state travel meets are optional, never required.

Thank you and have a nice weekend.

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Wednesday, March 25, 2026 1:17 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; Complaint Resolution

<ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>

**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Howard,
Thank you for your written response and for confirming that [redacted] has been moved to the Gold group.
I appreciate the time taken to review the matter and the outcome regarding his placement.
To ensure that [redacted] remains aligned with program expectations and continues progressing appropriately, I would like to request written clarification on the following:
• The specific performance benchmarks required to remain in the Gold group
• The measurable criteria for advancement beyond Gold
• Any minimum expectations related to training attendance, event participation, and stroke development
• How freestyle development is weighted relative to specialty strokes such as breaststroke and butterfly within Gold training evaluations
Additionally, I would like to confirm that, going forward, [redacted] will participate in swim meets within the state of Texas. At this time, out-of-state travel for meets is not feasible for our family. Please let me know if this impacts any expectations associated with his placement in the Gold group.
Having clearly defined, objective benchmarks will allow us to support [redacted] in a structured and consistent way, and will ensure alignment between athlete development and program expectations.
I would also appreciate confirmation that these criteria are applied consistently across all athletes within the program.
Thank you again for your time and consideration. I look forward to continuing to support [redacted] development within the program.
Sincerely,
Stephen Ray Jordan

On Wed, Mar 25, 2026 at 12:29 PM HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Good afternoon, Mr. Jordan,

Please see the attached letter in response to your Level 1 Grievance.

Thank you,

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, March 5, 2026 3:28 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

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I forgot what is the address of the administration building.

Get Outlook for Android

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 12:18:03 PM
**To:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Friday will be fine.

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---

**From:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 11:23:43 AM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan,

Which of the proposed meeting dates and times would be your preference?

Thank you,

**Melissa Howard**
*FISD Swim/Dive Coordinator*
469.633.6162
howardme@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Natatorium
Frisco ISD HS Swimming
Iron Horse Aquatics

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 10:15 AM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** RE: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Kolni and Ms. Howard,
I am in receipt of the General Counsel's correspondence. While I will comply with the District's "stepped process" to ensure I do not forfeit my right to appeal, let the record reflect that I am participating in this Level 1 hearing with Ms. Howard **strictly under protest.**
The District's assertion that a "fresh set of eyes" must be preserved for later levels does not negate the fundamental requirement for an impartial hearing officer at Level 1. Ms. Howard is a direct subject of my grievance; her prior communications have been contemptuous in tone and have actively invited the escalation of this conflict rather than seeking a technical resolution based on swimming merit.
To have the individual whose judgment and conduct are being questioned serve as the adjudicator of that very conduct is a procedural absurdity. It creates an environment where the Level 1 hearing is not a meaningful attempt at resolution, but a bureaucratic hurdle and a significant waste of time for all parties involved.
Furthermore, I remain deeply concerned regarding the conflict of interest involving a District Vice President whose child is a direct peer of my son. The District's refusal to provide an independent officer at this stage only reinforces my belief that this process lacks the transparency and objectivity required by **Board Policy FNG(LOCAL).**
**I will attend the meeting on [Select Date: Thursday, March 5th at 12:30 PM OR Friday, March 6th at 11:30 AM] at the FISD Administrative Building.** I will be bringing the supplemental performance data and evidence previously mentioned. I expect a formal, written response to each point of my grievance

following the meeting, as I fully anticipate the need to escalate this matter to Level 2 to find the "impartiality" the District claims to value.
Sincerely,
**Confidentiality Notice:** This email and any attachments are intended only for the recipient(s) named above. They may contain confidential or privileged information. If you are not the intended recipient, please delete this email immediately and notify the sender. Any unauthorized review, use, disclosure, or distribution is prohibited.

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**From:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Tuesday, March 3, 2026 8:47 AM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

Mr. Jordan - Please provide all supplemental information related to your grievance directly to the assigned hearing officer only. If you would like to include a second recipient, you may copy our complaints resolution email address at ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org. The Formal Grievance process is a stepped process that begins at Level I with your assigned hearing officer, Ms. Howard. If you appeal her findings, the District will need to assign your complaint to a person who can look at the issues with fresh eyes, without having previously been exposed to your concerns. I've asked those not directly involved at this level not to read of respond to your grievance material to maintain the efficacy of the grievance process.

Best,

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Monday, March 2, 2026 4:26 PM
**To:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA < howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders

<Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette < DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; MANDUVA, SURESH < manduvas@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Evidence Submission and Notice of Intent – Level 1 Grievance

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear All,
This correspondence serves as a formal evidentiary supplement to the Level 1 Grievance concerning the practice group placement of [redacted] Ray Jordan.
This submission contains:

1. Objective performance data from the February 27 to March 1, 2026 COR Swim Meet
2. A technical analysis of the current placement methodology
3. A comparative review of North Texas competitive swimming standards
4. Notice of intent regarding further action should corrective measures not be taken

---

## I. Objective Performance Data

**Junior and Senior COR Swim Meet – Garland, Texas**

[redacted] demonstrated measurable and significant improvement across multiple events and achieved USA Swimming A Motivational Standards in three events.

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 200 Yard IM | 2:37.61 | 2:33.81 | 3.80 | 2.41 percent | — |
| 100 Yard Fly | 1:12.02 | 1:09.39 | 2.63 | 1.67 percent | — |
| 50 Yard Breast | 36.16 | 35.04 | 1.12 | 0.71 percent | A Time |
| 200 Yard Breast | 2:51.55 | 2:45.63 | 5.92 | 3.76 percent | A Time |
| 50 Yard Fly | 31.66 | 31.56 | 0.10 | 0.06 percent | — |
| 100 Yard IM | 1:12.53 | 1:12.20 | 0.33 | 0.21 percent | — |

| Event | Entry Time | Best Time | Improvement | Percent Improvement | National Standard |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 100 Yard Breast | 1:19.20 | 1:17.11 | 2.09 | 1.33 percent | A Time |

These results are objective, verifiable, and attached as an official meet record.

---

## II. Training Volume Disparity

Silver Group weekly training volume: 7 hours 45 minutes
Gold Group weekly training volume: 9 hours 15 minutes
This represents a 22.8 percent increase in structured training exposure.
For an athlete performing at A standard in multiple events, denial of appropriate training volume constitutes a material developmental restriction. Continued placement below performance level directly impacts competitive progression and future opportunity.

---

## III. Technical Deficiency in Placement Criteria

The continued reliance on freestyle benchmarks as the primary gatekeeping metric is inconsistent with broader competitive swimming standards.
• USA Swimming Motivational Standards recognize performance across all strokes.
• ASCA development principles require stroke specific neuromuscular reinforcement for specialists.
• Long Term Athlete Development modeling identifies early non freestyle stroke proficiency as a leading indicator of long-term competitive viability.
• Regional North Texas programs promote based on verified meet data and tier standards rather than isolated stroke bias.
[redacted] currently meets or exceeds A tier standards in breaststroke events.
Placement decisions that disregard these standards lack objective consistency.

---

## IV. Notice of Intent

If this matter is not resolved at Level 1 through immediate promotion to the Gold practice group, I will proceed through all formal grievance levels available under Frisco ISD Board Policy FNG Local.
Further, I am prepared to pursue external legal review regarding:
• Inconsistent application of advancement standards
• Arbitrary and capricious placement methodology
• Developmental harm resulting from denial of appropriate training volume
• Potential exposure arising from unequal application of published or customary criteria

This letter should be understood as formal notice that I am prepared to protect my child's athletic development through all available administrative and legal channels.

---

## Requested Resolution

Immediate promotion of [redacted] Ray Jordan to the Gold practice group and implementation of the 9 hour 15 minute weekly training schedule without further delay.
This request is supported by objective data, industry standards, and developmental best practice.
I expect written confirmation of corrective action.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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**From:** McClendon, Cory <McClendC@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:36 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>; BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA < howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette < DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** RE: FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

Good Afternoon Mr. Jordan,

I just wanted to let you know that your email has been received, and I will touch base with athletics and someone will be in contact with you to discuss your concerns.

Sincerely,

FRISCO ISD
**Cory McClendon**
*Chief Leadership/Student Services Officer*
469.633.6021

mcclendc@friscoisd.org

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, February 26, 2026 2:18 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; Janak, [redacted] <JanakJ@friscoisd.org>; HOWARD, MELISSA <howardme@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER < burtchc@friscoisd.org>; RUCKER, DEIDRA <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette < DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Mark Hill <HillMark@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org; MANDUVA, SURESH <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org
**Subject:** FOLLOW-UP: Formal Grievance Regarding Inconsistent Communication and Program Integrity

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

**Dear FISD Board Members, Coach Franks and FISD Athletic Management,**
I am following up on my previous email as I have yet to receive a response. Please be advised that I am committed to seeing this matter through to a resolution that ensures transparency and equity for all swimmers in the program. My concerns regarding the **misrepresentation of program status** are based on the following written communications I received on February 2, 2026:

- **From Justin Bilgri:** "*Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March.*"
- **From Daiki Sato:** "*To be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin.*".

**I am requesting the following actions be taken by the FISD Athletic Department:**

1. **Administrative Review:** I request that [redacted] **Janak**, as the direct supervisor, provide a written explanation for why parents were provided with inaccurate information regarding athlete promotions.
2. **Accountability:** I am asking for a formal review of the conduct of Coaches Sato and Bilgri regarding their communication standards with parents.

3. **Leadership Oversight:** I request that the district evaluate the management practices under the current Head Coach to ensure an environment of honesty and equity.
4. **Placement Resolution:** To rectify the current disparity, I request that [redacted] be placed in the **Gold group**, or that the status of other athletes be returned to **Silver** to align with the timeline previously communicated to me.

I look forward to a prompt response from the management team regarding the steps being taken to address these discrepancies.

Sincerely,
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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---

**From:** Stephen Jordan
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:24 PM
**To:** 'BILGRI, JUSTIN' <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>; ', [redacted] Janak' <janakj@friscoisd.org>; 'Melissa Howard' <howardme@friscoisd.org>; 'Chris Burtch' < burtchc@friscoisd.org>; 'Deidra Rucker' <ruckerd@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>; ',' <leaders@friscoisd.org>; ' davisdy@friscoisd.org' <davisdy@friscoisd.org>; 'elads@friscoisd.org' <elads@friscoisd.org>; ' hillmark@friscoisd.org' <hillmark@friscoisd.org>; 'ddoxk@friscoisd.org' <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; ' manduvas@friscoisd.org' <manduvas@friscoisd.org>; 'lass@friscoisd.org' <lass@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Formal Grievance Regarding Iron Horse Aquatics Placement – Stephen Jordan

**Dear Coach Franks, FISD Board of Directors, and FISD Athletic Management,**

I am writing to file a formal complaint regarding the recent placement and promotion decisions within the Iron Horse Aquatics program.

Both you and Coach Daiki explicitly informed me that [redacted] was not being promoted. I have since discovered this was untrue. This lack of transparency is unacceptable, but more concerning is the apparent **conflict of interest** regarding this decision.

Because DR. [redacted] mother is an Assistant Principal within Frisco ISD, it appears that she is receiving **preferential treatment** for her child that is not

being afforded to other families. Using a district position to influence athletic promotions undermines the "power of one" and the equity Frisco ISD claims to uphold.
Due to this ethical concern and the misinformation provided to me, I am requesting the following immediate action:

1. **Placement Equity:** Promote [redacted] into the **Gold group** immediately, OR
2. **Reversion:** Move [redacted] back into the **Silver group** to reflect the standards previously communicated to me.

I am copying the Frisco ISD Athletic Department leadership to ensure this matter, and the potential misuse of district influence—is properly documented. I expect a formal response addressing these inconsistencies and a resolution to the placement issue.
**Stephen Ray Jordan**

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---

**From:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Wednesday, February 25, 2026 12:05 PM
**To:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>; SATO, DAIKI <satod@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

Hi Stephen,

Thank you for reaching out. You raised some very valid points, and I took the time to do a deeper comparison of [redacted] and [redacted] performances, as well as where [redacted] stands within the Gold group benchmarks.

[redacted] is progressing well, which is great to see. However, at this stage, [redacted] is the more well-rounded swimmer overall. The two events where [redacted] is clearly ahead are the 100 BR and 100 FL. In the 50 BR and 50 FL, he is only marginally faster.

To provide additional context, the current group averages for the boys in Gold are:

- 50 Free: 24–28 seconds
- 100 Free: 53–1:04

- 200 Free: 2:00–2:15

At this time, [redacted] is below these benchmark ranges in his freestyle events. His breaststroke is stronger and aligns more closely with the rest of the group. However, breaststroke is not the primary focus of daily training in Gold. Approximately 80% of weekly practices emphasize freestyle, as it forms the foundation of conditioning and overall development. Due to the physical strain that breaststroke and butterfly place on the body, training cannot be centered exclusively on those strokes.

For [redacted] to align more closely with the group standard and continue progressing long term, improving his freestyle will be key. I'm confident that with consistent focus and effort, he will continue to make strong gains across all events.

If you would like anymore clarification. We can schedule a meeting with Coach Daiki and I next week.

Best regards,
Justin Bilgri

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srj@srjconsultingservices.com>
**Sent:** Tuesday, February 24, 2026 9:43 PM
**To:** BILGRI, JUSTIN <bilgrij@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Question Regarding Group Placement for [redacted] Jordan

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Coach Bilgri,
I hope you are doing well. I wanted to reach out regarding [redacted] current placement in the Silver group.
[redacted] has been working hard and continues to improve his competitive performance. Based on recent meets and practice performance, we believe he is performing at a level comparable to [redacted] I understand that [redacted] remains officially in Silver but is being allowed to practice with the Gold group.

I am concerned about the consistency of this arrangement. If swimmers of similar competitive level are being treated differently, it can feel inequitable to the athletes who are putting in the same effort.

With that in mind, I would respectfully request one of the following:

• If [redacted] is going to continue practicing with Gold, I would ask that [redacted] be given the same opportunity.

• Alternatively, if group placement standards require swimmers to remain in their designated practice group, then those standards should apply consistently.

• Ideally, I would appreciate a formal evaluation of [redacted] for promotion to the Gold group if he meets the criteria.

Could you please clarify the specific performance benchmarks required for Gold placement and whether [redacted] is close to meeting them?

Thank you for your time and for everything you do for the team. I look forward to your guidance on the best path forward for [redacted] development.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

**Confidentiality Notice:** This email and any attachments are intended only for the recipient(s) named above. They may contain confidential or privileged information. If you are not the intended recipient, please delete this email immediately and notify the sender. Any unauthorized review, use, disclosure, or distribution is prohibited.

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

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# Grievance Presentation: The Case for Gold Group Placement

**Athlete:** [redacted] Jordan (11-Year-Old Athlete)

**Hearing Date:** March 6, 2026

**Subject:** Formal Challenge to Promotion Denial & Request for Objective Alignment with Texas Competitive Standards

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## I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: THE "LOST" YEAR

The current denial of promotion is the continuation of a documented historical oversight. To understand why [redacted] belongs in Gold today, the committee must acknowledge his established trajectory:

- **Historical Elite Status:** As a 10-year-old, [redacted] achieved **USA Swimming "AA" and "AAA" Time Standards**.
- **The National Benchmarks:** A "AAA" time signifies that a swimmer is in the **top 2% of the United States** for their age group.
- **The Failure to Promote:** In any premier North Texas program, a "AAA" 10-year-old is automatically placed in the highest performance tier. [redacted] was held back despite this data, and he is now being penalized again at age 11 for "A" level times that are faster than many current Gold swimmers.

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## II. CURRENT PERFORMANCE DATA: THE BREASTSTROKE SPECIALIST

The following times from the March 2026 meet represent national-level competency. [redacted] is currently "out-swimming" the Silver group's training intervals.

- **100-Yard Breaststroke: 1:16.82** (Current PB)
  - **Status: USA Swimming "A" Time.**
  - **The "Gold" Reality:** This time is faster than the "send-off" intervals used in Gold. In Silver, [redacted] has no one to push him, leading to physiological stagnation.
- **200-Yard Breaststroke: 2:45.63**
  - **Status: USA Swimming "A" Time.**
  - **The Endurance Factor:** The 200 is an aerobic power event. This time proves [redacted] has the "engine" to handle the **9.25-hour** weekly training volume of the Gold group.

- **50-Yard Breaststroke: 35.04**
  - **Status: High "A" Time** (Approaching State "AA").

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## III. NORTH TEXAS MARKET COMPARISON

If [redacted] were at any of the private clubs that feed the 5A/6A State Championship teams (the same teams FISD is measured by), he would be in their highest performance track.

| Private Club | "Gold/Performance" Requirement | [redacted] Jordan's Data | Comparison Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Texas Ford (TFA)** | **2+ "A" Times** or **1 "AA"** | **3 "A" Times** | **Exceeds** |
| **Lakeside (LAC)** | **Within 3-5% of TAGS (State)** | **Current Breaststroke Times** | **Aligned** |
| **Nadadores (NTN)** | **A-Standard** in 1 Stroke + 1 Distance | **100 & 200 Breast "A"s** | **Exceeds** |

Export to Sheets

**The Market Reality:** [redacted] is currently training **22.8% fewer hours** (7.75 vs 9.25) than his competitive peers. This is a material restriction of his development.

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## IV. SCIENTIFIC DEFENSE: THE MYTH OF THE "FREESTYLE GATEKEEPER"

The district has previously argued that [redacted] freestyle marks are a barrier to Gold. This is a scientifically and competitively flawed position for the following reasons:

**1. The "Aerobic Engine" Principle** A swimmer's heart and lungs do not distinguish between strokes. An athlete who can swim a **2:45.63 200-Breast** possesses an aerobic capacity that far exceeds the developmental goals of the Silver group. To deny him Gold yardage because of a freestyle "check-box" is to starve his aerobic engine of the volume it requires to grow.

**2. The Stroke Specialist in Texas 5A/6A Swimming** At the high school level (Reedy/Wakeland), teams win state titles because of **specialists**.

- A "great swimmer" is defined by their ability to score points in their best events.
- Olympic and NCAA legends (e.g., breaststroke specialists like Lilly King or Adam Peaty) often have freestyle times that are "average" compared to their primary stroke.
- By forcing [redacted] to remain in Silver for freestyle reasons, IHA is essentially trying to make him a "jack of all trades" while actively destroying his "mastery" of the breaststroke.

# EXHIBIT A: THE PHYSIOLOGY OF THE STROKE SPECIALIST

### Why Elite Performance is Not Dependent on Multi-Stroke Proficiency

## 1. The "Aerobic Engine" vs. Technical Mechanics

The most common misconception in developmental swimming is that an athlete must be proficient in all four strokes to handle an "Elite" or "Gold" training volume. From a physiological standpoint, this is incorrect.

- **Cardiovascular Uniformity:** The heart and lungs do not distinguish between strokes. An athlete who achieves a **USA Swimming "A" time in the 200-Yard Breaststroke (2:45.63)** has documented that their aerobic engine can sustain high-intensity output over a long duration.
- **The Volume Requirement:** To maintain a "AAA" or "A" trajectory, the body requires **overload stimulus**. If a swimmer is held in a "Silver" group because of freestyle technicalities, their heart and lungs are being "under-trained." You cannot build a 5A State Champion engine on a 7-hour weekly schedule if the athlete's physiology is ready for 9.25 hours.

## 2. The Specialist Advantage in Texas 5A/6A Swimming

In the Frisco ISD high school system (Reedy/Wakeland), team success is built on "Point Scorers."

- **The Scoring Math:** A swimmer who wins the 100 Breaststroke but finishes 20th in the 100 Freestyle earns **more points** for their team than a swimmer who is "proficient" (10th place) in both.
- **Market Precedent:** Look at the **2025 5A State Results**. The podiums are dominated by specialists. Many of the fastest breaststrokers in the state do not even qualify for the state meet in Freestyle. By forcing a specialist to wait for "Freestyle Proficiency," a club is effectively diluting the athlete's primary weapon.

## 3. The Biomechanical Divergence of Breaststroke

Breaststroke is the most "unique" of the four competitive strokes. It is the only stroke that is "drag-dominated" rather than "propulsion-dominated," and it relies on an entirely different muscle recruitment pattern (lateral hip rotation vs. linear kick).

- **Anatomical Variation:** Some of the world's greatest breaststrokers possess a specific hip and ankle flexibility that actually makes them **less efficient** in Freestyle and Backstroke.

- **The Specialist Path:** Forcing a breaststroke specialist to meet the same freestyle "check-box" as a distance freestyler is like asking a world-class sprinter to prove they can run a marathon before letting them on the track. It ignores the natural biomechanical gifts of the athlete.

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## 4. Historical and Competitive Precedents

The history of swimming is defined by specialists who were "average" in their secondary strokes but became legends in their primary:

- **Lilly King (Olympic Gold Medalist):** Widely considered the greatest 100m breaststroker in history. Her freestyle times, while competent, are nowhere near the elite national level. Had her coaches held her back in "Silver" groups until her freestyle was "Elite," the world would have lost a breaststroke legend.
- **Adam Peaty:** The first man under 57 seconds in the 100m Breaststroke. His training is almost entirely breaststroke-centric because that is where his physiological ceiling resides.

## 5. The "Training Down" Risk

When a specialist is kept in a developmental group (Silver) to work on secondary strokes (Freestyle/Backstroke):

1. **Interval Failure:** The athlete is forced to swim sets at a pace (e.g., 1:35 base) that is 20 seconds slower than their 100m Breaststroke pace (1:16.82).
2. **Stroke Decay:** To stay with the slower group, the athlete must "slow down" their natural tempo. This ruins the "muscle memory" of their elite stroke.
3. **Psychological Burnout:** High-performing athletes (those with **AAA/AA histories**) thrive on competition. Being the "fastest person in the slow group" leads to a lack of motivation and a decline in race-day aggression.

## Conclusion: The Case for [redacted] Jordan

[redacted] **1:16.82 (100 Breast)** and **2:45.63 (200 Breast)** are objective, indisputable evidence of Gold-level capacity. To deny him access to Gold-level yardage based on Freestyle or Backstroke "proficiency" is to ignore the science of aerobic development and the reality of competitive Texas swimming.

**A "Great Swimmer" is not one who is average at everything, but one who is elite at their specialty. [redacted] Jordan is an Elite Breaststroker; the Gold Group is where Elite athletes train.**

**3. Technical vs. Physiological Growth** "Stroke work" (Freestyle) can be corrected in a Gold environment. However, "Physiological Growth" (Endurance) **cannot** be achieved in a Silver environment that lacks the necessary yardage and intensity.

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## V. REMEDY SOUGHT

We are seeking the immediate correction of a multi-year placement error.

1. **Immediate Gold Promotion:** To align his training volume with the **AA/AAA trajectory** he established at age 10 and maintains today at age 11.
2. **Recognition of Objective Standards:** Move away from subjective "coaching discretion" and toward the **USA Swimming Motivational Standards (A/AA/AAA)** as the primary criteria for promotion.
3. **Accountability Report:** If promotion is denied, I request a written, evidence-based report explaining how a swimmer with **three "A" times** and a **AAA history** is "not ready" for 9.25 hours of training, while every other elite club in North Texas would have him on a performance track.

**Move Ups:**

Each group has a general age range and skill level projected. These are guidelines and ultimately it comes down to the staff involved with the swimmers and the current ebb and flow in the surrounding group structures.

We will do move ups once a year, after the athlete has completed one short course and long course season with their current group coach. Our goal is to make sure all swimmers are in the right group for their current development. Having said that, we would like to mention that if an athlete exceeds the current group (ability, attendance, demonstrates leadership, and skill level) they are swimming with, we may move them up prior to the soonest move up date. This will be looked at on a case by case basis but ultimately move ups will be at the discretion of the Head Age-Group and Head Coach.

I have verified the data for these four clubs and extracted the direct links to their official policy documents. These links will be critical for your meeting as they provide the "Proof of Concept" that elite clubs operate on a model of transparency and objective data.

## 1. Waterloo Swimming (Austin, TX)

- **Verification:** Waterloo uses a strict "Time Standard" and "Cut Density" model.
- **The Rule:** They define readiness using a **"Multiple"** (3 cuts in 2+ strokes) or **"Full Program"** (5 cuts in 3+ strokes) system.
- **Link:** Waterloo Swim Team Group Move-Up Guidelines
- **Link:** Waterloo Competitive Program Levels & Requirements

## 2. Madison Aquatic Center (MAC) (Madison, WI)

- **Verification:** MAC is one of the most granular clubs in the country. They publish the exact **send-off intervals** (pace clock times) for every group.
- **Specific Metric:** To move to Senior Gold, an athlete must hit **8 x 200 Free @ 2:20** and **6 x 200 IM @ 2:30**.
- **Link:** MAC Group Levels & Training Progression Chart

## 3. Kingfish Swimming (Kingston, RI)

- **Verification:** They use a "Requirements to Graduate" checklist that separates skills into "At Practice" (clock-based) and "At Meets" (time-based).
- **Age Group 2 (Elite) Metric:** Requires sets like **4 x 100 Free @ 2:00** and a **200 IM with legal starts/turns**.
- **Link:** Kingfish RI Swim Team Training Levels & Graduation Checklist

## 4. Lakeside Aquatic Club (LAC) (North Texas)

- **Verification:** LAC is a local "Top-10" National club. Their document explicitly states the "Top 30" rule for their highest age-group tier.
- **Specific Metric:** *"Swimmers in this group [AGS] are comprised of the **top 25-30 Age Group swimmers at each site**, who are committed to achieving state and national level time standards."*
- **Link:** Lakeside Aquatic Club (LAC) Program Structure & Group Tiers

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## How to leverage these links tomorrow:

1. **Print the MAC Progression Chart:** Point to the intervals (e.g., 8x100 @ 1:35). Ask the FISD committee: *"What is the equivalent 'send-off' for the Gold group at Iron Horse? If you cannot provide a number, you are not following the industry standard for elite development."*

2. **Use the Waterloo "Multiple" Rule:** Point out that [redacted] has **three "A" cuts** in Breaststroke (50, 100, 200). According to Waterloo's published standards, he has already met the "Multiple" criteria for an elite-track promotion.
3. **The "Top 30" argument (LAC):** Since LAC is a local peer of IHA, their "Top 30" rule is your strongest local argument. [redacted] **1:16.82 100-Breast** and **2:45.63 200-Breast** place him in the top tier of 11-year-olds in North Texas. By LAC standards, he belongs in their top-tier group (AGS/Gold).

## Defense of the "Stroke Specialist"

If they bring up his Freestyle or Backstroke again, refer to **Section 4 of the LAC Program Structure**, which notes that Gold swimmers must have "set times in all four strokes," but **does not** mandate that those times be at a specific level before the athlete can access the higher-volume training.

**At SRJ Consulting & Services, we advocate for data-driven decisions. The data from these four clubs proves that [redacted] Jordan is being held to a standard that is inconsistent with the best practices of American swimming.**

Below are the benchmarks for these clubs and how [redacted] specific times from the March 2026 meet compare.

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**1. Texas Ford Aquatics (TFA) – Frisco/Allen**

- **The Club:** One of the most successful programs in the region, training out of the same area as IHA.
- **Gold/Elite Requirements (11-12 Years):**
  - **Speed:** Possession of at least **two "A" times** or one **"AA" time.**
  - **Intervals:** Ability to hold 100-yard repeats on a **1:20–1:25 base.**
- [redacted] **Comparison:** * [redacted] has **three "A" times** (50, 100, and 200 Breaststroke).
  - His 100 Breaststroke (1:16.82) is significantly faster than the 1:20 interval required to lead a lane in a TFA Gold-level group.

**2. Lakeside Aquatic Club (LAC) – Flower Mound/Keller**

- **The Club:** A perennial Top-10 program in the USA Swimming Virtual Club Championships.
- **Gold/National Group Requirements (11-12 Years):**
  - **Speed:** LAC uses the **"TAGS" (Texas Age Group Swimming)** standards as their primary gatekeeper. To be in their "Gold" tier, an 11-year-old generally needs to be within **3-5% of a TAGS cut.**
  - **Endurance:** Must be able to complete a **400 IM** and a **500 Freestyle** legally.
- [redacted] **Comparison:** * [redacted] **200 Breaststroke (2:45.63)** is an elite endurance time. At 11 years old, this time is highly competitive and would place him squarely in LAC's performance track.

**3. North Texas Nadadores (NTN) – Southlake**

- **The Club:** Famous for a high-intensity, "performance-first" culture.
- **Performance Group Requirements:**
  - **Objective Benchmark:** Must achieve **USA Swimming "A" standards** in at least one distance event (200 Free or 200 IM) and one stroke event (100 or 200).

- [redacted] **Comparison:** *[redacted] meets this requirement twice over with his **100 Breast (1:16.82)** and **200 Breast (2:45.63)**.

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**Summary Table: [redacted] vs. North Texas "Gold" Standards**

| Criteria | North Texas Private Club Standard | [redacted] **Jordan's Data** | Result |
|---|---|---|---|
| **National Rank** | 2+ USA Swimming "A" Times | **3 "A" Times** | **Exceeds** |
| **Sustained Speed** | 100 Breast under 1:22 | **1:16.82** | **Exceeds** |
| **Endurance** | 200 Breast under 2:55 | **2:45.63** | **Exceeds** |
| **State Level** | Approaching TAGS/AA | **35.04 (50 Breast)** | **Aligned** |

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 34.18 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 GU AAU Junior Olympic Games - Houston | 07/27/2025 | 50 FR LCM Male | AA | Final 15th |
| 36.68 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 GU AAU Junior Olympic Games - Houston | 07/26/2025 | 50 FL LCM Male | AA | Final 2nd |
| 1:25.32 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 GU AAU Junior Olympic Games - Houston | 07/24/2025 | 100 FL LCM Male | AA | Final 2nd |
| 3:08.12 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT North Texas Long Course Age Group Championship | 06/29/2025 | 200 IM LCM Male | AA | Final 10th |
| 43.01 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 GU AAU Junior Olympic Games - Houston | 07/26/2025 | 50 BR LCM Male | AAA | Final 1st |
| 1:34.33 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT North Texas Long Course Age Group Championship | 06/29/2025 | 100 BR LCM Male | AAA | Final 3rd |
| 2:22.37 | Iron Horse Aquatics | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT North Texas Long Course Age Group Championship | 06/29/2025 | 200 FR-R LCM Male | AAA | Final 5th |
| 2:34.82 | Iron Horse Aquatics | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Texas Age Group Long Course Championships | 07/19/2025 | 200 MED-R LCM Male | AAAA | Final 9th |

| TIME | COMPETITOR | TEAM | MEET NAME | DATE | EVENT | STANDARD | SESSION |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1:26.91 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Short Course 14 & Under Championships | 02/02/2025 | 100 BR SCY Male | A | Final 3rd |
| 2:52.79 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Short Course 14 & Under Championships | 02/02/2025 | 200 IM SCY Male | A | Final 9th |
| 39.45 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Short Course 14 & Under Championships | 02/01/2025 | 50 BR SCY Male | AA | Final 5th |
| 34.15 | [redacted] Jordan | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Short Course 14 & Under Championships | 01/31/2025 | 50 FL SCY Male | AA | Final 7th |
| 2:11.34 | Iron Horse Aquatics | Iron Horse Aquatics | 2025 NT Short Course 14 & Under Championships | 02/02/2025 | 200 FR-R SCY Male | AA | Final 3rd |

# Level I Complaint Conference Script

**The administrator conducting the Level I Complaint Conference will follow the script as outlined and read the italicized verbiage below.**

## I. BEFORE RECORDING

*Hello, I will be recording this Level I conference for the record and to ensure that all of the information you share with us today is accurately captured. I will now begin the recording.*

*{BEGIN RECORDING}*

## II. INTRODUCTION

**Administrator:**

*Today is Friday, March 6, 2026, and the time is 11:30. My name is Melissa Howard Frisco ISD Swim and Dive Coordinator and I am the administrator designated to serve as the hearing officer for this matter. We are meeting to consider a Level I complaint at the request of Mr. Steven Jordan. This meeting is taking place at The FISD Administration Building located at 5515 Ohio Dr., Frisco, TX 75034 and is being held in accordance with the Frisco ISD Administrative Complaint Process.*

*At this time, will everyone present please state your name and your role or relationship to the individual who has requested this conference.*

[INTRODUCTIONS MADE].

*The purpose of this conference is for the complainant to present information and evidence relevant to the complaint. Following this conference, I will complete a*

*thorough investigation, including a review of the information presented in this conference, and render a decision regarding the complaint and the requested remedies.*

*All participants should refrain from talking when another person is speaking so that the recording will accurately reflect the proceedings. Further, please make statements as clear and complete as possible. Remember that the recording will not reflect gestures or any other form of non-verbal communications. In order to ensure the recording accurately reflects who is speaking, please state your name prior to making statements.*

*A Level I complaint conference is not like a trial but instead is an administrative proceeding. As such, neither the complainant nor myself will call witnesses or cross examine any participant. This is simply an opportunity for the complainant to present information and evidence relevant to the complaint.*

## III. PRESENTATION OF FACTS

*As a reminder, this is your opportunity to provide all relevant information related to your Level I complaint. Therefore, I urge you to present the issues, describe the specific allegations of your complaint, and state the specific remedies you are requesting.*

*I have allotted 30 minutes for your presentation. [IF GRIEVANCE WAS FILED BY MORE THAN ONE GRIEVANT: If you have more than one party presenting, all parties must remain within the 30 minutes total allotted for the grievant's presentation. You may also elect to have a single representative speak on behalf of all grievants.] I am here to listen, not to answer questions, offer opinions, give advice, or render any decisions during this conference. However, I may ask clarifying questions during or after your presentation. Your presentation should include all information relevant to your complaint.*

*At this time, you may present the information and evidence relevant to your complaint. If you have any documents you would like me to consider, you may present them as well.*

[Complainant or attorney/representative presents the complaint. Listen and ask questions when something is unclear. Generally, if the attorney/representative attempts

to speak the entire time, you may redirect the complainant to participate. Ultimately, however, you should not deny the attorney/representative the opportunity to speak.]

## IV. CLARIFY ALLEGATIONS AND REQUESTED REMEDIES

*Based on the information you presented, it is my understanding that the allegations raised in your complaint are:*

- [List allegations in the complaint as you understand them]

*Is that correct?*

*As I understand it, you are requesting the following remedies:*

- [List requested relief as you understand it]

*Is that correct?*

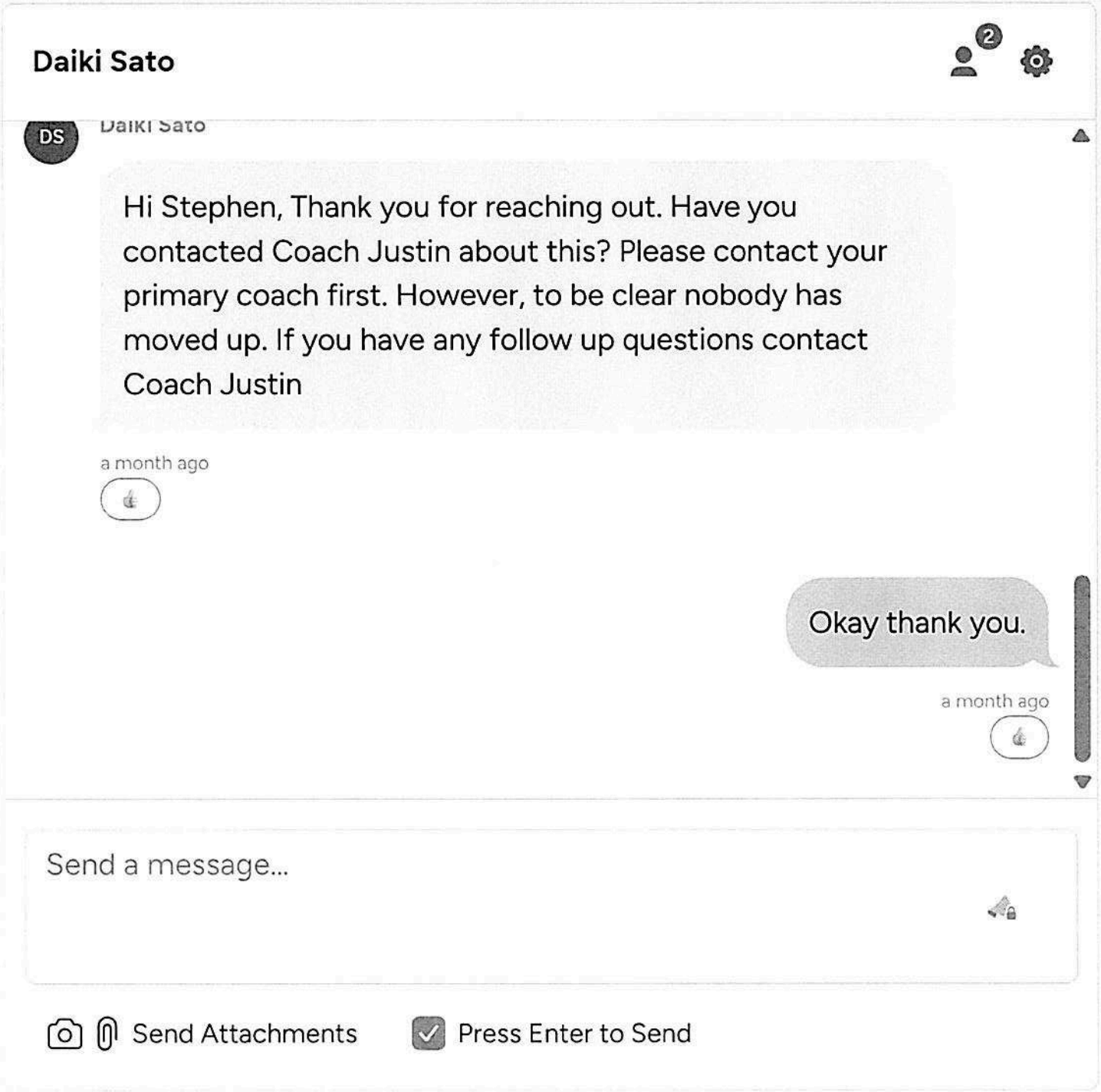
## V. DISCUSSION OF DECISION

*Pursuant to the Frisco ISD Administrative Complaint Process], I will provide you with a written response within twenty (20) calendar days of the date of this conference, absent extenuating circumstances. In reaching a decision, I will complete a thorough investigation of the allegations in your complaint, including a review of all the information and evidence you presented today and any other information I believe will help resolve the complaint. You have received a fair opportunity to present your complaint today.*

## VI. ADJOURN CONFERENCE

*Thank you for your time. This Level I conference is concluded. The time is [TIME] and I will now stop the recording.*

*{END RECORDING}*


Daiki Sato
2
DS
Daiki Sato
Hi Stephen, Thank you for reaching out. Have you contacted Coach Justin about this? Please contact your primary coach first. However, to be clear nobody has moved up. If you have any follow up questions contact Coach Justin
a month ago
Okay thank you.
a month ago
Send a message...
Send Attachments
Press Enter to Send

**Justin Bilgri**

7 months ago

Is [redacted] being promoted to the gold group? I don't care if he stays in silver but I would like his workouts to go to 1.5 hours per day.

7 months ago

JB Justin Bilgri

Good afternoon, I saw your note for [redacted] regarding the COR a/bb meet [OBJ] on the Saturday he only qualifies for one event so I will just decline him for that meet and enter

Send a message...

Send Attachments  Press Enter to Send

**Justin Bilgri**

I just found out thst [redacted] is in the gold group. [redacted] is not better than [redacted] in the breast and fly. [redacted] needs the extra time in the pool that the gold group would give him. Please switch [redacted] as soon as possible.

a month ago

JB Justin Bilgri

Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March. Please send me an email at Bilgrij@friscoisd.org if you would like to discuss this further.

Send a message...

Send Attachments  Press Enter to Send

**Matt Franks**

I just found out thst [redacted] is in the gold group. [redacted] is not better than [redacted] in the breast and fly. [redacted] needs the extra time in the pool that the gold group would give him. Please switch [redacted] as soon as possible.

a month ago

MF Matt Franks

Thanks for your message. Have you contacted Coach Justin, [redacted] primary coach, or Coach Daiki the head age group coach yet?

If not start with Coach Justin. It's highly inappropriate to

Send a message...

Send Attachments  Press Enter to Send

**Matt Franks**

If not start with Coach Justin. It's highly inappropriate to take a concern about your son directly to the head coach before following the established chain of command.

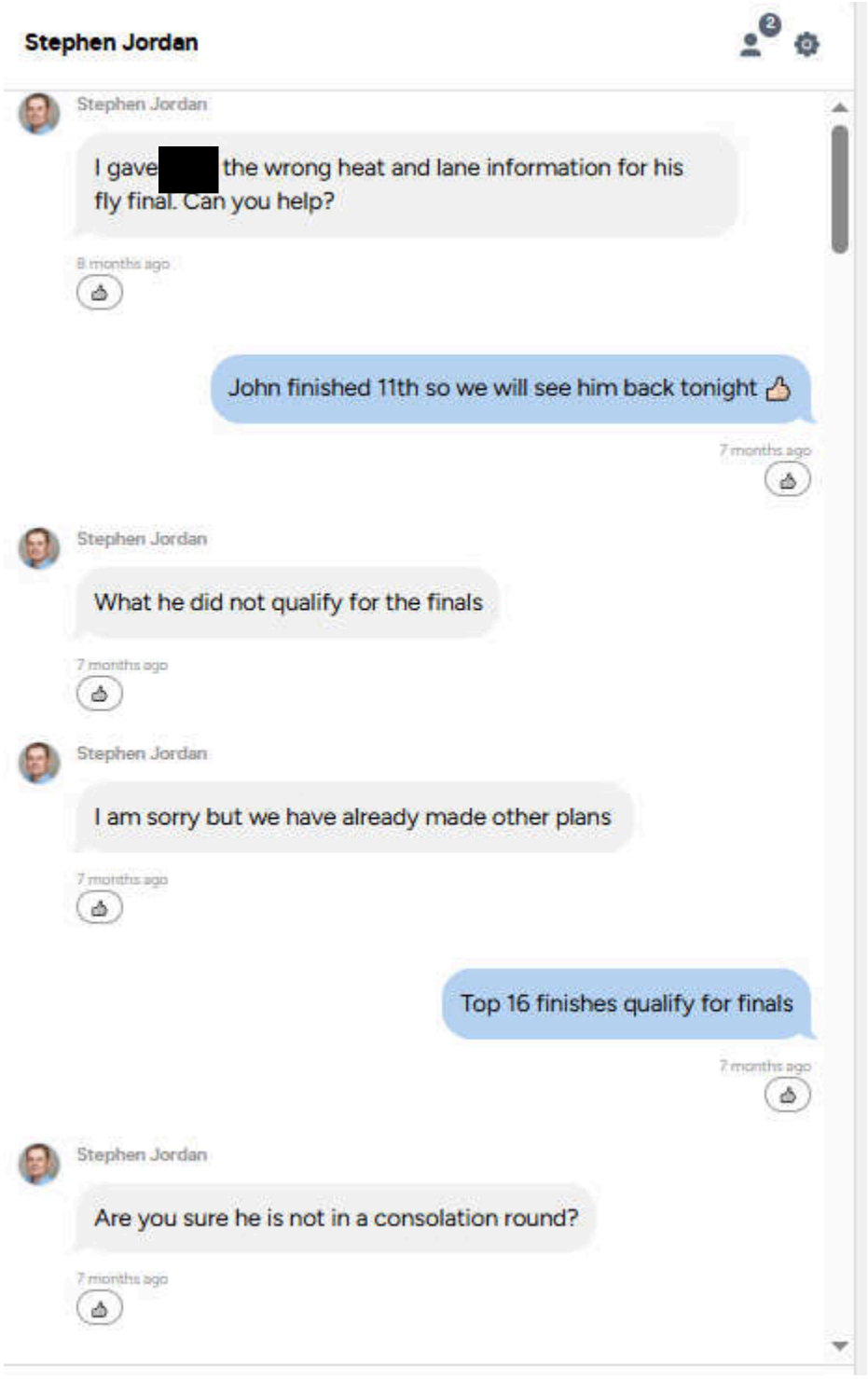
a month ago

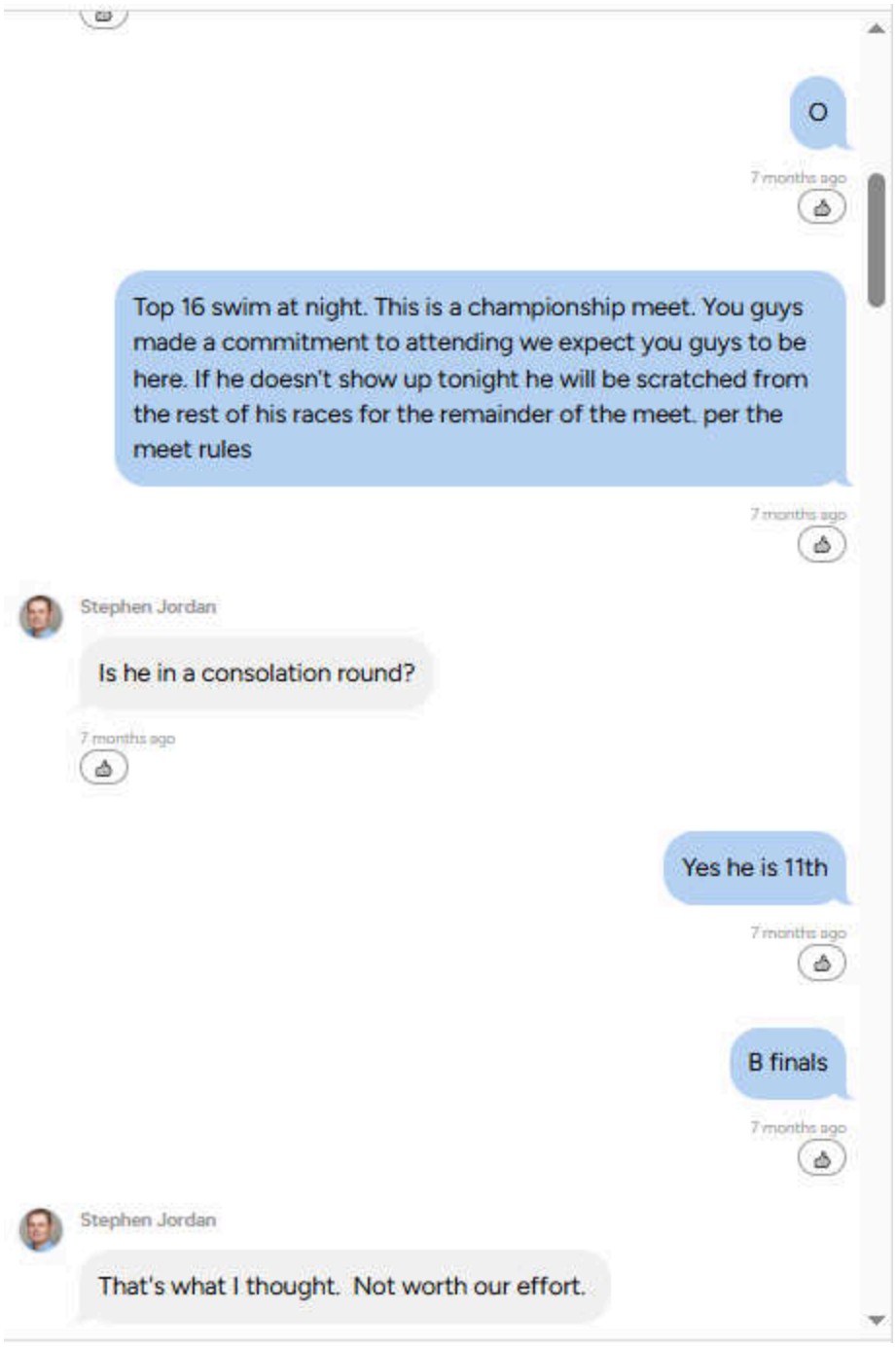
Nope, the system is yours. It's starts and ends with you. I will send a message to Justin, but I will not let this die. You said all promotions are in April and July. Yet. I have seen many promotions outside those dates. It is not just right.

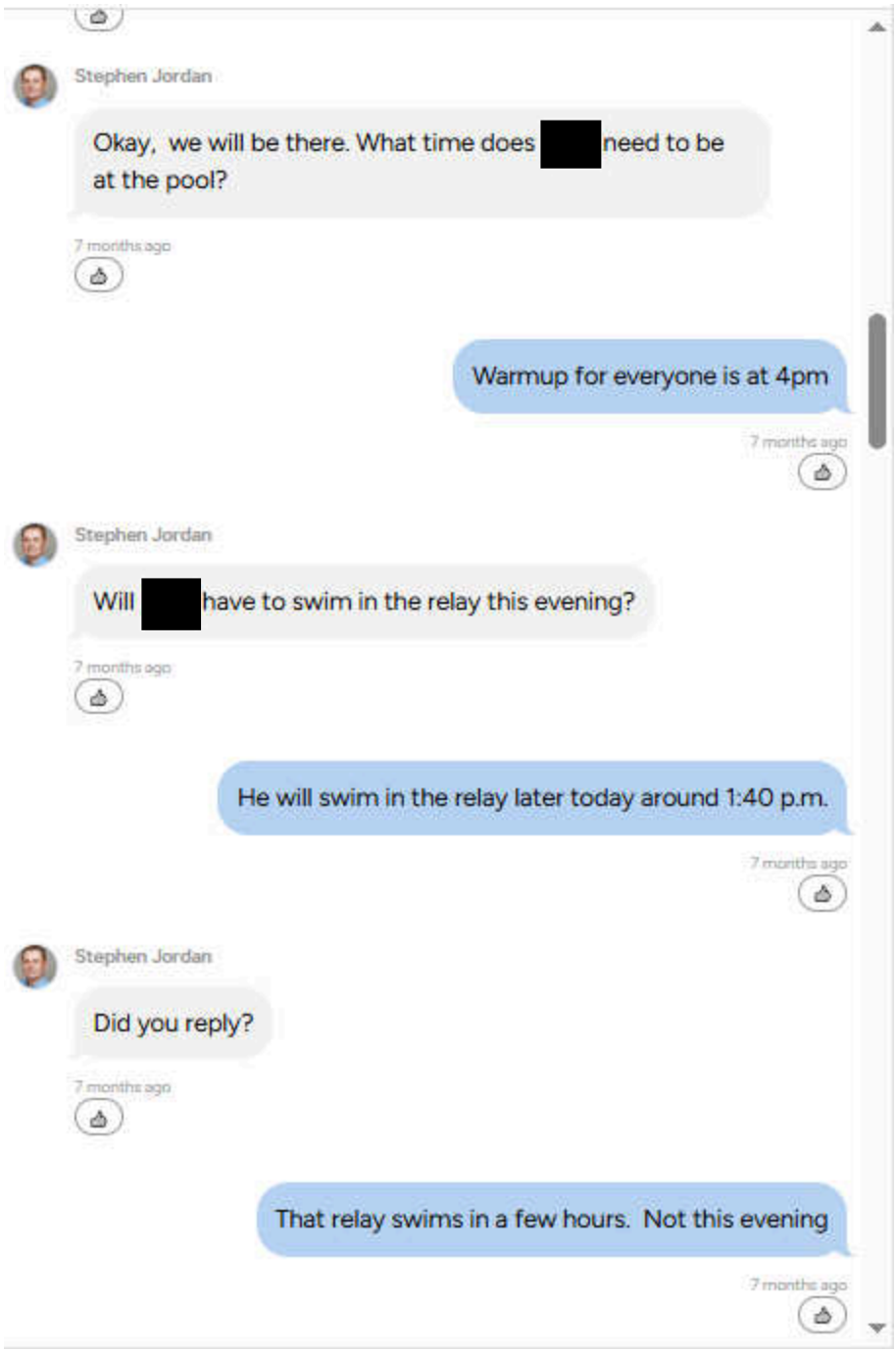
a month ago

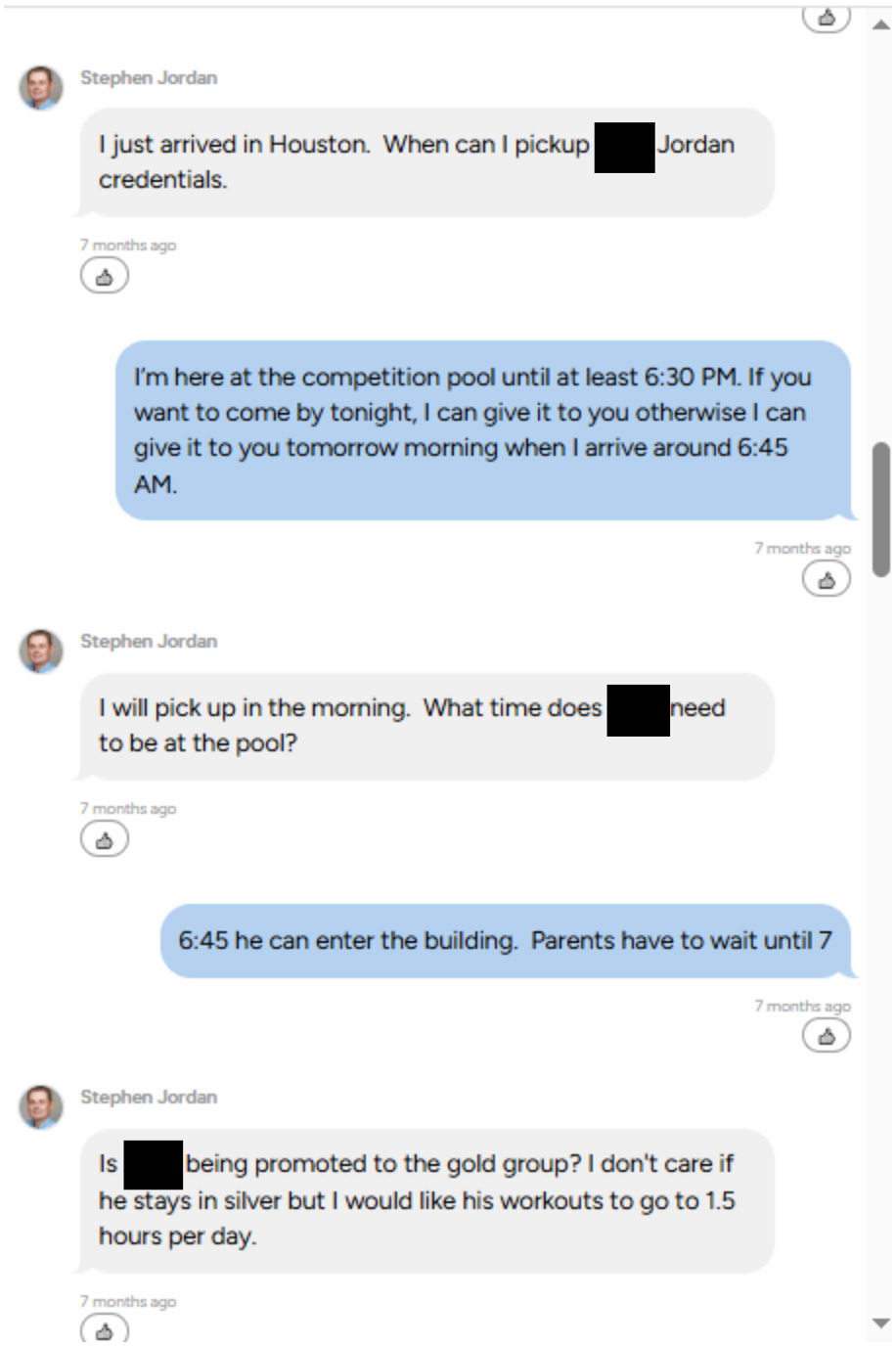
Send a message...

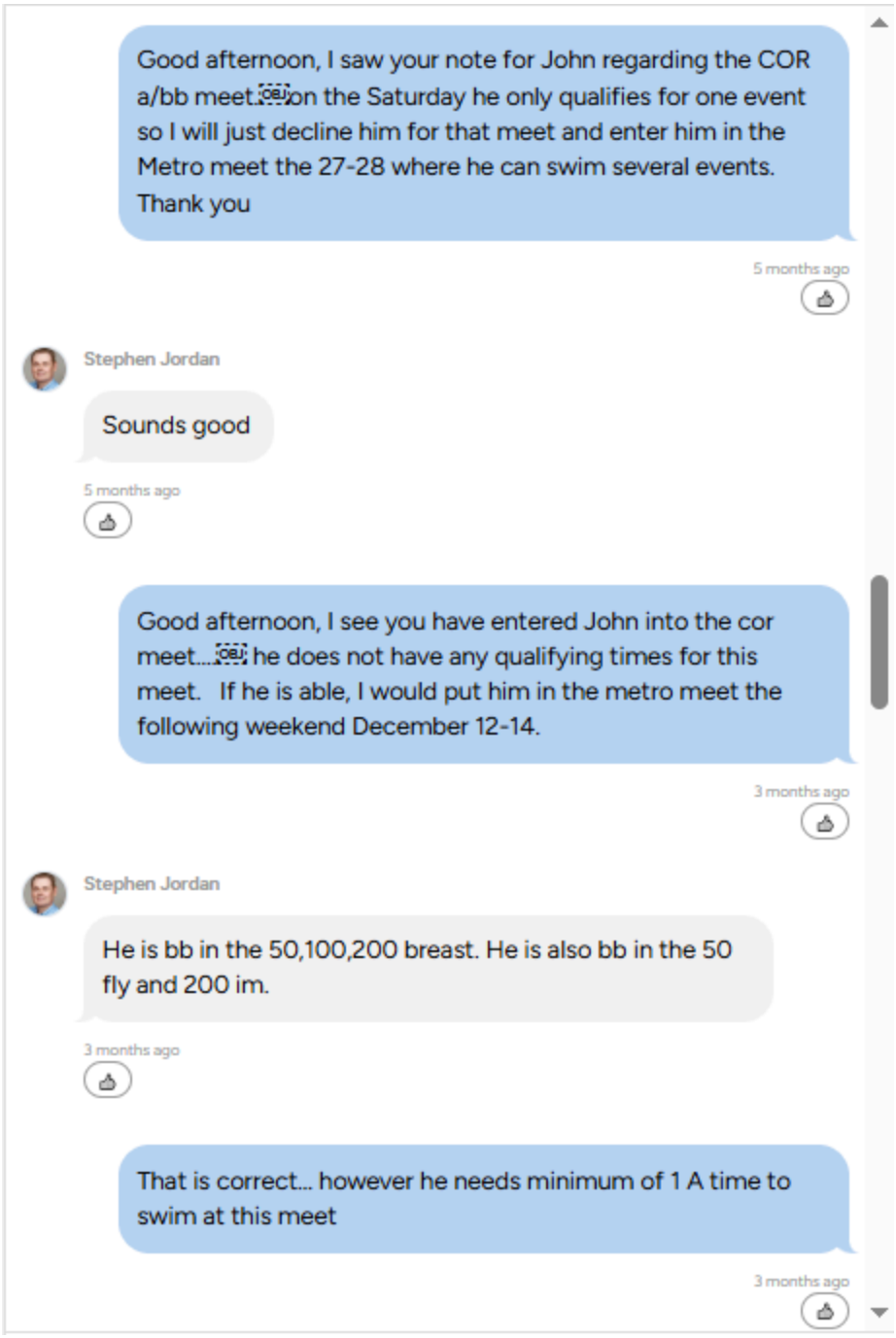
Send Attachments  Press Enter to Send


Stephen Jordan
Stephen Jordan
I gave [redacted] the wrong heat and lane information for his fly final. Can you help?
8 months ago
John finished 11th so we will see him back tonight
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
What he did not qualify for the finals
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
I am sorry but we have already made other plans
7 months ago
Top 16 finishes qualify for finals
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Are you sure he is not in a consolation round?
7 months ago


O
7 months ago
Top 16 swim at night. This is a championship meet. You guys made a commitment to attending we expect you guys to be here. If he doesn't show up tonight he will be scratched from the rest of his races for the remainder of the meet. per the meet rules
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Is he in a consolation round?
7 months ago
Yes he is 11th
7 months ago
B finals
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
That's what I thought. Not worth our effort.


Stephen Jordan
Okay, we will be there. What time does [redacted] need to be at the pool?
7 months ago
Warmup for everyone is at 4pm
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Will [redacted] have to swim in the relay this evening?
7 months ago
He will swim in the relay later today around 1:40 p.m.
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Did you reply?
7 months ago
That relay swims in a few hours. Not this evening
7 months ago


Stephen Jordan
I just arrived in Houston. When can I pickup [redacted] Jordan credentials.
7 months ago
I'm here at the competition pool until at least 6:30 PM. If you want to come by tonight, I can give it to you otherwise I can give it to you tomorrow morning when I arrive around 6:45 AM.
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
I will pick up in the morning. What time does [redacted] need to be at the pool?
7 months ago
6:45 he can enter the building. Parents have to wait until 7
7 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Is [redacted] being promoted to the gold group? I don't care if he stays in silver but I would like his workouts to go to 1.5 hours per day.
7 months ago


Good afternoon, I saw your note for John regarding the COR a/bb meet on the Saturday he only qualifies for one event so I will just decline him for that meet and enter him in the Metro meet the 27-28 where he can swim several events. Thank you
5 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Sounds good
5 months ago
Good afternoon, I see you have entered John into the cor meet.... he does not have any qualifying times for this meet. If he is able, I would put him in the metro meet the following weekend December 12-14.
3 months ago
Stephen Jordan
He is bb in the 50,100,200 breast. He is also bb in the 50 fly and 200 im.
3 months ago
That is correct... however he needs minimum of 1 A time to swim at this meet
3 months ago

Stephen Jordan

I can only do day 2 on Sunday. He can do events 28,30,32 on Sunday if they are in the morning. I will not pull him out of school on Monday.

3 months ago

The meet is Friday-Sunday. I can enter him in those events you listed but they are on Saturday. morning

3 months ago

Stephen Jordan

I am confused. Can you send me a schedule.

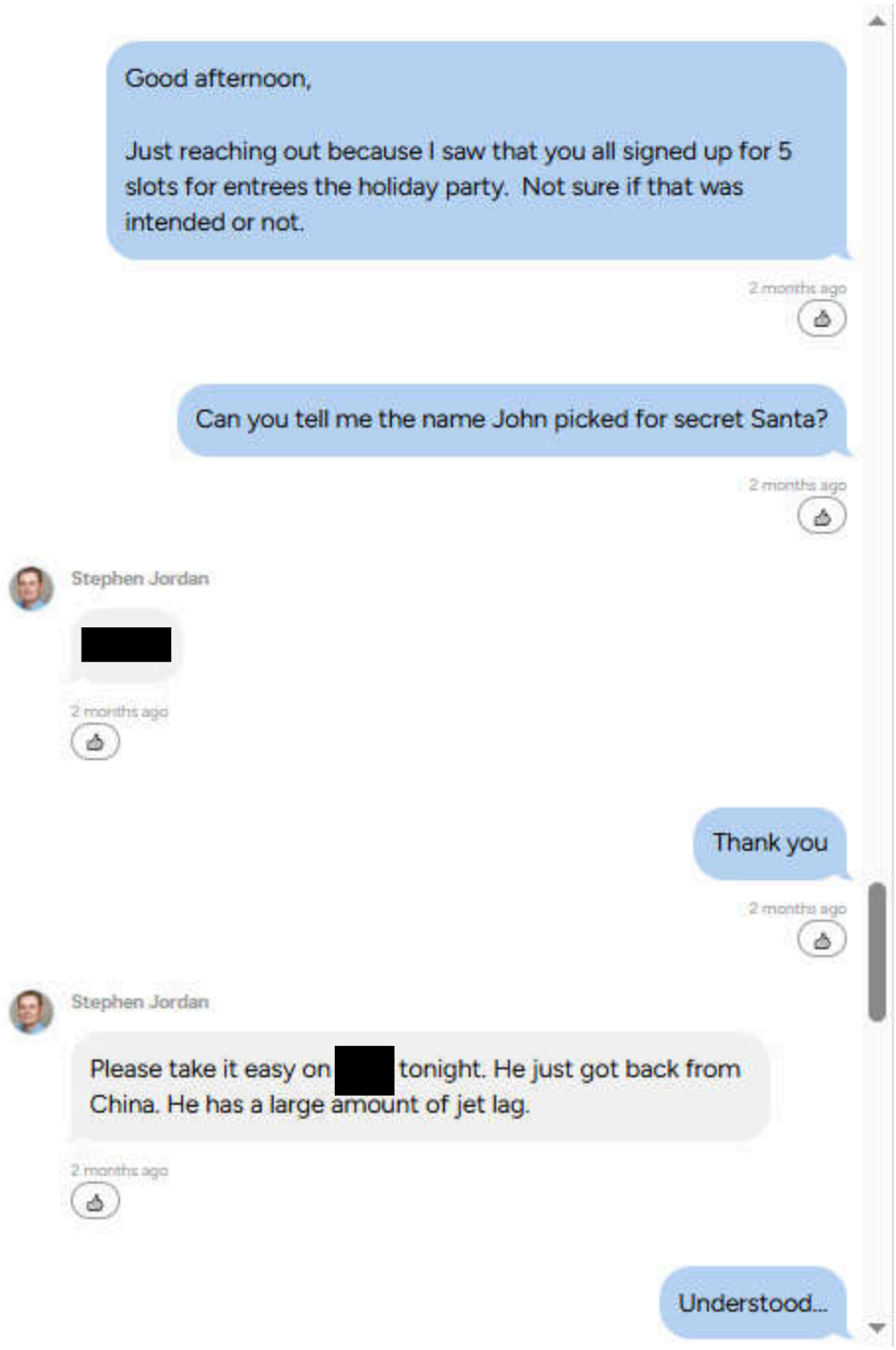
3 months ago

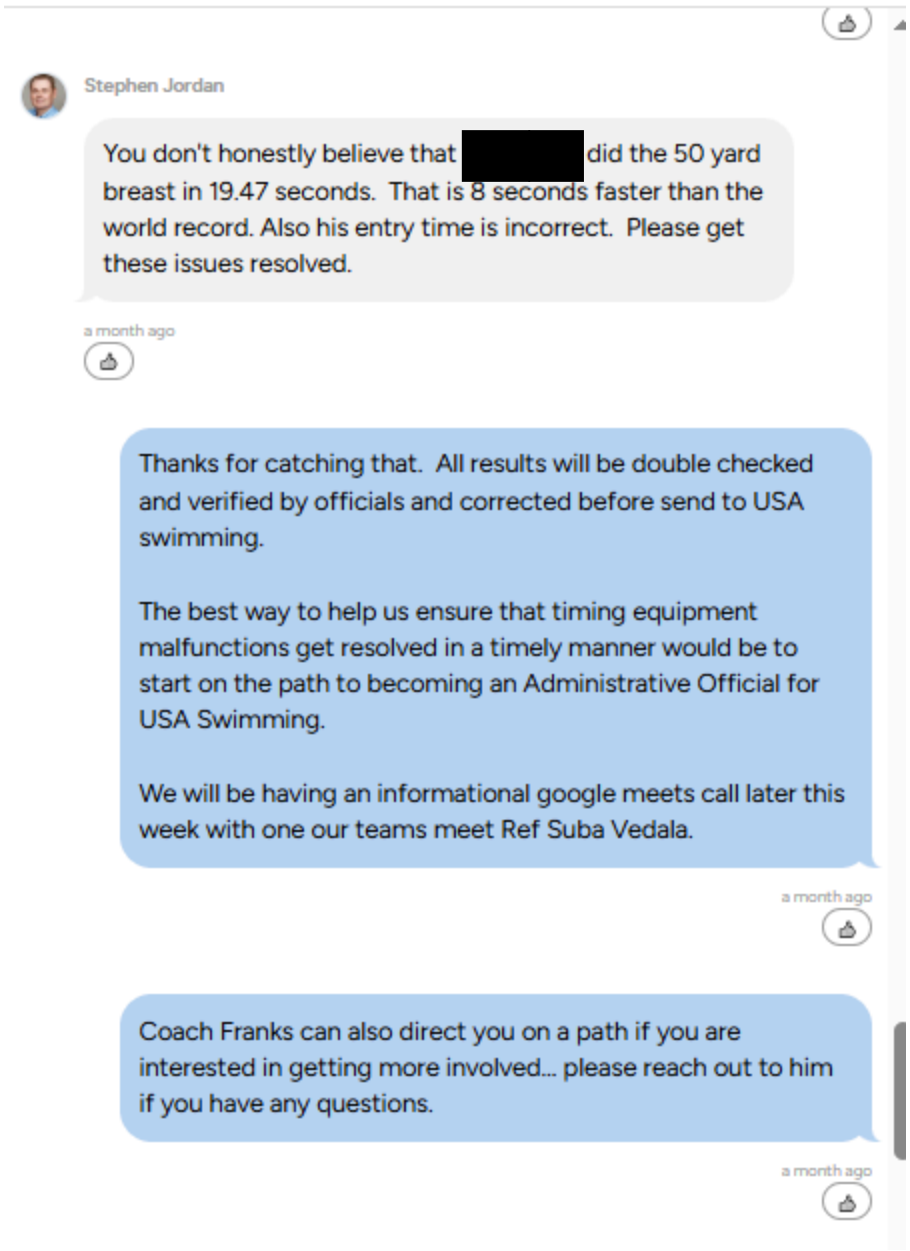


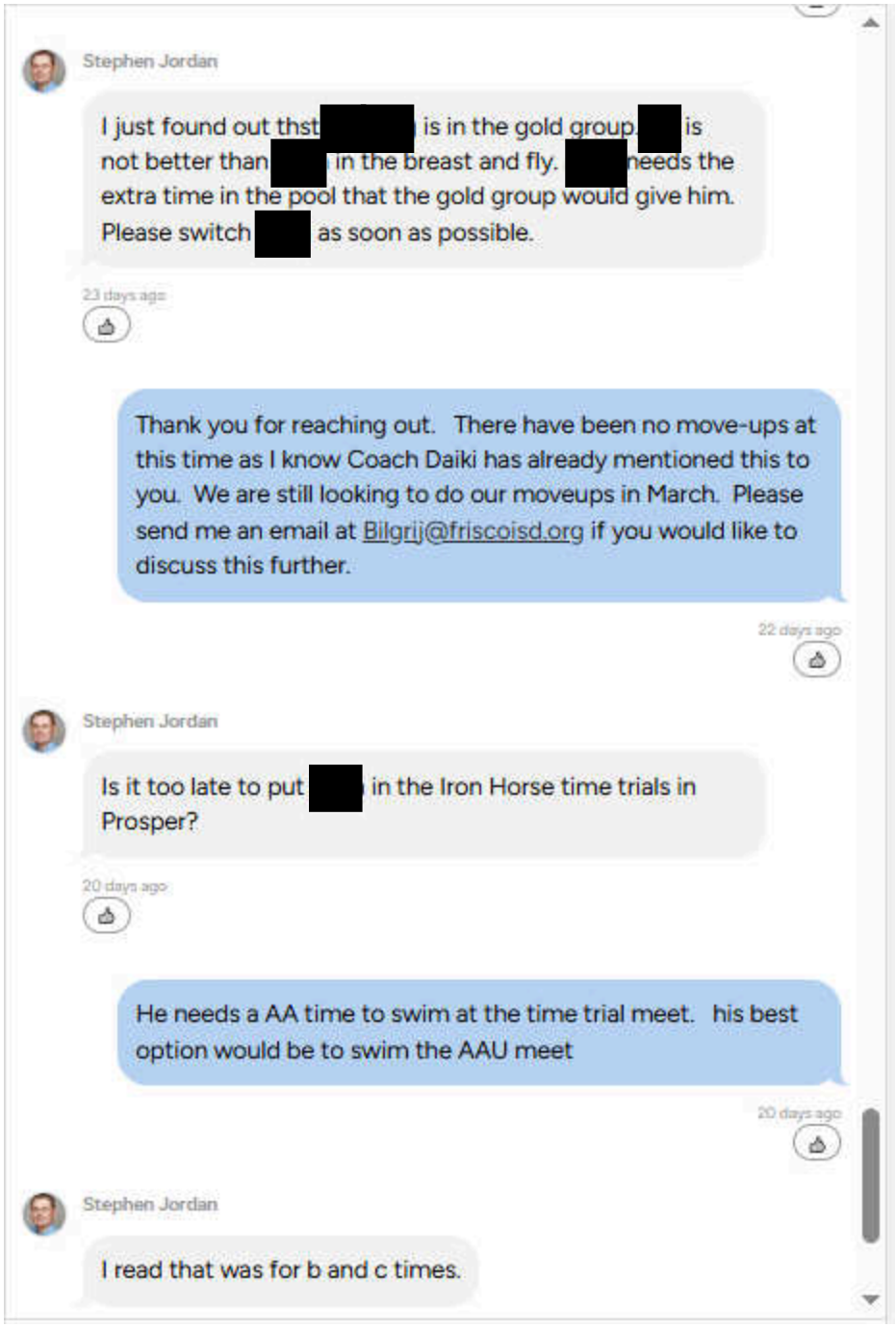
3 months ago

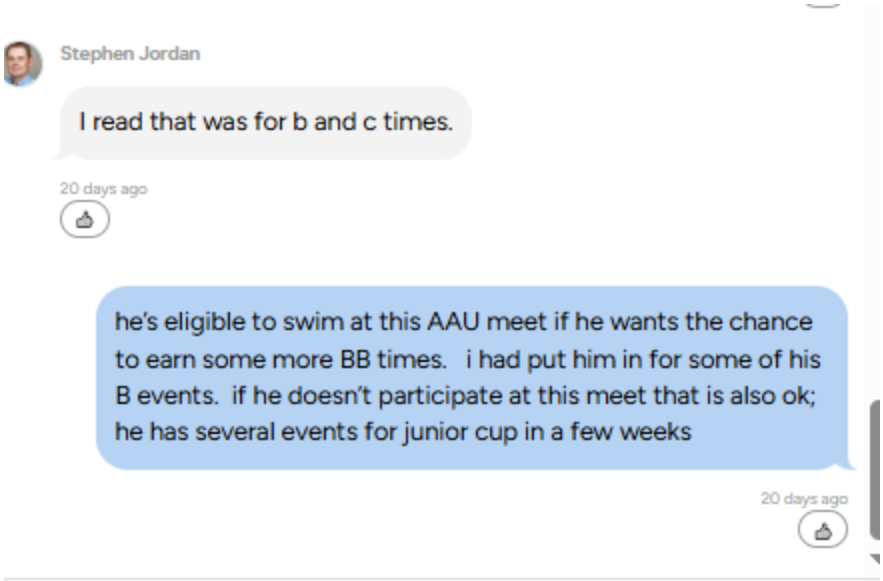
Stephen Jordan

Ok, do 16, 28,30,32. Scratch 16 if he can't do 4 events.


Good afternoon,
Just reaching out because I saw that you all signed up for 5 slots for entrees the holiday party. Not sure if that was intended or not.
2 months ago
Can you tell me the name John picked for secret Santa?
2 months ago
Stephen Jordan
[redacted]
2 months ago
Thank you
2 months ago
Stephen Jordan
Please take it easy on [redacted] tonight. He just got back from China. He has a large amount of jet lag.
2 months ago
Understood...


Stephen Jordan
You don't honestly believe that [redacted] did the 50 yard breast in 19.47 seconds. That is 8 seconds faster than the world record. Also his entry time is incorrect. Please get these issues resolved.
a month ago
Thanks for catching that. All results will be double checked and verified by officials and corrected before send to USA swimming.
The best way to help us ensure that timing equipment malfunctions get resolved in a timely manner would be to start on the path to becoming an Administrative Official for USA Swimming.
We will be having an informational google meets call later this week with one our teams meet Ref Suba Vedala.
a month ago
Coach Franks can also direct you on a path if you are interested in getting more involved... please reach out to him if you have any questions.
a month ago


Stephen Jordan
I just found out thst [redacted] is in the gold group. [redacted] is not better than [redacted] in the breast and fly. [redacted] needs the extra time in the pool that the gold group would give him. Please switch [redacted] as soon as possible.
23 days ago
Thank you for reaching out. There have been no move-ups at this time as I know Coach Daiki has already mentioned this to you. We are still looking to do our moveups in March. Please send me an email at Bilgrij@friscoisd.org if you would like to discuss this further.
22 days ago
Stephen Jordan
Is it too late to put [redacted] in the Iron Horse time trials in Prosper?
20 days ago
He needs a AA time to swim at the time trial meet. his best option would be to swim the AAU meet
20 days ago
Stephen Jordan
I read that was for b and c times.


Stephen Jordan
I read that was for b and c times.
20 days ago
he's eligible to swim at this AAU meet if he wants the chance to earn some more BB times. i had put him in for some of his B events. if he doesn't participate at this meet that is also ok; he has several events for junior cup in a few weeks
20 days ago

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | Complaint Resolution |
| **Sent time:** | 05/20/2026 03:29:22 PM |
| **To:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> |
| **Subject:** | FISD Complaint Process |

Mr. Jordan,
I have reviewed the information you shared in your email communication on Monday, May 18, 2026. As you noted in your response, your issue is not a legal issue. The basis of your complaint is that you would prefer the Iron Horse program to run in a particular way and you do not agree that Iron Horse coaches should have wide discretion to make decisions regarding practice and advancement of student-athletes.

You noted complaints regarding the following areas within a coach's discretion:
"• measurable performance data provides an objective basis for evaluation
• advancement criteria should operate within a defined framework
• transparency and consistency are important within publicly supported programs
• undefined discretionary advancement structures create avoidable fairness concerns"

As noted in the Level 2 response you received, the items you requested are not required by law. Additionally, it has been made clear to you at both Levels 1 and 2 that coaches have discretion, based on their expertise and instructional knowledge, to make decisions regarding practice structure, team placement, and athlete advancement.

Please be aware that the subject matter of your complaint is regarding an extracurricular. As such, it is governed by the District's Administrative Complaints Process in which formal complaints are only allowable through Level 2. Therefore, if you file a Level 3 complaint on the issues presented in your email, it will be dismissed. The Level 2 response you received is final.
Sincerely,

Frisco ISD

**Shelley Anderson**
*Complaint Resolution Coordinator*
469.633.6390
andersonsh@friscoisd.org
FISD Administration

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> |
| **Sent time:** | 05/21/2026 04:38:28 PM |
| **To:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> |
| **Subject:** | Re: FISD Complaint Process |
| **Attachments:** | Outlook-Frisco ISD.png |

Mr. Jordan,

Respectfully, you have not filed a Level III appeal. The District prescribes that all complaints must be filed through the electronic form available on our website. You have used this process twice for your Level I complaint and Level II appeal filing. If you wish to submit a Level III appeal, you will need to follow the same procedure. In case you need it again, the electronic form to submit a grievance can be found on our website here. If you scroll to the bottom of the page, you will see a yellow button that says "Submit a Formal Complaint."

However, as a courtesy, our Complaints Resolution Coordinator communicated to you yesterday that if you do file a Level III appeal based on the information contained in your email, it will most likely be dismissed. As she noted, your complaint is regarding extracurricular participation and your disagreement with the discretion provided to coaches who oversee that extracurricular. In accordance with Texas Education Code 26.011 and Frisco ISD policy and procedures, complaints concerning a student's participation in an extracurricular activity are not heard by the Board of Trustees. Instead, the District allows complaints regarding extracurriculars to be heard through its internal Administrative Complaints Process, which stops at Level II. You received decisions on the merits of your complaint at both Levels I and II of the Administrative Complaints Process.

Again, you are welcome to file a Level III appeal if you wish to do so. However, if it is based on the same concerns voiced by you at Levels I and II and in your previous email, the subject matter is limited to our Administrative Complaints Process. The Complaints Resolution Manager communicated that to you via email in an effort to ensure efficacy, to let you know about the District's policy and procedures, and to ensure you understood the likely outcome of a Level III filing in this matter.

Best,

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, May 21, 2026 4:02 PM
**To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>; Anderson, Shelley <andersonsh@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org <lass@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Complaint Process

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I am following up on my message of yesterday requesting confirmation of the District's final position on the Level III appeal I filed on May 18, 2026.
Today, I received a response through Lighthouse Services regarding Report Number 9022620263313, the ethics complaint I filed on February 26, 2026. The District's response to Lighthouse stated, in writing: "The complaint was filed as a grievance with the district. It will be handled through the grievance process."
That statement is inconsistent with your letter of May 19, which informed me that the Level II response is final and that any Level III filing "will be dismissed." If the ethics complaint is being handled through the grievance process, then the grievance process has not concluded with respect to the substance of that complaint, which has not received any written disposition by the District since its filing on February 26, 2026.
I am requesting written clarification on three points:
First, whether the District's grievance process is, or is not, closed with respect to the matters raised in the underlying grievance and the related ethics complaint.
Second, whether the Board of Trustees has been informed that a Level III appeal was filed on May 18, 2026, and that it was administratively terminated through your letter of May 19.

Third, whether the District wishes to revisit the position stated in your May 19 letter in light of the inconsistency described above.
I would appreciate a written response by close of business on the fifth business day following this message.
Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan

On Wed, May 20, 2026 at 3:40 PM Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> wrote:

> I will submit to TEA. Then to state courts. The courts will want know why the board did not hear the case. Is this your final position?
>
> **Stephen R. Jordan**
> **Owner & Accountant, SRJ Consulting & Services LLC.**
>
> Phone +1 (415) 413-7772 | Mobile +1 (972) 403-1231
> web www.srjconsultingservices.com
> email srj@srjconsultingservices.com
> 13054 Cinderella Ln. Frisco, Texas 75035
> Fax +1 (469) 731-4368
>
> Create your own email signature
>
> ------ Original Message ------
> From "Complaint Resolution" <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
> To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
> Date 5/20/2026 15:29:22
> Subject FISD Complaint Process
>
> Mr. Jordan,
> I have reviewed the information you shared in your email communication on Monday, May 18, 2026. As you noted in your response, your issue is not a legal issue. The basis of your complaint is that you would prefer the Iron Horse program to run in a particular way and you do not agree that Iron Horse coaches should have wide discretion to make decisions regarding practice and advancement of student-athletes.
>
> You noted complaints regarding the following areas within a coach's discretion:
> "• measurable performance data provides an objective basis for evaluation
> • advancement criteria should operate within a defined framework
> • transparency and consistency are important within publicly supported programs
> • undefined discretionary advancement structures create avoidable fairness concerns"
>
> As noted in the Level 2 response you received, the items you requested are not required by law. Additionally, it has been made clear to you at both Levels 1 and 2 that coaches have discretion, based on their expertise and instructional knowledge, to make decisions regarding practice structure, team placement, and athlete advancement.
>
> Please be aware that the subject matter of your complaint is regarding an extracurricular. As such, it is governed by the District's Administrative Complaints Process in which formal complaints are only allowable through Level 2. Therefore, if you file a Level 3 complaint on the issues presented in your email, it will be dismissed. The Level 2 response you received is final.
> Sincerely,
>
> Frisco ISD
> **Shelley Anderson**
> *Complaint Resolution Coordinator*
> 469.633.6390
> andersonsh@friscoisd.org
> FISD Administration

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> |
| **Sent time:** | 05/21/2026 10:04:52 PM |
| **To:** | Kolni, Esther |
| **Subject:** | Re: FISD Complaint Process |
| **Attachments:** | Outlook-Frisco ISD.png |

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Subject: Re: FISD Complaint Process

Dear Ms. Kolni,

Thank you for your email of May 21, 2026. I want to respond directly to the points it raises.

First, my intent. I do intend to file a Level III appeal, and I have attempted to file it through the District's electronic form, as instructed. The form does not work. When I open the "Submit a Formal Complaint" page — including through the link in your email — the data fields are greyed out and will not accept any input. I reported this to Complaint Resolution on May 19 and again on May 20. Complaint Resolution attributed it to a storm-related power outage and asked me to retry; I retried, and the form still does not function. I am therefore not declining to file. I am unable to file through the channel the District requires, for reasons outside my control. I respectfully request either a working electronic form, confirmed in writing as operational, or written confirmation that the District will accept my Level III appeal by email.

Second, your statement that I received "decisions on the merits" at both Levels I and II. Respectfully, that is not what the record shows. The Level II Response addressed only the narrow question of whether Texas Education Code Section 26.0062 requires the District to publish a syllabus for an extracurricular program. It did not address the substance of my grievance — the contradictory written communications from coaching staff dated February 2, 2026, the conflict-of-interest concerns raised in my ethics complaint, or the inconsistent application of advancement standards across swimmers. A decision on a narrow legal question is not a decision on the merits of the grievance I filed.

Third, your statement that this matter is governed by an "Administrative Complaints Process" that limits formal complaints to Level II, supported by your citation to Texas Education Code Section 26.011 and "Frisco ISD policy and procedures." So that I can properly understand the District's position, I respectfully request that you identify, by policy code and section:

1. the specific Board Policy or administrative regulation that establishes the "Administrative Complaints Process" as a process distinct from FNG(LOCAL);

2. the specific provision that limits that process to Level II; and

3. the specific provision under which my grievance was classified as a complaint concerning a student's participation in an extracurricular activity.

I ask because the Level I and Level II proceedings in this matter were conducted under Board Policy FNG(LOCAL), and the District's March 30, 2026 remand expressly cited FNG(LOCAL). I would like to understand the policy basis for applying a different framework at the point Level III review becomes available.

Fourth, I want to be unambiguous on one point. The ethics complaint I filed with Lighthouse Services on February 26, 2026 (Report Number 9022620263313) is a separate matter. I filed it as a formal ethics complaint — alleging deceptive communication by District employees, a prohibited financial conflict of interest, and undue influence — through the District's ethics reporting channel. I did not file it as a grievance. It is not part of, governed by, or resolved by the Administrative Complaints Process or the Level II response, and I do not accept the District's characterization, communicated to Lighthouse Services, that the complaint "was filed as a grievance."

Regardless of how the District characterizes it, the ethics complaint has received no written disposition since February 26, 2026. If the District maintains, as it told Lighthouse Services, that the complaint "will be handled through the grievance process," then the grievance process is not closed. If the District treats the ethics complaint as the separate matter it is, then it remains an independent, unresolved complaint requiring its own investigation and written disposition. Either way, it is not concluded. I request a written disposition of the

ethics complaint that addresses its allegations on their own terms.

Because I am being directed to a filing system that does not function, I also ask the District to confirm in writing that no filing deadline will run against me, and that my Level III appeal will not be treated as untimely, during the period the District's electronic form has been and remains non-functional.

This email is intended to clarify the record and to obtain a workable path to file. I do not, by this email, concede the District's characterization of this matter, and I reserve all arguments for the appropriate forum.

I would appreciate a response within five business days.

Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan

On Thu, May 21, 2026 at 4:38 PM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> Respectfully, you have not filed a Level III appeal. The District prescribes that all complaints must be filed through the electronic form available on our website. You have used this process twice for your Level I complaint and Level II appeal filing. If you wish to submit a Level III appeal, you will need to follow the same procedure. In case you need it again, the electronic form to submit a grievance can be found on our website here. If you scroll to the bottom of the page, you will see a yellow button that says "Submit a Formal Complaint."
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> However, as a courtesy, our Complaints Resolution Coordinator communicated to you yesterday that if you do file a Level III appeal based on the information contained in your email, it will most likely be dismissed. As she noted, your complaint is regarding extracurricular participation and your disagreement with the discretion provided to coaches who oversee that extracurricular. In accordance with Texas Education Code 26.011 and Frisco ISD policy and procedures, complaints concerning a student's participation in an extracurricular activity are not heard by the Board of Trustees. Instead, the District allows complaints regarding extracurriculars to be heard through its internal Administrative Complaints Process, which stops at Level II. You received decisions on the merits of your complaint at both Levels I and II of the Administrative Complaints Process.
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>
> Best,
>
> **Esther Kolni,**
> *J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
> *General Counsel*
> 469.633.6057
> kolnie@friscoisd.org
> Frisco ISD Administration
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
> **Sent:** Thursday, May 21, 2026 4:02 PM
> **To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>; Anderson, Shelley <andersonsh@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org <lass@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>
> **Subject:** Re: FISD Complaint Process
>
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Third, whether the District wishes to revisit the position stated in your May 19 letter in light of the inconsistency described above.

I would appreciate a written response by close of business on the fifth business day following this message.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan

On Wed, May 20, 2026 at 3:40 PM Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> wrote:

I will submit to TEA. Then to state courts. The courts will want know why the board did not hear the case. Is this your final position?


**Stephen R. Jordan**
**Owner & Accountant, SRJ Consulting & Services LLC.**

Phone +1 (415) 413-7772 | Mobile +1 (972) 403-1231
web www.srjconsultingservices.com
email srj@srjconsultingservices.com
13054 Cinderella Ln. Frisco, Texas 75035
Fax +1 (469) 731-4368


Create your own email signature

------ Original Message ------
From "Complaint Resolution" <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
Date 5/20/2026 15:29:22
Subject FISD Complaint Process

Mr. Jordan,

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"• measurable performance data provides an objective basis for evaluation
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Sincerely,

Frisco ISD

**Shelley Anderson**

*Complaint Resolution Coordinator*

469.633.6390

andersonsh@friscoisd.org

FISD Administration

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent time:** 05/21/2026 10:01:41 PM
**To:** Kolni, Esther
**Subject:** Re[2]: FISD Complaint Process
**Attachments:** Outlook-Frisco ISD.png

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Ms. Nikolai,

Thank you for your email of May 21, 2026. I want to respond directly to the points it raises.

First, my intent. I do intend to file a Level III appeal, and I have attempted to file it through the District's electronic form, as instructed. The form does not work. When I open the "Submit a Formal Complaint" page — including through the link in your email — the data fields are grayed out and will not accept any input. I reported this to Complaint Resolution on May 19 and again on May 20. Complaint Resolution attributed it to a storm-related power outage and asked me to retry; I retried, and the form still does not function. I am therefore not declining to file. I am unable to file through the channel the District requires, for reasons outside my control. I respectfully request either a working electronic form, confirmed in writing as operational, or written confirmation that the District will accept my Level III appeal by email.

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I would appreciate a response within five business days.

Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan

------ Original Message ------
From "Kolni, Esther" <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
Date 5/21/2026 4:38:28 PM
Subject Re: FISD Complaint Process

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> Respectfully, you have not filed a Level III appeal. The District prescribes that all complaints must be filed through the electronic form available on our website. You have used this process twice for your Level I complaint and Level II appeal filing. If you wish to submit a Level III appeal, you will need to follow the same procedure. In case you need it again, the electronic form to submit a grievance can be found on our website here. If you scroll to the bottom of the page, you will see a yellow button that says "Submit a Formal Complaint."
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>
> **Esther Kolni,**
> *J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
> *General Counsel*
> 469.633.6057
> kolnie@friscoisd.org
> Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, May 21, 2026 4:02 PM
**To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>; Anderson, Shelley <andersonsh@friscoisd.org>; Davis, Dynette <DavisDy@friscoisd.org>; Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>; ddoxk@friscoisd.org <ddoxk@friscoisd.org>; lass@friscoisd.org <lass@friscoisd.org>; Stephanie Elad <EladS@friscoisd.org>; Leaders <Leaders@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: FISD Complaint Process

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

I am following up on my message of yesterday requesting confirmation of the District's final position on the Level III appeal I filed on May 18, 2026.
Today, I received a response through Lighthouse Services regarding Report Number 9022620263313, the ethics complaint I filed on February 26, 2026. The District's response to Lighthouse stated, in writing: "The complaint was filed as a grievance with the district. It will be handled through the grievance process."
That statement is inconsistent with your letter of May 19, which informed me that the Level II response is final and that any Level III filing "will be dismissed." If the ethics complaint is being handled through the grievance process, then the grievance process has not concluded with respect to the substance of that complaint, which has not received any written disposition by the District since its filing on February 26, 2026.
I am requesting written clarification on three points:
First, whether the District's grievance process is, or is not, closed with respect to the matters raised in the underlying grievance and the related ethics complaint.
Second, whether the Board of Trustees has been informed that a Level III appeal was filed on May 18, 2026, and that it was administratively terminated through your letter of May 19.
Third, whether the District wishes to revisit the position stated in your May 19 letter in light of the inconsistency described above.
I would appreciate a written response by close of business on the fifth business day following this message.
Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan

On Wed, May 20, 2026 at 3:40 PM Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> wrote:

> I will submit to TEA. Then to state courts. The courts will want know why the board did not hear the case. Is this your final position?
>
> **Stephen R. Jordan**
> **Owner & Accountant, SRJ Consulting & Services LLC.**
>
> Phone +1 (415) 413-7772 | Mobile +1 (972) 403-1231
> web www.srjconsultingservices.com
> email srj@srjconsultingservices.com
> 13054 Cinderella Ln. Frisco, Texas 75035
> Fax +1 (469) 731-4368
>
> Create your own email signature
>
> ------ Original Message ------
> From "Complaint Resolution" <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
> To "Stephen Jordan" <srjordan@gmail.com>
> Date 5/20/2026 15:29:22
> Subject FISD Complaint Process
>
> Mr. Jordan,
> I have reviewed the information you shared in your email communication on Monday, May 18, 2026. As you noted in your response, your issue is not a legal issue. The basis of your complaint is that you would prefer the Iron Horse program to run in a particular way and you do not agree that Iron Horse coaches should have wide discretion to make decisions regarding practice and advancement of student-athletes.
>
> You noted complaints regarding the following areas within a coach's discretion:
> "• measurable performance data provides an objective basis for evaluation
> • advancement criteria should operate within a defined framework
> • transparency and consistency are important within publicly supported programs

• undefined discretionary advancement structures create avoidable fairness concerns”

As noted in the Level 2 response you received, the items you requested are not required by law. Additionally, it has been made clear to you at both Levels 1 and 2 that coaches have discretion, based on their expertise and instructional knowledge, to make decisions regarding practice structure, team placement, and athlete advancement.

Please be aware that the subject matter of your complaint is regarding an extracurricular. As such, it is governed by the District’s Administrative Complaints Process in which formal complaints are only allowable through Level 2. Therefore, if you file a Level 3 complaint on the issues presented in your email, it will be dismissed. The Level 2 response you received is final.
Sincerely,

Frisco ISD

**Shelley Anderson**
*Complaint Resolution Coordinator*
469.633.6390
andersonsh@friscoisd.org
FISD Administration

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

**Confidentiality Notice:** This email and any attachments are intended only for the recipient(s) named above. They may contain confidential or privileged information. If you are not the intended recipient, please delete this email immediately and notify the sender. Any unauthorized review, use, disclosure, or distribution is prohibited.

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org> |
| **Sent time:** | 06/09/2026 04:35:52 PM |
| **To:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> |
| **Cc:** | HOWARD, MELISSA; SATO, DAIKI |
| **Subject:** | Report of Conduct at the NWAA Team Travel Meet |
| **Attachments:** | image.png |

Dear Mr. Jordan,

Following the incident that occurred this past weekend, additional information regarding your interactions with meet volunteers and officials has been brought to our attention.

This email serves as formal notice that we will be conducting an investigation into your conduct as a potential violation of our Parent Code of Conduct.

As part of this process, I would like to speak with you to obtain your account of the events in question. I am available for a phone conversation on Tuesday or Thursday between 11:30 a.m. and 1:30 p.m. Please let me know which date and time within those windows works best for you.

Thank you for your cooperation and attention to this matter.

**Matt Franks**
*Head Club Swim Coach*
*Assistant Natatorium Manager*
franksma@friscoisd.org
469-633-6176
Frisco ISD Swim Center
7210 Stadium Lane
Frisco, TX 75034

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com> |
| **Sent time:** | 06/09/2026 07:35:32 PM |
| **To:** | FRANKS, MATTHEW |
| **Cc:** | HOWARD, MELISSA; SATO, DAIKI |
| **Subject:** | Re: Report of Conduct at the NWAA Team Travel Meet |
| **Attachments:** | image.png |

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Dear Mr. Franks,

Thank you for your email regarding the incident this past weekend.

I take any concern about my conduct around District programs seriously, and I want to participate in this process in good faith. I am requesting that the investigation proceed in writing rather than by telephone, so that there is a clear and accurate record on both sides.

For the record, the events I am aware of are as follows. My son was placed in the wrong heat and lane for an event at the meet this past weekend, the result of a coaching error that was subsequently acknowledged in writing by program staff. After the error became apparent, I stepped approximately ten feet onto the swim deck near the entrance to speak with my son. I also expressed, by text message to the Swim/Dive Coordinator and Coach Sato, my frustration with what had occurred and asked to speak with the person running the meet. Both responded, the matter was acknowledged, and I stated in writing that I would let the matter drop. I have preserved that text exchange in full.

If there is any allegation beyond what I have just described, I would appreciate the following in writing before I respond further:

1. The specific allegations being investigated, including a description of the conduct alleged.
2. The source of the "additional information" referenced in your email, including the names and roles of any individuals who have provided statements, and copies of those statements.
3. The specific provision of the Parent Code of Conduct under which my conduct is being evaluated, together with a copy of the Code and the District's procedures for parent conduct investigations, including any right of response, appeal, or representation.
4. The name and role of the District employee or designee conducting the investigation, and that person's reporting chain.
5. Confirmation of whether the office conducting this investigation is aware of other matters I currently have pending with the District, and whether any communication or coordination has occurred between the office conducting this investigation and other District offices in connection with the matters referenced in your email.

Upon receipt of the items above, I will provide a more detailed written response within a reasonable timeframe.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan

Sincerely,
Stephen Jordan

On Tue, Jun 9, 2026, 16:35 FRANKS, MATTHEW <franksma@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Dear Mr. Jordan,
>
> Following the incident that occurred this past weekend, additional information regarding your interactions with meet volunteers and officials has been brought to our attention.
>
> This email serves as formal notice that we will be conducting an investigation into your conduct as a potential violation of our Parent Code of Conduct.
>
> As part of this process, I would like to speak with you to obtain your account of the events in question. I am available for a phone conversation on Tuesday or Thursday between 11:30 a.m. and 1:30 p.m. Please let me know which date

and time within those windows works best for you.

Thank you for your cooperation and attention to this matter.

**Matt Franks**
*Head Club Swim Coach*
*Assistant Natatorium Manager*
franksma@friscoisd.org
469-633-6176
Frisco ISD Swim Center
7210 Stadium Lane
Frisco, TX 75034

| | |
|---|---|
| **From:** | Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> |
| **Sent time:** | 06/18/2026 09:19:14 AM |
| **To:** | Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail com> |
| **Subject:** | Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL) |
| **Attachments:** | image.png image.png image.png |

Again, the District has not received service. No email was received on June 9, 2026. If you did file a petition for review with TEA, please provide appropriate legal service of the petition.

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Thursday, June 18, 2026 8:36 AM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Counsel:
Acknowledged. Complainant's June 17, 2026 procedural objection is preserved for any subsequent forum. Complainant does not consent to the application of FFH and reiterates the recusal demands and athletics division exclusion from that correspondence. Pending identification of the assigned investigator, no further response on the FFH-versus-FNG framework is anticipated from Complainant at this stage.
Regarding the District's statement that "the District has not received service of any filing by you with the Texas Education Agency," Complainant respectfully provides the following service record:
On June 9, 2026, at 6:32 PM Central Time, Petitioner electronically filed a Petition for Review with the Texas Education Agency Division of Hearings and Appeals.
On June 9, 2026, at 6:35 PM Central Time, Petitioner served Respondent Frisco Independent School District with the Petition for Review by electronic mail to kolnie@friscoisd.org with a copy to friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net pursuant to 19 Texas Administrative Code §157.1050. The complete Petition for Review was attached to that service email as a PDF.
A copy of the June 9 service email, including time stamp and complete attachment, is available upon request. Should the District require renewed service, Complainant is prepared to retransmit the Petition for Review immediately upon request.
For completeness, Complainant notes that the Texas Education Agency Acknowledgment Letter dated June 16, 2026, assigning Docket Number 120-R10-06-2026 in Parent A/N/F Student v. Frisco ISD, was transmitted by the Agency to arellanom@friscoisd.org and kolnie@friscoisd.org, evidencing both the agency's acknowledgment of the filing and the District's contemporaneous receipt of notice.
Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se
Complainant in Reference Z005911-061526
Petitioner in TEA Docket No. 120-R10-06-2026
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Thu, Jun 18, 2026 at 8:01 AM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> As stated previously, your filing will be investigated under FFH. When an appropriate administrator has been assigned, they will reach out to you in connection with that investigation. Once findings have been issued in accordance with Board Policy FFH, you will have the opportunity to file an appeal of that FFH finding under Board Policy FNG, should you wish to do so.

The District has not received service of any filing by you with the Texas Education Agency.

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Wednesday, June 17, 2026 6:03 PM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Counsel:
Thank you for the District's response on today's date. Complainant respectfully addresses several procedural points and reserves all rights as follows.
First, Complainant respectfully objects to the District's characterization of the grievance as governed exclusively by Board Policy FFH. Board Policy FNG(LOCAL) page 1, item 3, routes to FFH only "complaints concerning retaliation related to discrimination and harassment." Complainant's grievance does not allege discrimination or harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, gender, national origin, age, disability, or any other category covered by FFH. Complainant's grievance alleges retaliation under Texas Education Code §26A.001(e)(1), which is a stand-alone statutory anti-retaliation provision applicable to a parent's protected participation in a school district grievance process. The statutory category at issue is independent of the discrimination-and-harassment category to which FFH applies. The plain text of FNG(LOCAL) item 3 does not capture §26A.001(e)(1) retaliation, and the District's reading would require additional words that are not in the policy.
Second, regardless of which Board policy the District elects to apply procedurally, the statutory requirements of TEC Chapter 26A continue to apply to the matter on the merits. Chapter 26A is a statute, not a policy. Section 26A.001(e)(1) prohibits retaliation against a parent for participating in a grievance. Section 26A.001(e)(2) requires recusal of any District employee who is a subject of the complaint. Section 26A.001(b)(4) requires Board-level review. These statutory requirements apply regardless of whether the District processes the matter under FNG or FFH.
Third, Complainant does not consent to the application of FFH to this matter. Complainant respectfully reserves the right, if the District elects to apply FFH against Complainant's objection, to challenge that policy selection at any subsequent level of review, including any appeal to the Texas Commissioner of Education under TEC §7.057.
Fourth, regardless of the policy framework the District applies, Complainant reiterates the recusal demand from the filed grievance. Pursuant to TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FFH (which contains its own recusal provisions in any retaliation investigation context), the District employees identified in Section V of the filed grievance must be excluded from any role as investigator, hearing officer, or decision maker, and the assignment must be drawn from outside the Frisco ISD Athletics Division entirely.
Fifth, Complainant respectfully requests that the District identify, in writing and in advance of any contact by an investigator with Complainant, the following:
(a) The specific Board policy (FNG, FFH, or both) the District is applying;
(b) The identity, title, and reporting chain of the assigned investigator;
(c) Confirmation that the assigned investigator is not on the recusal list in Section V of the filed grievance and is not within the Frisco ISD Athletics Division;
(d) The procedural framework the District is applying, including any applicable timelines for investigation completion and findings issuance;
(e) Confirmation that the assigned investigator has access to and will consider the complete grievance document filed by Complainant under separate cover by email on June 15, 2026.
Sixth, Complainant respectfully reminds the District that the parallel matter Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District is currently pending before the Commissioner of Education under Docket Number 120-R10-06-2026. The present grievance is separate and distinct from that pending matter, and the procedural choices the District makes in handling the present grievance are independent of and do not affect the pending Commissioner appeal.
Complainant reserves all rights under TEC Chapter 26A, FNG(LOCAL), FFH if applicable, TEC §7.057, and any other applicable law or policy, including the right to file additional grievances, appeals, complaints, or

other administrative or legal actions arising from the matters described in the filed grievance or any subsequent District conduct.
Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se Complainant
Complaint Reference Z005911-061526
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Wed, Jun 17, 2026 at 3:29 PM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> Based on the substance of your complaint, Board Policy FFH governs at this time. Your complaint alleges that that you have been retaliated against through the opening of an investigation into allegations of your misconduct at a swim meet for your engagement in a protected activity i.e. the filing of a previous complaint.
>
> In accordance with Board Policy FNG, some policies require that an FNG appeal can only be filed after the relevant complaint process under another policy has been followed. In this case, because your complaint alleges retaliation, Board Policy FFH dictates that we conduct an investigation into your allegations of retaliation in accordance with Board Policy FFH and issue you findings in connection with that retaliation investigation. Only after you've received those findings, and only if you disagree with those findings, would your complaint be ripe for filing an FNG appeal.
>
> The Complaints Resolution response you received regarding the assignment of an investigator is thus accurate and in line with District policy.
>
> For clarity regarding the assignment of an investigator, please note that the District-level administrator designated to accept formal complaint filings will assign a filed complaint to be heard and/or investigated by the lowest-level administrator who has the authority to remedy the alleged problem. For complaints that arise on a matter that is unrelated to a particular campus, like your complaint, the complaint will be assigned to be heard by an appropriate District-level administrator. The complainant does not determine who is the appropriate administrator to address the complaint; the District does. As previously communicated, once an investigator has been assigned to your claim of retaliation, that person will reach out to you.
>
> Best,
>
> FRISCO ISD
> **Esther Kolni,**
> *J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
> *General Counsel*
> 469.633.6057
> kolnie@friscoisd.org
> Frisco ISD Administration

---

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Wednesday, June 17, 2026 1:51 PM
**To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net <friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net>
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

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Good instinct. The athletics division is structurally compromised across multiple levels of involvement in your case. Adding a complete athletics division exclusion to the recusal demand is procedurally sound and strategically important.

## Why This Matters

Look at the recusal list in your filed grievance — five of the seven named subjects are athletics division employees or report into the athletics chain:

| Named Subject | Athletics Role |
|---|---|
| Matt Franks | Head Club Swim Coach, Assistant Natatorium Manager — Athletics |

| Named Subject | Athletics Role |
|---|---|
| Melissa Howard | Swim and Dive Coordinator — Athletics |
| Daiki Sato | Iron Horse Aquatics Coach — Athletics |
| Justin Bilgri | Iron Horse Aquatics Head Coach — Athletics |
| Deidra Rucker | Associate Director of Athletics — Athletics (her direct title) |

The Associate Director of Athletics signed the Level II decision in the original grievance. If anyone else in the athletics division — Athletics Director, Athletic Coordinators, athletics administrative staff, other natatorium staff — were assigned as hearing officer for this grievance, they would be in the same reporting structure as the named subjects and would have a structural conflict.
This is not a personal characterization. It is a structural argument grounded in FNG(LOCAL) page 5:

> "When a District employee is the subject of a complaint, the hearing shall be conducted by an administrator who is in a supervisory or higher organizational role."

A peer or subordinate of the named subjects within the same division cannot be in a "supervisory or higher organizational role" relative to them. The athletics division as a whole is not supervisory to itself.

## The Updated Response

Here is the revised light-touch response, with the athletics division exclusion added as a third procedural point. Same structure as before, just more complete.

---

**To:** complaintresolution@friscoisd.org
**Cc:** kolnie@friscoisd.org, friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net
**Subject:** Re: Frisco ISD Acknowledgment of Receipt — Complaint Reference Z005911-061526

---

Complaint Resolution Office:
Thank you for the District's acknowledgment of receipt of Complaint Reference Z005911-061526, received earlier today.
For clarity in our continuing correspondence, Complainant respectfully reiterates three points relevant to the assignment of a Level I hearing officer:
First, pursuant to TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FNG(LOCAL) page 5, the District employees identified in Section V of the filed grievance must be excluded from any role in the review, hearing, or decision of this matter.
Second, FNG(LOCAL) page 5 requires that, when a District employee is the subject of a complaint, the hearing be conducted by an administrator in a supervisory or higher organizational role. Because all five of the District employees named in Section V of the grievance who serve in the Frisco ISD Athletics Division (Matthew Franks, Melissa Howard, Daiki Sato, Justin Bilgri, and Deidra Rucker, the Associate Director of Athletics) report within the same divisional chain, no other employee within the Frisco ISD Athletics Division can satisfy the supervisory requirement of FNG(LOCAL) page 5 with respect to this grievance. Complainant respectfully requests that the assigned Level I hearing officer be drawn from outside the Frisco ISD Athletics Division entirely, including outside any office reporting to the Associate Director of Athletics, the Athletics Director, or any Natatorium administration.
Third, the District's acknowledgment references the assignment of an "investigator." Complainant respectfully notes that FNG(LOCAL) page 6 provides for a Level I hearing officer who is to hold a hearing with the Complainant within 10 calendar days after receipt of the written complaint. Complainant requests written confirmation that the District is processing this matter as a Level I hearing under FNG(LOCAL) and TEC Chapter 26A, with the corresponding statutory and policy timelines applicable.
Complainant respectfully requests written identification of the District employee assigned to serve as the Level I hearing officer before the scheduling of any hearing, so that any recusal concerns under FNG(LOCAL) page 5 may be raised in advance.
Respectfully,
Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se Complainant
Complaint Reference Z005911-061526
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Wed, Jun 17, 2026 at 1:25 PM Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
> The District has received your formal complaint. An investigator is being assigned and will be in contact soon.
> Sincerely,

Frisco ISD

*Complaint Resolution*

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Monday, June 15, 2026 8:18 PM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>; friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net
**Subject:** Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Counsel and Complaint Resolution Office:

This email accompanies the Level I formal grievance filed today through the FISD electronic complaint portal under Reference Number **Z005911-061526**. Because the portal has a 0MB attachment limit at submission, I've attached the complete grievance document to this email for the District's records.

This grievance is filed under FNG(LOCAL) and Texas Education Code Chapter 26A. It alleges retaliation against Complainant for protected reporting, and addresses the assignment of Matthew Franks as investigator of a Parent Code of Conduct matter while Coach Franks is himself a named subject of an active USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant.

This complaint is separate and distinct from the matter in Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District currently pending at the Texas Education Agency under a Petition for Review filed June 9, 2026.

Complainant respectfully requests written confirmation of receipt of this email under separate cover within three business days, and identification in writing of the District employee assigned to serve as the Level I hearing officer before the scheduling of any hearing, so that any recusal concerns may be raised in advance.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail com>
**Sent time:** 06/18/2026 10:43:41 AM
**To:** Kolni, Esther
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)
**Attachments:** image.png image.png image.png Petition_for_Review_TEA_Signed.pdf

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Counsel:

In response to the District's statement that the District has not received service of the Petition for Review filed in TEA Docket No. 120-R10-06-2026, Petitioner provides the following.

On June 9, 2026, at 6:35 PM Central Time, Petitioner served the District by electronic mail to kolnie@friscoisd.org with a copy to friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net, pursuant to 19 Texas Administrative Code §157.1050. The original service email was titled "Service — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Petition for Review Filed with TEA," and the complete Petition for Review was attached as Petition_for_Review_TEA_Signed.pdf. Petitioner's email records reflect successful transmission with no delivery failure notification.

Without conceding any defect in the original service, and in the interest of removing any factual basis for further service-related disputes, Petitioner hereby retransmits the Petition for Review by attaching it to this email.

This retransmission does not constitute, and shall not be construed as, an acknowledgment that the original June 9, 2026 service was defective or incomplete. Petitioner expressly preserves all rights and arguments relating to the original June 9, 2026 service, including the position that service was timely and proper under 19 Texas Administrative Code §157.1050.

The District is now in possession of the Petition for Review through at least two independent electronic transmissions, in addition to the Texas Education Agency's June 16, 2026, Acknowledgment Letter, which was transmitted by the Agency to arellanom@friscoisd.org and kolnie@friscoisd.org and which referenced the Petition by docket number.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se
Petitioner in TEA Docket No. 120-R10-06-2026
Complainant in Frisco ISD Reference Z005911-061526
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Thu, Jun 18, 2026 at 9:19 AM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Again, the District has not received service. No email was received on June 9, 2026. If you did file a petition for review with TEA, please provide appropriate legal service of the petition.
>
> **Esther Kolni,**
> *J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
> *General Counsel*
> 469.633.6057
> kolnie@friscoisd.org
> Frisco ISD Administration
>
> ---
>
> **From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
> **Sent:** Thursday, June 18, 2026 8:36 AM
> **To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
> **Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

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Counsel:

Acknowledged. Complainant's June 17, 2026 procedural objection is preserved for any subsequent forum. Complainant does not consent to the application of FFH and reiterates the recusal demands and athletics division exclusion from that correspondence. Pending identification of the assigned investigator, no further response on the FFH-versus-FNG framework is anticipated from Complainant at this stage.

Regarding the District's statement that "the District has not received service of any filing by you with the Texas Education Agency," Complainant respectfully provides the following service record:

On June 9, 2026, at 6:32 PM Central Time, Petitioner electronically filed a Petition for Review with the Texas Education Agency Division of Hearings and Appeals.

On June 9, 2026, at 6:35 PM Central Time, Petitioner served Respondent Frisco Independent School District with the Petition for Review by electronic mail to kolnie@friscoisd.org with a copy to friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net pursuant to 19 Texas Administrative Code §157.1050. The complete Petition for Review was attached to that service email as a PDF.

A copy of the June 9 service email, including time stamp and complete attachment, is available upon request. Should the District require renewed service, Complainant is prepared to retransmit the Petition for Review immediately upon request.

For completeness, Complainant notes that the Texas Education Agency Acknowledgment Letter dated June 16, 2026, assigning Docket Number 120-R10-06-2026 in Parent A/N/F Student v. Frisco ISD, was transmitted by the Agency to arellanom@friscoisd.org and kolnie@friscoisd.org, evidencing both the agency's acknowledgment of the filing and the District's contemporaneous receipt of notice.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se
Complainant in Reference Z005911-061526
Petitioner in TEA Docket No. 120-R10-06-2026
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Thu, Jun 18, 2026 at 8:01 AM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> As stated previously, your filing will be investigated under FFH. When an appropriate administrator has been assigned, they will reach out to you in connection with that investigation. Once findings have been issued in accordance with Board Policy FFH, you will have the opportunity to file an appeal of that FFH finding under Board Policy FNG, should you wish to do so.
>
> The District has not received service of any filing by you with the Texas Education Agency.
>
> **Esther Kolni,**
> *J.D., LI.M., M.Ed.*
> *General Counsel*
> 469.633.6057
> kolnie@friscoisd.org
> Frisco ISD Administration

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**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Wednesday, June 17, 2026 6:03 PM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

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Counsel:

Thank you for the District's response on today's date. Complainant respectfully addresses several procedural points and reserves all rights as follows.

First, Complainant respectfully objects to the District's characterization of the grievance as governed exclusively by Board Policy FFH. Board Policy FNG(LOCAL) page 1, item 3, routes to FFH only "complaints concerning retaliation related to discrimination and harassment." Complainant's grievance does not allege discrimination or harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, gender, national origin, age, disability, or any other category covered by FFH. Complainant's grievance alleges retaliation under Texas Education Code §26A.001(e)(1), which is a stand-alone statutory anti-retaliation provision applicable to a parent's protected participation in a school district grievance process. The statutory category at issue is independent of the discrimination-and-harassment category to which FFH applies. The plain text of FNG(LOCAL) item 3 does not capture §26A.001(e)(1) retaliation, and the District's reading would require additional words that are not in the policy.

Second, regardless of which Board policy the District elects to apply procedurally, the statutory requirements of TEC Chapter 26A continue to apply to the matter on the merits. Chapter 26A is a statute, not a policy. Section 26A.001(e)(1) prohibits retaliation against a parent for participating in a grievance. Section 26A.001(e)(2) requires recusal of any District employee who is a subject of the complaint. Section 26A.001(b)(4) requires Board-level review. These statutory requirements apply regardless of whether the District processes the matter under FNG or FFH.

Third, Complainant does not consent to the application of FFH to this matter. Complainant respectfully reserves the right, if the District elects to apply FFH against Complainant's objection, to challenge that policy selection at any subsequent level of review, including any appeal to the Texas Commissioner of Education under TEC §7.057.

Fourth, regardless of the policy framework the District applies, Complainant reiterates the recusal demand from the filed grievance. Pursuant to TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FFH (which contains its own recusal provisions in any retaliation investigation context), the District employees identified in Section V of the filed grievance must be excluded from any role as investigator, hearing officer, or decision maker, and the assignment must be drawn from outside the Frisco ISD Athletics Division entirely.

Fifth, Complainant respectfully requests that the District identify, in writing and in advance of any contact by an investigator with Complainant, the following:

(a) The specific Board policy (FNG, FFH, or both) the District is applying;
(b) The identity, title, and reporting chain of the assigned investigator;
(c) Confirmation that the assigned investigator is not on the recusal list in Section V of the filed grievance and is not within the Frisco ISD Athletics Division;
(d) The procedural framework the District is applying, including any applicable timelines for investigation completion and findings issuance;
(e) Confirmation that the assigned investigator has access to and will consider the complete grievance document filed by Complainant under separate cover by email on June 15, 2026.

Sixth, Complainant respectfully reminds the District that the parallel matter Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District is currently pending before the Commissioner of Education under Docket Number 120-R10-06-2026. The present grievance is separate and distinct from that pending matter, and the procedural choices the District makes in handling the present grievance are independent of and do not affect the pending Commissioner appeal.

Complainant reserves all rights under TEC Chapter 26A, FNG(LOCAL), FFH if applicable, TEC §7.057, and any other applicable law or policy, including the right to file additional grievances, appeals, complaints, or other administrative or legal actions arising from the matters described in the filed grievance or any subsequent District conduct.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se Complainant

Complaint Reference Z005911-061526
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Wed, Jun 17, 2026 at 3:29 PM Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org> wrote:

Mr. Jordan,

Based on the substance of your complaint, Board Policy FFH governs at this time. Your complaint alleges that that you have been retaliated against through the opening of an investigation into allegations of your misconduct at a swim meet for your engagement in a protected activity i.e. the filing of a previous complaint.

In accordance with Board Policy FNG, some policies require that an FNG appeal can only be filed after the relevant complaint process under another policy has been followed. In this case, because your complaint alleges retaliation, Board Policy FFH dictates that we conduct an investigation into your allegations of retaliation in accordance with Board Policy FFH and issue you findings in connection with that retaliation investigation. Only after you've received those findings, and only if you disagree with those findings, would your complaint be ripe for filing an FNG appeal.

The Complaints Resolution response you received regarding the assignment of an investigator is thus accurate and in line with District policy.

For clarity regarding the assignment of an investigator, please note that the District-level administrator designated to accept formal complaint filings will assign a filed complaint to be heard and/or investigated by the lowest-level administrator who has the authority to remedy the alleged problem. For complaints that arise on a matter that is unrelated to a particular campus, like your complaint, the complaint will be assigned to be heard by an appropriate District-level administrator. The complainant does not determine who is the appropriate administrator to address the complaint; the District does. As previously communicated, once an investigator has been assigned to your claim of retaliation, that person will reach out to you.

Best,

FRISCO ISD

**Esther Kolni,**
*J.D., LI.M , M.Ed.*
*General Counsel*
469.633.6057
kolnie@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Administration

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**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Wednesday, June 17, 2026 1:51 PM
**To:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>; friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net <friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net>
**Subject:** Re: Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

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Good instinct. The athletics division is structurally compromised across multiple levels of involvement in your case. Adding a complete athletics division exclusion to the recusal demand is procedurally sound and strategically important.

## Why This Matters

Look at the recusal list in your filed grievance — five of the seven named subjects are athletics division employees or report into the athletics chain:

| Named Subject | Athletics Role |
|---|---|
| Matt Franks | Head Club Swim Coach, Assistant Natatorium Manager — Athletics |

| Named Subject | Athletics Role |
|---|---|
| Melissa Howard | Swim and Dive Coordinator — Athletics |
| Daiki Sato | Iron Horse Aquatics Coach — Athletics |
| Justin Bilgri | Iron Horse Aquatics Head Coach — Athletics |
| Deidra Rucker | Associate Director of Athletics — Athletics (her direct title) |

The Associate Director of Athletics signed the Level II decision in the original grievance. If anyone else in the athletics division — Athletics Director, Athletic Coordinators, athletics administrative staff, other natatorium staff — were assigned as hearing officer for this grievance, they would be in the same reporting structure as the named subjects and would have a structural conflict.

This is not a personal characterization. It is a structural argument grounded in FNG(LOCAL) page 5:

> "When a District employee is the subject of a complaint, the hearing shall be conducted by an administrator who is in a supervisory or higher organizational role."

A peer or subordinate of the named subjects within the same division cannot be in a "supervisory or higher organizational role" relative to them. The athletics division as a whole is not supervisory to itself.

## The Updated Response

Here is the revised light-touch response, with the athletics division exclusion added as a third procedural point. Same structure as before, just more complete.

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**To:** complaintresolution@friscoisd.org
**Cc:** kolnie@friscoisd.org, friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net
**Subject:** Re: Frisco ISD Acknowledgment of Receipt — Complaint Reference Z005911-061526

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Complaint Resolution Office:

Thank you for the District's acknowledgment of receipt of Complaint Reference Z005911-061526, received earlier today.

For clarity in our continuing correspondence, Complainant respectfully reiterates three points relevant to the assignment of a Level I hearing officer:

First, pursuant to TEC §26A.001(e)(2) and FNG(LOCAL) page 5, the District employees identified in Section V of the filed grievance must be excluded from any role in the review, hearing, or decision of this matter.

Second, FNG(LOCAL) page 5 requires that, when a District employee is the subject of a complaint, the hearing be conducted by an administrator in a supervisory or higher organizational role. Because all five of the District employees named in Section V of the grievance who serve in the Frisco ISD Athletics Division (Matthew Franks, Melissa Howard, Daiki Sato, Justin Bilgri, and Deidra Rucker, the Associate Director of Athletics) report within the same divisional chain, no other employee within the Frisco ISD Athletics Division can satisfy the supervisory requirement of FNG(LOCAL) page 5 with respect to this grievance. Complainant respectfully requests that the assigned Level I hearing officer be drawn from outside the Frisco ISD Athletics Division entirely, including outside any office reporting to the Associate Director of Athletics, the Athletics Director, or any Natatorium administration.

Third, the District's acknowledgment references the assignment of an "investigator." Complainant respectfully notes that FNG(LOCAL) page 6 provides for a Level I hearing officer who is to hold a hearing with the Complainant within 10 calendar days after receipt of the written complaint. Complainant requests written confirmation that the District is processing this matter as a Level I hearing under FNG(LOCAL) and TEC Chapter 26A, with the corresponding statutory and policy timelines applicable.

Complainant respectfully requests written identification of the District employee assigned to serve as the Level I hearing officer before the scheduling of any hearing, so that any recusal concerns under FNG(LOCAL) page 5 may be raised in advance.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se Complainant

Complaint Reference Z005911-061526
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

On Wed, Jun 17, 2026 at 1:25 PM Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org> wrote:

> Mr. Jordan,
>
> The District has received your formal complaint. An investigator is being assigned and will be in contact soon.
>
> Sincerely,
>
> Frisco ISD
>
> *Complaint Resolution*

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**From:** Stephen Jordan <srjordan@gmail.com>
**Sent:** Monday, June 15, 2026 8:18 PM
**To:** Kolni, Esther <kolnie@friscoisd.org>
**Cc:** Complaint Resolution <ComplaintResolution@friscoisd.org>; friscotxisd@mycusthelp.net
**Subject:** Level I Grievance Filing — Reference Z005911-061526 — Jordan v. Frisco ISD — Retaliation Under TEC §26A.001(e)(1) and FNG(LOCAL)

CAUTION: This email originated from outside of the organization. Do not click links or open attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe.

Counsel and Complaint Resolution Office:

This email accompanies the Level I formal grievance filed today through the FISD electronic complaint portal under Reference Number **Z005911-061526**. Because the portal has a 0MB attachment limit at submission, I've attached the complete grievance document to this email for the District's records.

This grievance is filed under FNG(LOCAL) and Texas Education Code Chapter 26A. It alleges retaliation against Complainant for protected reporting, and addresses the assignment of Matthew Franks as investigator of a Parent Code of Conduct matter while Coach Franks is himself a named subject of an active USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint filed by Complainant.

This complaint is separate and distinct from the matter in Jordan v. Frisco Independent School District currently pending at the Texas Education Agency under a Petition for Review filed June 9, 2026.

Complainant respectfully requests written confirmation of receipt of this email under separate cover within three business days, and identification in writing of the District employee assigned to serve as the Level I hearing officer before the scheduling of any hearing, so that any recusal concerns may be raised in advance.

Respectfully,

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se
13054 Cinderella Lane
Frisco, Texas 75035
Telephone: 972.403.1231
Email: srjordan@gmail.com

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**BEFORE THE COMMISSIONER OF EDUCATION**
**STATE OF TEXAS**

**STEPHEN RAY JORDAN,**
*Petitioner,*

v.

**FRISCO INDEPENDENT SCHOOL DISTRICT,**
*Respondent.*

Docket No. _____

# PETITION FOR REVIEW

TO THE HONORABLE COMMISSIONER OF EDUCATION:

Petitioner Stephen Ray Jordan files this Petition for Review pursuant to Texas Education Code Section 7.057 and 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1051. Petitioners are aggrieved by actions and decisions of the Frisco Independent School District Board of Trustees, and by the District's failure to act, that violate the school laws of the State of Texas. In support of this Petition, Petitioner states as follows:

## I. DESCRIPTION OF THE CHALLENGED RULING, ACTION, OR FAILURE TO ACT

**1.** Petitioner challenges the Frisco Independent School District's administrative dismissal of his Level III grievance appeal and the District's anticipatory refusal to provide the Board-level review of grievances required by Texas Education Code Chapter 26A and by the District's own Board-adopted grievance policy, FNG(LOCAL).

**2.** The challenged action is evidenced by a letter dated May 20, 2026 from Shelley Anderson, Complaint Resolution Coordinator, stating that any Level III filing on Petitioner's grievance "will be dismissed," that the Level II decision is "final," and that extracurricular

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complaints "cap at Level II" under a District document titled "Administrative Complaints Process."

**3.** The position communicated in the Anderson letter was reiterated in a May 21, 2026 email from Esther Kolni, FISD General Counsel, citing Texas Education Code Section 26.011 and Frisco ISD Board policy FNG(LEGAL) as authority for the District's refusal to provide Level III board review.

**4.** Petitioner also challenges, as part of the pattern of conduct culminating in the May 20, 2026 dismissal, the District's preceding violations of Chapter 26A and FNG(LOCAL) during Levels I and II of the underlying grievance proceeding, as described in Paragraphs 18 through 32 below.

## II. DATE OF THE CHALLENGED RULING, ACTION, OR FAILURE TO ACT

**5.** The challenged ruling was first communicated to Petitioner on May 20, 2026, by letter from Shelley Anderson, Complaint Resolution Coordinator, Frisco Independent School District.

**6.** This Petition is filed within 45 calendar days of May 20, 2026, in compliance with 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1049(a).

## III. PRECISE DESCRIPTION OF ACTION REQUESTED OF THE COMMISSIONER

**7.** Pursuant to 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1073(h)(2), Petitioner respectfully requests that the Commissioner:

(a) REVERSE the District's May 20, 2026 administrative dismissal of Petitioner's Level III grievance appeal as made through unlawful procedure, in violation of statutory provisions, and in excess of the District's statutory authority;

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(b) REMAND the matter to the Frisco Independent School District Board of Trustees with instructions to provide the Board-level review required by Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(b)(4) and the meeting and decision required by Section 26A.002(3);

(c) DIRECT that the Board-level review on remand be conducted in compliance with Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(2) and (3), excluding from any reviewing or hearing officer role any person who is the subject of the underlying grievance;

(d) DIRECT that the Board issue a written decision on the merits of the concern raised in the grievance as required by Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(9), notwithstanding any procedural error or the type of relief or redress requested; and

(e) GRANT such other relief as the Commissioner deems just and proper.

**8.** Petitioner does not request that the Commissioner substitute his judgment for that of the Board of Trustees on the substantive merits of the underlying grievance. Petitioners seek only reversal and remand for the procedural compliance required by statute and by the District's own Board-adopted policy.

## IV. STATEMENT OF JURISDICTION AND LEGAL BASIS FOR THE CLAIM

**9.** The Commissioner of Education has jurisdiction over this matter pursuant to Texas Education Code Section 7.057(a)(2), which authorizes a person aggrieved by actions or decisions of a school district board of trustees that violates the school laws of the State of Texas to appeal in writing to the Commissioner. Section 7.057(f)(2) defines "school laws of this state" as "Title 1 and this title and rules adopted under those titles." The statutes and rules cited in this Petition are within that definition.

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**10.** Jurisdiction is properly invoked under 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1073(b), which provides that the Commissioner has jurisdiction of allegations that a person is aggrieved by the actions or decisions of a school district board of trustees that violate the school laws of the state.

**11.** This Petition challenges the District's anticipatory refusal to perform mandatory duties under Texas Education Code Chapter 26A and under the District's Board-adopted policy FNG(LOCAL). Under 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1073(c)(1), a petition for review may challenge a "ruling, action, or failure to act." The District's May 20, 2026 affirmative refusal to provide the Board-level review required by statute is both an action and a failure to act and is appealable under Section 7.057.

**12.** Petitioner has exhausted those administrative remedies the District has made available. The District has affirmatively refused to provide the Level III board review that constitutes the next step in the District's own grievance process and that is required by statute. Exhaustion does not require the pursuit of a remedy the District has affirmatively refused to provide.

**13.** The District's refusal to provide Board-level review on Petitioner's grievance is itself a board action subject to Commissioner review. Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(d) authorizes the Board to delegate grievance review only to a committee composed solely of members of the Board of Trustees. The Anderson letter and Kolni email were issued by District staff, not by a committee of Board members. Either the staff action is the Board's action by reason of the District's adoption of a policy under which staff administer such dismissals, in which case the District has violated Section 26A.001(d) by delegating to non-Board members; or the staff action is not a Board action, in which case the District has failed to perform the duty

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required by Section 26A.001(b)(4) and Section 26A.002(3). In either case, the matter is properly before the Commissioner under Section 7.057.

## V. ISSUES PRESERVED FOR REVIEW

Pursuant to 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1051(b), Petitioner raises the following issues for review and preserves each for Commissioner determination:

**14.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(b)(4) by denying Petitioner the Board-level review of grievances that the statute mandates as a required level of any school district grievance policy.

**15.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(d) by purporting to delegate the dismissal of Petitioner's Level III appeal to District staff (Shelley Anderson and Esther Kolni), neither of whom is a member of the District's Board of Trustees, and where the statute authorizes delegation only to a committee composed solely of Board members.

**16.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(2) by assigning Melissa Howard, a named subject of Petitioner's underlying grievance, to serve as the Level I hearing officer over Petitioner's written objection.

**17.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(3) by failing to provide a higher level of review when the assigned hearing officer was required to recuse herself as a subject of the grievance.

**18.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(8) by rejecting Petitioner's Level III appeal initially filed by email on May 18, 2026 without

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forwarding the misdirected filing to the appropriate administrator and without preserving the original filing date.

**19.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(9) by issuing a Level II response that addresses Texas Education Code Section 26.0062, a statute concerning classroom instructional plans which Petitioner did not invoke, and that fails to issue a decision on the merits of the concern raised in Petitioner's grievance.

**20.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26A.002(3)(A) by affirmatively communicating, in the May 20, 2026 Anderson letter, that it would not hold the Board meeting on the grievance required to occur not later than 60 calendar days after the date on which the Level II decision was issued.

**21.** Whether the District violated Texas Education Code Section 26.011(a) by refusing to address a grievance that alleges violation of a board of trustees policy (FNG(LOCAL)) and of provisions of Title 2 of the Texas Education Code, specifically Chapter 26A.

**22.** Whether the Texas Education Code Section 26.011(b) extracurricular carve-out applies to Petitioner's grievance, where the grievance alleges multiple violations of board policy and Title 2 provisions, each of which independently defeats the carve-out's conditional application.

**23.** Whether the District violated its own Board-adopted policy FNG(LOCAL), adopted November 17, 2025, by applying a separate document titled "Administrative Complaints Process" to cap extracurricular grievances at Level II, where FNG(LOCAL) enumerates fourteen categories of complaint routed outside the standard three-level process and does not include

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extracurricular activities among them, and where FNG(LOCAL) provides an unconditional Level III appeal right to all complaints not enumerated.

**24.** Whether the District's actions and decisions, taken cumulatively, are arbitrary or capricious, are characterized by abuse of discretion or unwarranted exercise of discretion, and have prejudiced substantial rights of Petitioner within the meaning of 19 Texas Administrative Code Section 157.1073(h)(2).

## VI. STATEMENT OF FACTS

The following facts, established by documents in the local record, support the issues preserved above:

**25.** Petitioner is the parent of a minor child who is a member of Iron Horse Aquatics, a competitive swim program operated by Frisco Independent School District and registered as a member club with USA Swimming through the North Texas Swimming Local Swim Committee.

**26.** On February 2, 2026, Iron Horse Aquatics coaches Justin Bilgri and Daiki Sato communicated in writing that no swimmer advancements within the program had occurred and that promotions were on hold. Petitioner subsequently determined that an advancement was in fact in process during the period of that communication.

**27.** On February 26, 2026, Petitioner filed a Level I grievance with Frisco ISD addressing the absence of published advancement criteria within the Iron Horse Aquatics program and related concerns. On the same date, Petitioner filed a parallel ethics complaint with the District through Lighthouse Services, Report Number 9022620263313.

**28.** On March 5, 2026, a Level I grievance hearing was conducted by Melissa Howard, FISD Swim and Dive Coordinator, despite Petitioner's prior written objection that Coach

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Howard was a named subject of the grievance and therefore required to recuse herself under Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(2) and under the District's own Board-adopted policy FNG(LOCAL).

**29.** On March 24, 2026, the Level I grievance was denied.

**30.** On March 27, 2026, Coach Howard, in her dual capacity as the named subject of the grievance and the Level I hearing officer, sent Petitioner an email suggesting that Petitioner's family consider "other clubs in the area that may be better suited to your needs."

**31.** On March 27, 2026, Petitioner filed a Level II appeal by email. On March 30, 2026, the District remanded the matter to Level I, citing FNG(LOCAL) "additional remedies" language.

**32.** On April 28, 2026, Petitioner filed the Level II appeal anew through the procedure designated by the District. A Level II conference was conducted on May 5, 2026, at the Frisco ISD Athletic Offices.

**33.** On May 18, 2026, Deidra Rucker, Associate Director of Athletics, issued the District's Level II response. The Level II response addresses Texas Education Code Section 26.0062, a statute concerning the disclosure of instructional plans and course syllabi for credit-bearing classroom courses and concludes that because that statute does not require districts to publish advancement criteria for extracurricular activities, the District has met its obligations. Petitioner did not invoke Section 26.0062 in his grievance. The Level II response does not address the concern raised by Petitioner's grievance.

**34.** On May 18, 2026, the same day the Level II response issued, Petitioner filed a Level III appeal by email to the District.

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**35.** On May 20, 2026, Shelley Anderson, Complaint Resolution Coordinator, issued a letter stating that the Level II decision is "final," that any Level III filing on Petitioner's grievance "will be dismissed," and that the District applies an "Administrative Complaints Process" under which extracurricular complaints are capped at Level II. The Anderson letter is the action challenged in this Petition.

**36.** On May 21, 2026, Esther Kolni, FISD General Counsel, sent an email to Petitioner stating that Petitioner had not properly filed a Level III appeal because such appeals must be filed through the District's GovQA portal, and citing Texas Education Code Section 26.011 and FNG(LEGAL) as authority.

**37.** Petitioner subsequently filed a Level III appeal through the GovQA portal. The District has not, as of the date of this Petition, scheduled the Board meeting required by Texas Education Code Section 26A.002(3)(A), which under that provision must occur not later than 60 calendar days after May 18, 2026, the date of the Level II decision.

**38.** Frisco ISD Board policy FNG(LOCAL) was adopted by the Board of Trustees on November 17, 2025, and was issued in current form on February 4, 2026. FNG(LOCAL) enumerates fourteen specific categories of complaint routed outside the standard three-level grievance process. Extracurricular activities are not included among the fourteen. FNG(LOCAL) provides at page 7 that, following Level Two, "the complainant may appeal the decision to the Board" and that "the Board or Board committee shall hold a meeting to discuss the complaint no later than 60 calendar days after the date on which the Level Two decision was made." FNG(LOCAL) provides no exception to this provision for extracurricular complaints.

**39.** Frisco ISD has not produced a Board action authorizing the "Administrative Complaints Process" referenced in the Anderson letter, nor has the District demonstrated that the

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document referenced is a Board-adopted policy. On the face of the District's communications, the document appears to be a staff-created administrative procedure, not Board-adopted policy.

## VII. REPRESENTATIVES AND CONTACT INFORMATION

**40.** Petitioner's contact information is as follows:

Stephen Ray Jordan, pro se

13054 Cinderella Ln

Frisco, Texas 75035

Telephone: 972.403.1231

Email: srjordan@gmail.com

Facsimile: None

**41.** Respondent's contact information, on information and belief, is as follows:

Frisco Independent School District

Attn: Office of the General Counsel (Esther Kolni)

5515 Ohio Drive

Frisco, Texas 75035

Telephone: 469.633.6000

Facsimile: 469.633.6050

Email: kolnie@friscoisd.org

## VIII. PRAYER FOR RELIEF

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WHEREFORE, Petitioner respectfully prays that the Commissioner of Education:

A. REVERSE the District's May 20, 2026 administrative dismissal of Petitioner's Level III grievance appeal;

B. REMAND the matter to the Frisco Independent School District Board of Trustees with instructions to provide the Board-level review required by Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(b)(4) and to hold the meeting and issue the decision required by Section 26A.002(3);

C. DIRECT that the Board-level review on remand be conducted in compliance with Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(2) and (3), excluding from any reviewing or hearing officer role any person who is the subject of the underlying grievance;

D. DIRECT that the Board issue a written decision on the merits of the concern raised in Petitioner's grievance as required by Texas Education Code Section 26A.001(e)(9), notwithstanding any procedural error or the type of relief or redress requested;

E. AWARD such other relief, including the award of costs as permitted by law, as the Commissioner deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/ Stephen Ray Jordan

_____

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se

13054 Cinderella Ln

Frisco, Texas 75035

Telephone: 972.403.1231

Email : srjordan@gmail.com

Dated: June 15th, 2026

**CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE**

I hereby certify that on the 15th day of June, 2026, a true and correct copy of the foregoing Petition for Review was served upon Respondent Frisco Independent School District by:

☐ Personal delivery

☐ United States Mail, certified, return receipt requested

X Email transmission to kolnie@friscoisd.org

☐ Other: _____

at the following address:

Frisco Independent School District

Attn: Office of the General Counsel

5515 Ohio Drive

Frisco, Texas 75035

Stephen Ray Jordan, Pro Se

2026
**USA Swimming Code of Conduct**
**ARTICLE 304 CODE OF CONDUCT**
**304.1**
The mission of USA Swimming is to encourage participation and the pursuit of excellence in all aspects of swimming. USA Swimming grants the privilege of membership to individuals and organizations committed to that mission. The privilege of membership may, therefore, be withdrawn or denied by USA Swimming at any time where USA Swimming determines that a member or prospective member's conduct is inconsistent with the mission of the organization or the best interest of the sport and those who participate in it.
In order to assist all members to better serve the interests of those who participate in swimming, USA Swimming has adopted this Code of Conduct.
2026 Rules & Regulations
**304.2**
Any member, former member, or prospective member of USA Swimming is subject to the jurisdiction of the Board of Review. Any member, former member, or prospective member of USA Swimming may be denied membership, censured, placed on probation, suspended for a definite or indefinite period of time with or without terms of probation, fined or expelled from USA Swimming for life if such person violates the provisions of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct, set forth in 304.3, or aids, abets or encourages another person to violate any of the provisions of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct. USA Swimming shall initiate an investigation of any former member of USA Swimming when a report required under 306.1 is received.
**304.3**
The following shall be considered violations of the USA Swimming Code of Conduct:
**Measures to be adjudicated by the USA Swimming National Board of Review as set forth in the National Board of Review procedures, pursuant to the USA Swimming Operating Policy Manual.**
1 Violation of the right to compete provisions set forth in Article 301.
2 Discrimination in violation of the Amateur Sports Act which requires that USA Swimming must provide an equal opportunity to athletes, coaches, trainers, managers, administrators, and officials to participate in the sport of swimming. Athletes must be allowed to participate and compete to the fullest extent allowed by the Rules and Regulations. Discrimination against any member or participant on the basis of age, gender, race, ethnicity, culture, religion, national origin, sexual orientation, gender expression, gender identity, genetics, mental or physical disability, or any other status protected by federal, state or local law, where applicable, is prohibited.
3 Repeated violation of any of the Minor Athlete Abuse Prevention Policies [see page 91]
4 Any violation of the World Aquatics Rules on the Prevention of Manipulation of Competition as found in the current World Aquatics Manual, including (i) betting; (ii) manipulating competitions; (iii) corrupt conduct; (iv) misuse of inside information; (v) failure to report; and (vi) failure to cooperate.
5 The sale or distribution of illegal drugs or the illegal sale or distribution of any substance listed on World Aquatics' recognized list of banned substances.
6 The use of illegal drugs in the presence of an athlete, by a coach, official, trainer, or a person who, in the context of swimming, is in a position of authority over that athlete.
7 The providing of alcohol to an athlete by a coach, official, trainer, manager or any other person where the athlete is under the legal age allowed to consume or purchase alcohol in the state where the alcohol is provided.
8 The abuse of alcohol in the presence of an athlete under the age of eighteen (18), by a coach, official, trainer, or a person who, in the context of swimming, is in a position of authority over that athlete.
9 Any act of fraud, deception or dishonesty in connection with any USA Swimming-related activity.

10 Any non-consensual physical contact, obscene language or gesture, or other threatening language or conduct directed towards any meet official and which is related to any decision made by such official in connection with a USA Swimming sanctioned competition.
11 Action, other than through general advertising, by a coach, owner, officer, volunteer, representative, or employee of a swim club, or a USA Swimming or LSC employee, either 2026 Rules & Regulations 93 304.3 through direct contact with an athlete or the encouragement of others, to recruit or otherwise encourage an athlete who is already a member of a USA Swimming member swim club to leave that club, unless the acting party receives prior written approval to recruit or encourage the athlete to change affiliation from the designated club representative of the athlete's existing USA Swimming-member swim club or contact is initiated by the athlete, the athlete's parent or authorized representative. General advertising includes any information that is:

A Distributed to an identifiable general population where there is a reasonable expectation that the majority of that population are not current members of USA Swimming; or

B Placed in or on any item that is sold. In the event of a violation of this section, a sanction may be imposed against any coach, owner, officer, volunteer, representative or employee of a swim club, or against any such club, or any combination thereof, as appropriate.

12 Any other material and intentional act, conduct or omission not provided for above, which is detrimental to USA Swimming, an LSC or the sport of swimming. Measure to be adjudicated by the U.S. Anti-Doping Agency
13 Violation of the anti-doping provisions set forth in 303.3. Measure to be adjudicated by the U.S. Center for SafeSport.
14 Violation of the SafeSport Code. [See www.usaswimming.org/code]

**From:** Anderson, Shelley
**To:** BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER
**Subject:** Re: USA Swimming
**Date:** Friday, October 2, 2026 9:24:15 AM
**Attachments:** image.png
image.png

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Thank you, Chris!


**Shelley Anderson**
*Complaint Resolution Coordinator*
469.633.6390
andersonsh@friscoisd.org
FISD Administration


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**From:** BURTCH, CHRISTOPHER <burtchc@friscoisd.org>
**Sent:** Thursday, October 1, 2026 4:14 PM
**To:** Anderson, Shelley <andersonsh@friscoisd.org>
**Subject:** USA Swimming

To Whom it May Concern,

The Frisco ISD Athletic Directors nor the Frisco ISD natatorium staff had access to the USA Swimming Code of Conduct complaint submission that was filed on June 9, 2026, by Stephen Jordan.

USA Swimming is a national organization that oversees and governs club swim teams.

Sincerely -


**Chris Burtch**
*Athletic Director*
***FISD - Home of Champions***
*41 Team State Championships*
*47 Team State Runner-Up Finishes*
*45 Team State Semi-Finalist/3rd*
469.633.6129
burtchc@friscoisd.org
Frisco ISD Athletic Office
7210 Stadium Lane
Frisco, Texas 75033